



Microsoft Power Automate for End Users

Two-day course book

Collect, report, remind, approve and brief: automate a training coordinator's routine with automated, instant and scheduled cloud flows, variables, parallel branches and Copilot.

Microsoft Power Automate for End Users

Two-day course book · Participant edition, version 2.0

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Online resources: github.com/Asraf-JS/Microsoft-Power-Automate

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Screenshots show the product at the time of writing. Microsoft updates its apps often, so labels and layouts in your tenant may differ slightly.

About the author

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He holds a Bachelor of Information Technology (Multimedia) from the University of Malaya, along with Microsoft certifications in Power BI (PL-300) and AI for business (AB-730). Outside the classroom he writes his own automation tools in Python and Node.js, mostly to save himself from doing the same task twice.

He runs his training practice solo, which means he has personally felt every inefficiency this book tries to fix.

Contents

	Before you begin	9
1	Understand Power Automate	12
	What You Will Learn	12
	Your Business Scenario	12
	1.1 What Is Automation?	12
	1.2 Recognise the Parts of a Flow	13
	1.3 Choose How the Flow Starts	13
	1.4 Connectors and Connections	14
	1.5 Explore Power Automate	14
	1.6 Plan Before You Build	17
	Independent Practice: Plan a Weekly Reminder	17
	Tips and Troubleshooting	18
	Lesson Summary	18
	Hands-on exercises	19
2	Prepare Your Training Workspace	21
	What You Will Learn	21
	2.1 Create the Training Folders in OneDrive	21
	2.2 Create the Excel Workbook	22
	2.3 Prepare a Test Email	24
	2.4 Confirm Forms Readiness	25
	2.5 Confirm the Teams Training Destination	25
	2.6 Confirm the Power Automate Environment	25
	Independent Practice	25
	Lesson Summary	25
	Hands-on exercises	26
3	Save Email Attachments Automatically	27
	What You Will Learn	27
	Before You Begin	27
	How to Insert Dynamic Content	28
	3.1 Create the Automated Cloud Flow	28
	3.2 Configure the Trigger	29
	3.3 Add Apply to Each	30
	3.4 Add the PDF Condition	31
	3.5 Create the OneDrive File	32
	3.6 Test a Positive Case	33
	3.7 Test a Negative Case	34
	Independent Practice	35
	Tips and Troubleshooting	35

Lesson Summary	36
Hands-on exercises	37
4 Create and Distribute an Excel Summary	38
What You Will Learn	38
How the Flow Works	38
Before You Begin	38
4.1 Confirm the Source Table	39
4.2 Create an Instant Cloud Flow	40
4.3 Read the Excel Records	41
4.4 Choose the Report Columns	42
4.5 Build One HTML Table	43
4.6 Send the Coordinator Summary	44
4.7 Your First Expression: Count the Rows	45
4.8 Test and Inspect	47
4.9 Optional Teams Update	48
Independent Practice	48
Troubleshooting	48
Lesson Summary	49
Hands-on exercises	50
5 Send Weekly Training Reminders	51
What You Will Learn	51
How the Flow Works	51
Before You Begin	51
5.1 Create the Weekly Schedule	52
5.2 Produce a Readable Local Timestamp	53
5.3 Read the Excel Rows	54
5.4 Process One Row at a Time	55
5.5 Prepare the Reminder Email	56
5.6 Make the Date Readable with an Expression	57
Trainer-Controlled Test	58
Independent Practice	58
Troubleshooting	59
Lesson Summary	59
Hands-on exercises	60
6 Process a Training Approval	61
What You Will Learn	61
How the Flow Works	61
Before You Begin	61
6.1 Prepare the Request Form	62
6.2 Create the Automated Flow	62
6.3 Select the Form	63

6.4 Retrieve the Answers	64
6.5 Request the Decision	64
6.6 Branch on the Outcome	65
6.7 Prepare the Approved Message	66
6.8 Prepare the Rejected Message	67
6.9 Save and Check the Flow	67
Trainer-Controlled Test	68
Independent Practice	68
Troubleshooting	68
Lesson Summary	69
Hands-on exercises	70
7 Capstone: Weekly Reminders and Summary	71
What You Will Learn	71
How the Flow Works	71
Before You Begin	71
7.1 Make a Safe Capstone Copy	72
7.2 Remove Completed Rows with Filter Array	72
7.3 Work Out the End of the Window	73
7.4 Start the Reminder Counter	74
7.5 Loop Through the Remaining Rows	75
7.6 Check the Date Window	76
7.7 Count Each Reminder	77
7.8 Decide Whether a Summary Is Needed	78
7.9 Prepare the Coordinator Summary	79
7.10 Handle a Week with No Matching Rows	80
7.11 Save and Check the Capstone	80
Trainer-Controlled Test	81
Independent Practice	81
Troubleshooting	82
Lesson Summary	82
Hands-on exercises	83
8 My Morning Briefing: Variables and Parallel Branches	85
What You Will Learn	85
How the Flow Works	85
8.1 Create the Scheduled Flow	86
8.2 Create the Variables	86
8.3 Branch 1: The Weather	87
8.4 Branch 2: Your Meetings	88
8.5 Branch 3: Important Unread Email	89
8.6 Bring the Branches Back Together	90
8.7 Change the Subject on a Busy Day	91
8.8 Send the Briefing	92

8.9 Test It	93
Independent Practice	94
Troubleshooting	94
Lesson Summary	95
Hands-on exercises	96
9 Plan an Automation with Copilot	98
What You Will Learn	98
The Business Problem	98
Before You Begin	98
9.1 Open the Copilot Planning Experience	99
9.2 Describe the Complete Business Outcome	99
9.3 Review the First Suggestion	100
9.4 Clarify the Filter and Count	101
9.5 Identify an Unnecessary Action	101
9.6 Request a Streamlined Design	102
9.7 Validate the Final Suggestion	102
9.8 Exit Without Creating the Flow	103
Independent Practice	103
Troubleshooting	103
Lesson Summary	104
Hands-on exercises	105
10 Move Automations with Environments and Solutions	106
What You Will Learn	106
The Migration Path	106
Before You Begin	107
Environments in Plain Language	107
10.1 Confirm the Current Environment	107
10.2 Create the Solution	107
10.3 to 10.7 Add the Capstone Flow	108
10.8 Verify the Solution Components	109
10.9 Review the Solution Before Export	110
10.10 to 10.12 Publish and Export	110
10.13 and 10.14 Switch Environment and Start the Import	111
10.15 Repair Connections and Settings	112
10.16 Verify and Test Safely	112
Independent Practice	112
Troubleshooting	112
Lesson Summary	113
Hands-on exercises	114
11 Extra Practice: Personal Automations	115
Which One Should I Try?	115

A. Flagged Email to To Do	115
B. Send Me a Note	116
C. Save an Email to OneDrive	117
D. News Digest	118
Lesson Summary	119
Hands-on exercises	120

Before you begin

How to use this book

This book collects the notes and copy-paste values from the two-day Microsoft Power Automate for End Users course in one place, so you can follow along offline and keep it at your desk afterwards.

Each chapter matches one chapter of the course and has two parts:

- **Notes** explain the concepts and walk you through each build step by step, mostly point and click, with screenshots, checkpoints and troubleshooting.
- **Hands-on exercises** give you every flow name and text value you type, ready to copy.

You'll write just a few short expressions on the main path, one each in Chapters 4, 5 and 7, each with a step-by-step explanation. More are waiting in optional *Going further* boxes for when you're ready.

Look out for the coloured boxes. Blue boxes are notes, teal boxes are tips, purple boxes are things to try, and orange boxes are key points and warnings.

Prefer to copy values rather than retype them? Everything in this book is also online at github.com/Asraf-JS/Microsoft-Power-Automate, where each grey box has a copy button. Copying from there is safer than copying from a PDF, which can add line breaks or change quotation marks.

Course scenario

Throughout the course you automate the work of one training coordinator.

You coordinate training for a small organisation. Course materials arrive by email, session details live in an Excel register, requests need approval, and participants need reminders.

Each chapter turns one of those manual tasks into a flow:

Stage	What happens
Plan	Learn how flows work and write a plan before building anything
Prepare	Set up the OneDrive folders, Excel register, test email, Forms and Teams destinations
Collect	Save PDF attachments from training emails to OneDrive automatically
Report	Send the coordinator a one-click summary table from the Excel register
Remind	Send weekly reminders to every participant on a schedule
Approve	Route a training request form through an approval and post the result to Teams
Refine	Filter reminders to upcoming incomplete sessions, count them and summarise the week

Brief	Build a personal morning briefing with variables and parallel branches
Design	Use Copilot to plan a flow, then review and correct its suggestion
Release	Watch the trainer package the finished flow in a solution for another environment

Ground rules

Important: Use only fictional data. Keep flows turned off until your trainer asks you to test them, and only send test emails to addresses your trainer has approved. Testing a flow can create files, send messages, start approvals or change shared data.

Sample files

Four practice files come with the course. All of them are fictional.

File	Used in	What it is
TrainingRegister.xlsx	Chapters 2 to 7	A ready-made register with the tblTraining table and six records. Use it only if your trainer says so
CourseOutline.pdf	Chapters 2 and 3	The attachment the Chapter 3 flow should save
TrainerPhoto.jpg	Chapters 2 and 3	The attachment the Chapter 3 flow should skip
SessionNotes.docx	Chapter 3	Used in the independent practice

Download them from the course repository: github.com/Asraf-JS/Microsoft-Power-Automate.

Your Power Automate training journey

One coordinator's routine, start to finish: turn each repeated manual task into a cloud flow.

FOUNDATIONS

01

Understand Power Automate

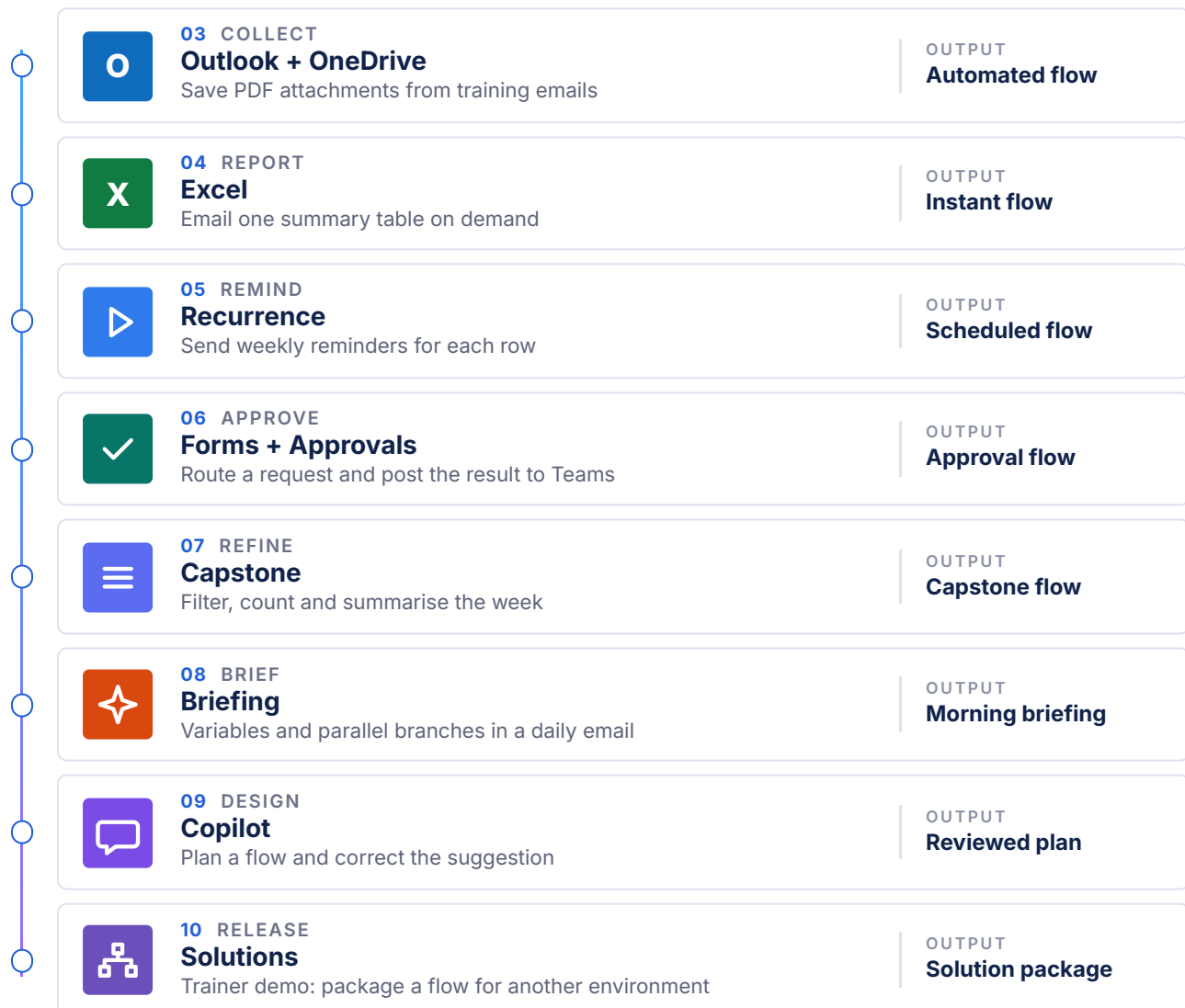
Triggers, actions, flow types and planning

02

Prepare your workspace

OneDrive folders, the Excel register and test data

THE PROJECT, APP BY APP



Collect → Report → Remind → Approve → Refine → Brief → Design → Release

01

CHAPTER 1

Understand Power Automate

Before you build anything, learn the vocabulary of a flow, the three ways a cloud flow can start, and where the main pages live in Power Automate.

Copy-paste values: the planning template for this chapter is on the copy-paste page.

Estimated time: 45 minutes

Your result: A simple automation plan and familiarity with the Power Automate Home and Create pages.

What You Will Learn

- Identify a repetitive business task that could benefit from automation
- Explain the trigger, actions, data, condition and result of a flow
- Choose between an automated, instant and scheduled cloud flow
- Open Power Automate and find Home, Create and My flows
- Write a short plan before building an automation

You need a Windows computer with Microsoft Edge, an internet connection and your training work or school account. You don't need the Excel workbook, a form or any test files yet. You prepare those in Chapter 2.

Your Business Scenario

You coordinate training for a small organisation. Course materials arrive by email, session details are stored in Excel, and participants need reminders. You keep downloading attachments, copying information into messages and checking whether requests were approved.

Each of those tasks has a recognisable starting point and repeatable steps. Over the two days you use Power Automate to do some of those steps for you.

1.1 What Is Automation?

Automation means setting up a repeatable process so software performs the steps when a defined event happens, or when you ask it to run.

Power Automate calls an automation a **flow**. This course builds **cloud flows**, which work with online services such as Outlook and OneDrive for Business.

A flow applies your rule every time, including a wrong one. If you pick the wrong folder or recipient, the flow repeats that mistake. So every flow needs a clear rule and a test.

Tip: Start with a small task whose result you can check easily. A good first flow saves one test attachment to the correct folder.

1.2 Recognise the Parts of a Flow

Take this requirement: *When an email with the subject marker [PA TRAINING] arrives, examine each attachment. If the attachment is a PDF, save it to the training attachments folder.*

Part	Plain-language meaning	Example
Trigger	What starts the flow	A matching email arrives
Action	A step the flow carries out	Create a file in OneDrive for Business
Data	Information a step receives or produces	The attachment's name and contents
Condition	A question that selects a path	Is this attachment a PDF?
Loop	Steps repeated for each item	Check each attachment in the email
Result	The business outcome you verify	Matching files appear in the intended folder

The basic pattern is: something starts the flow, the flow follows its steps, you check the result. A flow only needs a condition or a loop when the process calls for one.

Try it: Imagine a training email with two attachments, `CourseOutline.pdf` and `TrainerPhoto.jpg`. Walk the rule through each one. The PDF is saved, the image is skipped, and the folder should end up with `CourseOutline.pdf` only. If an email has no PDFs at all, the flow still runs successfully and creates nothing.

1.3 Choose How the Flow Starts

Cloud-flow type	When it starts	Training example
Automated	When a specified event occurs	Save attachments when a training email arrives
Instant	When you deliberately start it	Create an Excel summary when you're ready to share it
Scheduled	At a time and frequency you configure	Send training reminders every Monday morning

Pick the type by asking *what should make this process begin?* Sending an email doesn't tell you the type. All three can send email. Only their starting points differ.

Quick check. Pick a type for each request, then check the answers.

1. Whenever a new training request is submitted, ask someone to approve it.
2. At 9:00 AM every Friday, prepare a weekly reminder.
3. Let me generate a summary whenever I need one.

Answers: 1 is Automated, 2 is Scheduled, 3 is Instant.

1.4 Connectors and Connections

A **connector** gives Power Automate a set of triggers and actions for one service. Office 365 Outlook provides email operations. OneDrive for Business provides file operations.

A **connection** links those operations to an account. Whenever a later lesson asks you to sign in to a connector, check that you're using the training account, and that it has permission for the mailbox, folder or resource involved.

The core exercises use standard connectors only. Power Automate Free can create and run cloud flows with standard connectors but can't share flows, so you build and own your own flows. See [Power Automate license types](#).

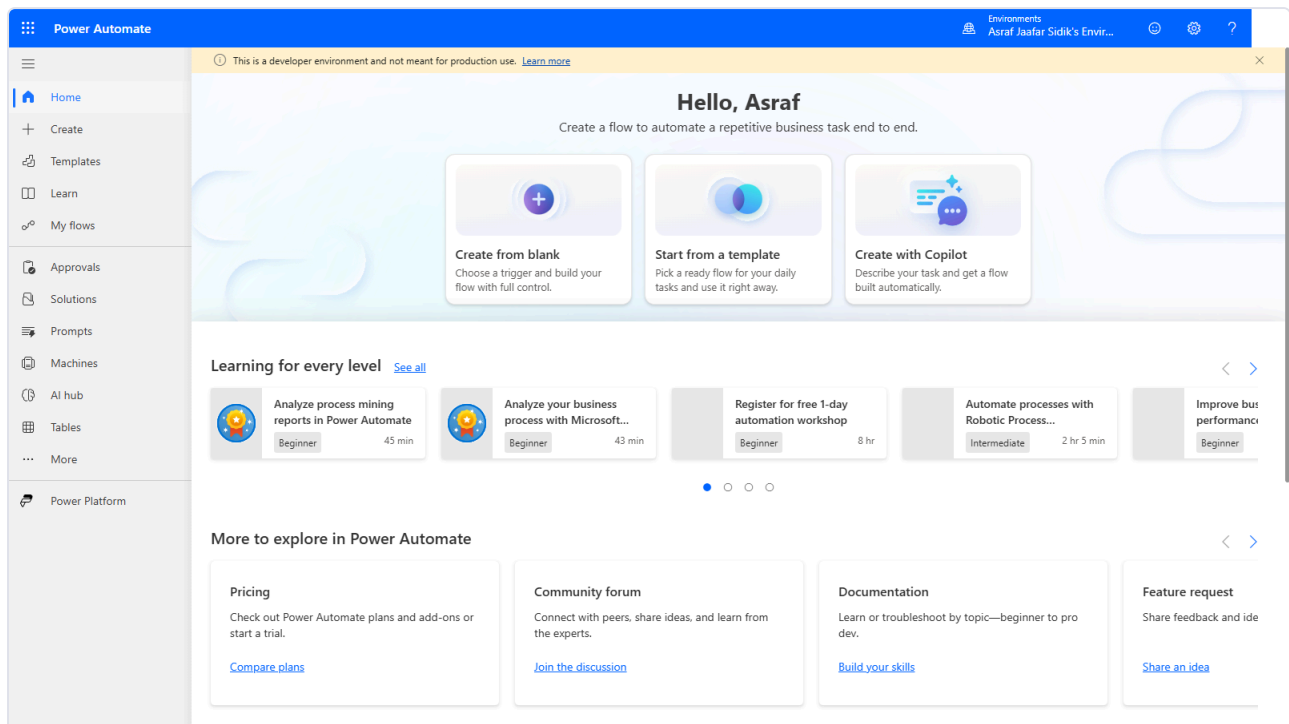
Tip: Office 365 Outlook and Outlook.com are different connectors. Go by the connector name in the lesson, not the icon.

1.5 Explore Power Automate

The manual has a screenshot for each step (Figures 1.1 to 1.12).

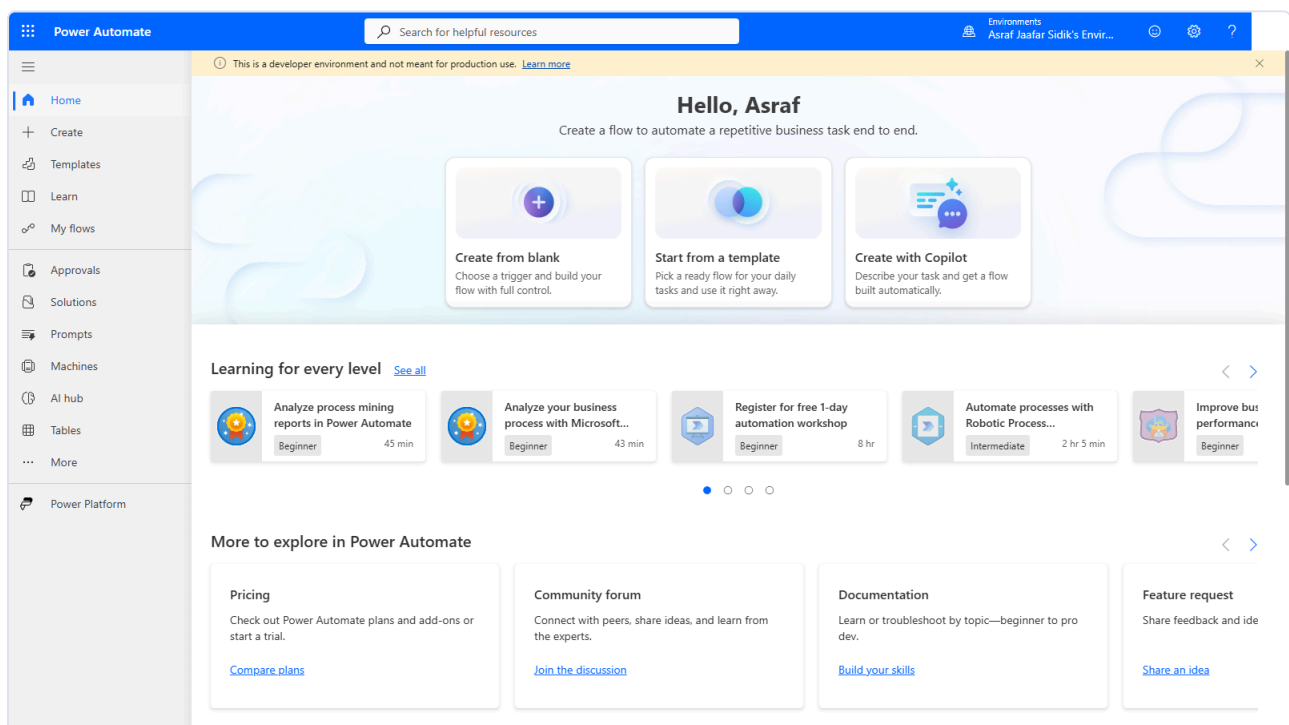
Open the training workspace

1. In Edge, go to make.powerautomate.com and sign in with your training account.
2. Check that the page says **Power Automate** at the upper left.



The Power Automate home page.

- Find the environment name near the top of the page, under **Environments**. An environment is a workspace that holds Power Platform resources, including flows.
- Compare it with the environment your trainer gave you. If they differ, ask before you build anything.



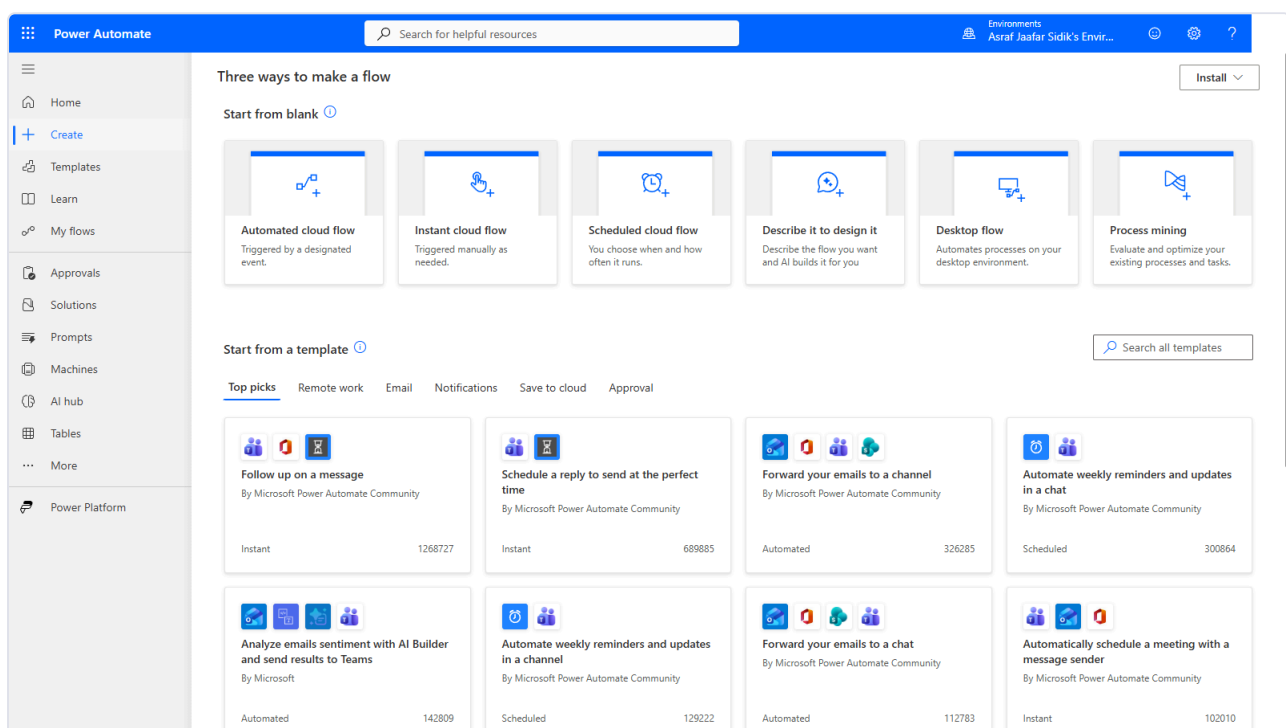
The environment selector shows which workspace you're in. Yours will have a different name.

Find the three cloud-flow choices

- Expand the left navigation if it's collapsed, then select **Create**.

2. Under **Start from blank** you see six tiles. Three of them create cloud flows from scratch, and those are what this course uses:

Tile	Description on the tile	Used in this course
Automated cloud flow	Triggered by a designated event	Yes
Instant cloud flow	Triggered manually as needed	Yes
Scheduled cloud flow	You choose when and how often it runs	Yes
Describe it to design it	Describe the flow you want and AI builds it for you	Chapter 9
Desktop flow	Automates processes on your desktop environment	No
Process mining	Evaluate and optimize your existing processes and tasks	No



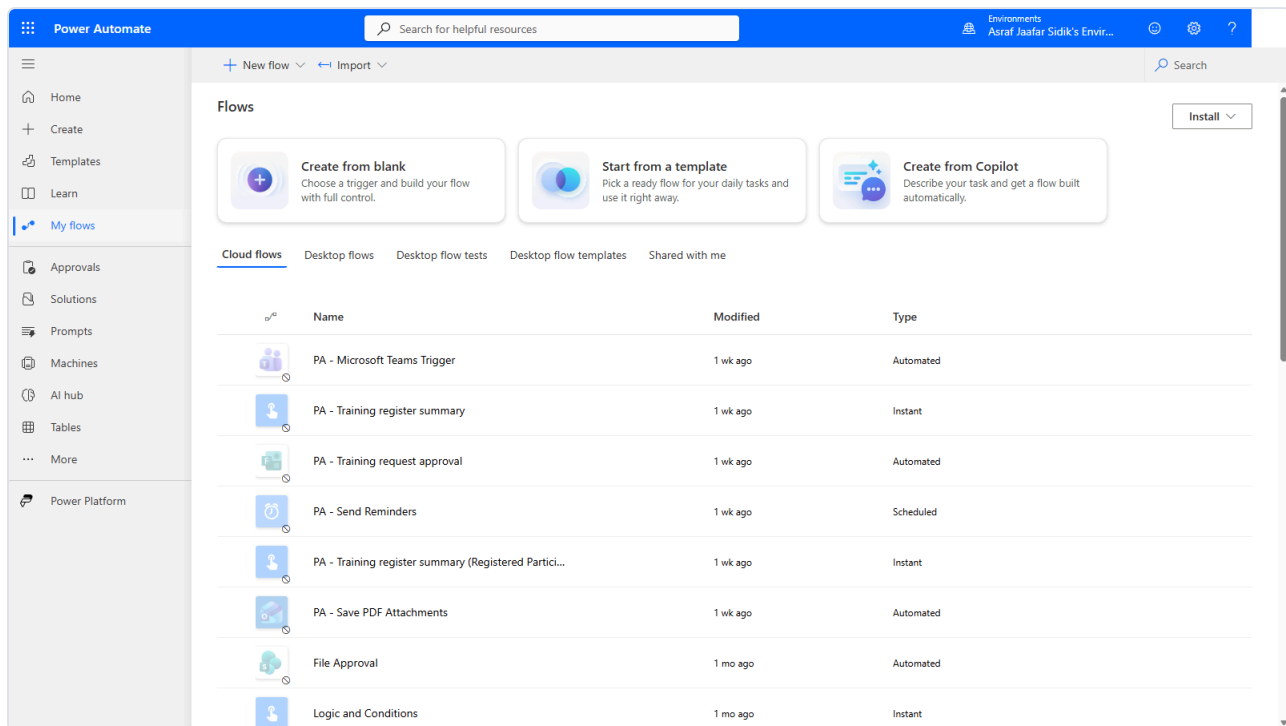
The three cloud-flow tiles come first under Start from blank. Describe it to design it is the Copilot option you'll try in Chapter 9.

Note: The heading **Three ways to make a flow** refers to the three sections of the page: Start from blank, Start from a template and Start from a connector. Those aren't the three cloud-flow types. The types are three of the six tiles inside the first section.

3. Decide which tile you'd use for a flow that starts when someone submits a form. The answer is **Automated cloud flow**: a form submission is an event that happens without you starting it. Instant means you start the flow.

Locate your flows

1. Find **My flows** in the left navigation. You'll come back here to find every flow you build.



My flows lists every flow you've built.

2. Select **Home** to return to the start page.

1.6 Plan Before You Build

A short plan makes the designer much easier to use. Here's the plan for the attachment scenario:

Planning question	Example answer
What task repeats?	Saving PDF training attachments from email
What starts it?	An email with the training subject marker arrives
What information is needed?	Attachment name and contents
What rule applies?	Save PDF attachments; skip other file types
Where should the output go?	The training attachments folder in OneDrive for Business
How will I test it?	Use an email with a PDF and an image, then check the folder

Chapter 2 prepares the resources this plan refers to. Chapter 3 turns it into a working flow.

Independent Practice: Plan a Weekly Reminder

Allow five minutes. Every Monday morning, a training coordinator wants to remind people about upcoming sessions. Session details are in Excel. People whose training is marked Completed should not get a reminder.

1. Choose a cloud-flow type.

2. State the start time and time zone.
3. List three pieces of information the flow needs from Excel.
4. Write one rule that decides whether a reminder is sent.
5. Describe a test with one person who should get a reminder and one who shouldn't.

A good plan uses a scheduled flow with a local time zone, needs values like email address, session date, course title and status, sends only for upcoming incomplete training, and tests both an included and an excluded record.

Tips and Troubleshooting

What you notice	What to do
A different Microsoft account opens automatically	Check the account shown on the page. Use the Edge profile meant for training
You can't open Power Automate	Check the address and connection, then ask the trainer to verify access. Note the error message
The environment name is unfamiliar	Compare it with the class instructions before creating anything
Create isn't visible	Expand the left navigation. If it's still missing, ask the trainer to check access
The page looks different from the screenshot	Look for the named command. Layouts vary
A trial or upgrade prompt appears	Check what you selected. The core lessons use the Free baseline
You can't decide which flow type to use	Finish the sentence "This process should begin when..." and match it to a type

Lesson Summary

A trigger starts a flow, actions perform the steps, and data moves between them. Conditions choose a path and loops repeat work for each item. You can now tell automated, instant and scheduled flows apart, find the main Power Automate pages, and describe an automation before you build it.

HANDS-ON

Hands-on exercises

Hover over a grey box and click the copy icon in its top-right corner.

Automation planning template (section 1.6)

Paste this into your notes and fill in each line before you build a flow. You use the same questions for the independent practice at the end of the chapter.

```
What task repeats?  
What starts it?  
What information is needed?  
What rule applies?  
Where should the output go?  
How will I test it?
```

Power Automate address (section 1.5)

```
https://make.powerautomate.com
```


02

CHAPTER 2

Prepare Your Training Workspace

Every flow in this course reads from or writes to something: a folder, a table, a mailbox, a form, a Teams chat. Set those up first and the later build steps become predictable.

Copy-paste values: the Excel headers, table name and email subject are on the copy-paste page.

Estimated time: 90 minutes

Your result: A training folder, an Excel workbook with a table, and safe test data for the first two build exercises.

What You Will Learn

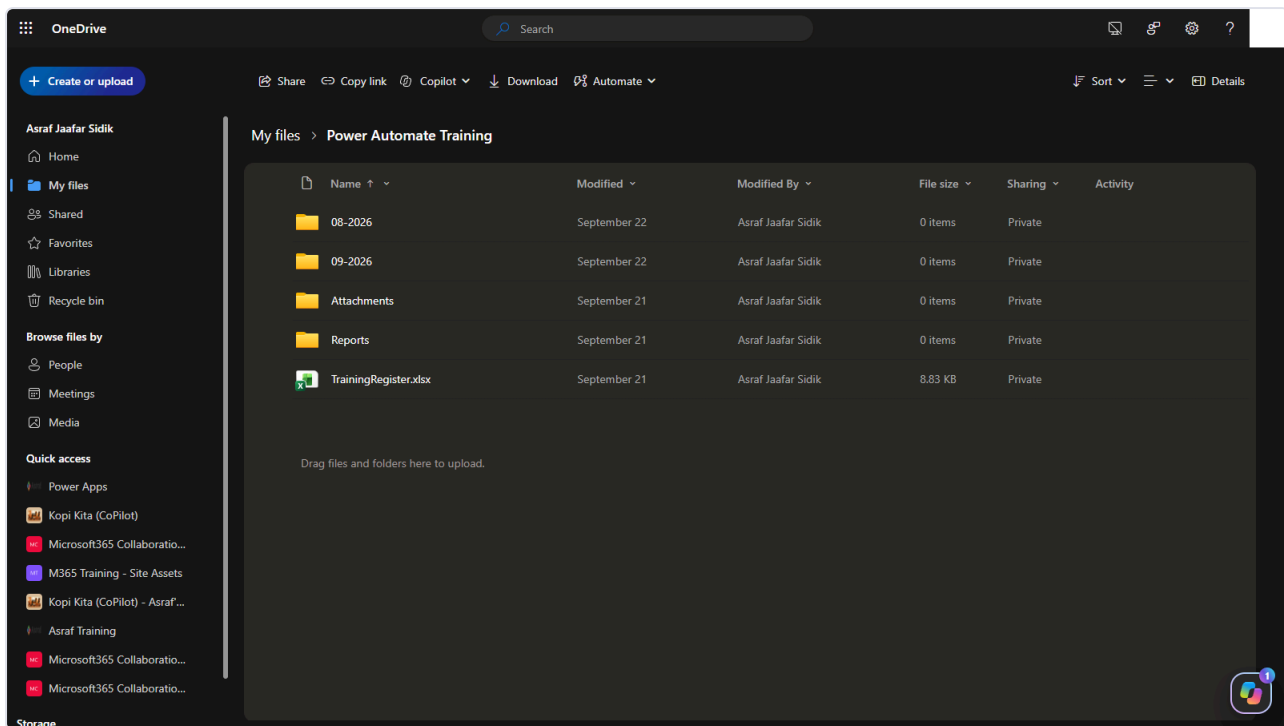
- Create a dedicated training folder structure in OneDrive for Business
- Build an Excel workbook and format its data as a named table
- Prepare a safe test email with sample attachments
- Confirm that Forms, Teams and your Power Automate environment are ready

Note: Use your own training account and the environment your trainer names. Never put real participant information in the practice resources. Use fictional names and test addresses only.

Forms and Teams preparation in this chapter are trainer-led readiness checks, because those destinations depend on your organisation's policy.

2.1 Create the Training Folders in OneDrive

1. Open OneDrive for Business and select **My files**.
2. Select **Create or upload**, then **Folder**.
3. Name the folder *Power Automate Training* and select **Create**.
4. Open the new folder.
5. Inside it, create two subfolders: *Attachments* and *Reports*.



Both subfolders inside Power Automate Training.

Checkpoint: You can see *Attachments* and *Reports* inside *Power Automate Training*. The Chapter 3 flow writes to *Attachments*. Summary outputs can go to *Reports*.

2.2 Create the Excel Workbook

1. Inside *Power Automate Training*, select **Create or upload**, then **Excel workbook**. Check the breadcrumb first: the workbook is created in whichever folder you're viewing.
2. When Excel for the web opens, select the file name in the title bar and rename it *TrainingRegister*. Excel adds *.xlsx* for you.
3. In *Sheet1*, enter these headers in row 1:

TrainingID	ParticipantName	Email	CourseTitle	SessionDate	Status
------------	-----------------	-------	-------------	-------------	--------

4. Enter six fictional rows. Include at least two upcoming sessions, one completed session, and one session outside the training week. Use the trainer's approved test addresses in the *Email* column.

TrainingID	ParticipantName	Email	CourseTitle	SessionDate	Status
TR-001	Aisha Rahman	learner1@example.com	Power Automate Basics	9/21/2026	Registered
TR-002	Daniel Lee	learner2@example.com	Excel Reporting	9/22/2026	Registered
TR-003	Mei Chen	learner3@example.com	Microsoft Forms	9/23/2026	Completed
TR-004	Ravi Kumar	learner4@example.com	Teams Collaboration	9/24/2026	Registered
TR-005	Sofia Martinez	learner5@example.com	Approval Workflows	9/28/2026	Registered
TR-006	Noah Williams	learner6@example.com	Cloud Flow Essentials	10/5/2026	Completed
TR-007	Asraf	learner6@example.com	Power Automate Basics	9/21/2026	Completed

Six fictional rows. The example.com addresses can't receive mail.

5. Select any cell in the range, choose **Insert > Table**, confirm **My table has headers** is ticked, and select **OK**. Then on the **Table Design** tab, replace the default table name with `tblTraining` and press Enter.

TrainingID	ParticipantName	Email	CourseTitle	SessionDate	Status
TR-001	Aisha Rahman	learner1@example.com	Power Automate Basics	9/21/2026	Registered
TR-002	Daniel Lee	learner2@example.com	Excel Reporting	9/22/2026	Registered
TR-003	Mei Chen	learner3@example.com	Microsoft Forms	9/23/2026	Completed
TR-004	Ravi Kumar	learner4@example.com	Teams Collaboration	9/24/2026	Registered
TR-005	Sofia Martinez	learner5@example.com	Approval Workflows	9/28/2026	Registered
TR-006	Noah Williams	learner6@example.com	Cloud Flow Essentials	10/5/2026	Completed
TR-007	Asraf	learner6@example.com	Power Automate Basics	9/21/2026	Completed

Set the table name on the Table Design tab.

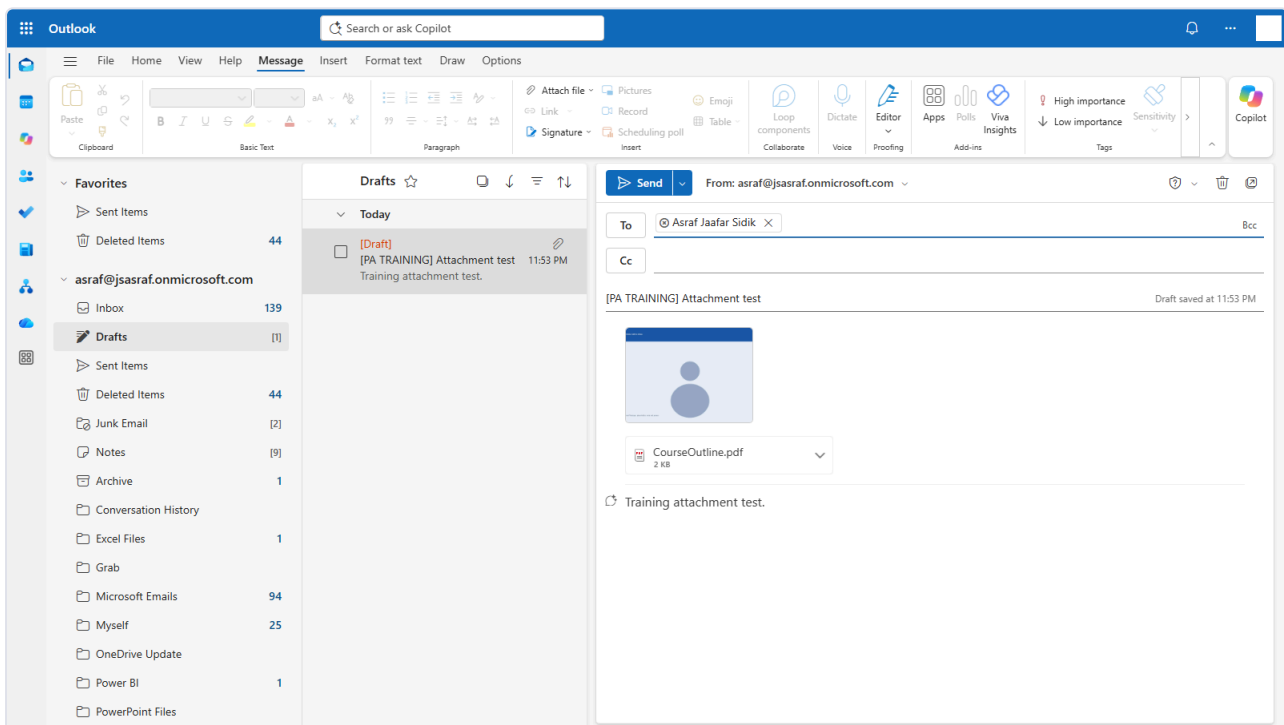
Checkpoint: The workbook is named `TrainingRegister.xlsx`, the data is a formatted table named `tblTraining`, and the table has six fictional records.

Tip: Short on time? Your trainer may tell you to use the ready-made [TrainingRegister.xlsx](#) in this folder instead. It already has the `tblTraining` table and six fictional records. Upload it to **Power Automate Training** in OneDrive. Only do this if your trainer says so.

If Power Automate can't find the table later, check three things: the workbook is in OneDrive for Business, the range is formatted as a table, and the table name is exactly `tblTraining`.

2.3 Prepare a Test Email

1. Open Outlook on the web with the training account.
2. Create a message to your own training mailbox, the one you connect to Power Automate in Chapter 3. Use the subject `[PA TRAINING] Attachment test`.
3. Attach `CourseOutline.pdf` and `TrainerPhoto.jpg` from the `test-files` folder in this chapter. **Don't send it yet.** Close the message so it's saved in Drafts.



The test email waits in Drafts until Chapter 3.

Important: Don't attach real course materials or any file whose name contains a person's name. The filename shows up in run history and in your OneDrive folder.

The Chapter 3 flow only reacts to new messages, so you send this draft during the test in section 3.6.

2.4 Confirm Forms Readiness

Open Microsoft Forms and confirm the training account can create a form. You build the **Training Request** form in Chapter 6, right before the flow that uses it. It will ask for Requester name, Course, Preferred date and Business reason, with fictional answers only.

2.5 Confirm the Teams Training Destination

Ask the trainer for the team and channel, or the training chat, and write its name down. The trainer confirms posting access before the Teams exercises: the optional extension in Chapter 4 and the approval messages in Chapter 6.

The Teams connector is standard, but your organisation may restrict posting or require the Workflows app. If you can't post a test message, tell the trainer before building the summary flow.

2.6 Confirm the Power Automate Environment

1. Return to Power Automate.
2. Check the environment selector near the top of the page.
3. Confirm it matches the environment your trainer gave you.

Key point: OneDrive files, Excel workbooks, Forms and Teams destinations aren't packaged automatically when a solution is moved. Keep a note of where each resource lives. Your trainer demonstrates moving flows in Chapter 10.

Independent Practice

Find the row in `tblTraining` whose Status is Completed. Which later reminder test should exclude it, and why? Then write a second test email without the `[PA TRAINING]` marker, save it as a draft, and predict whether the attachment flow should process it once it's sent.

Lesson Summary

You created a dedicated OneDrive training area with its folders and Excel table, prepared safe inputs for the attachment and summary exercises, confirmed the environment, and noted where the Forms and Teams work will happen. Next you build the flow that saves qualifying email attachments.

HANDS-ON

Hands-on exercises

Hover over a grey box and click the copy icon in its top-right corner. Anything marked **text** is typed or pasted straight into a field.

Folder names (text, section 2.1)

Main folder:

Power Automate Training

Subfolders:

Attachments

Reports

Workbook name (text, section 2.2)

TrainingRegister

Excel column headers (section 2.2)

Click cell A1 in Sheet1, then paste. Each header lands in its own column.

TrainingID	ParticipantName	Email	CourseTitle	SessionDate	Status
------------	-----------------	-------	-------------	-------------	--------

Table name (text, section 2.2)

tblTraining

Test email subject (text, section 2.3)

[PA TRAINING] Attachment test

03

CHAPTER 3

Save Email Attachments Automatically

Your first build: an automated flow that watches for training emails and saves only the PDF attachments to OneDrive. Everything in this chapter is point and click.

Copy-paste values: the flow name and subject filter are on the copy-paste page.

Estimated time: 90 minutes

Your result: An automated cloud flow that examines new training emails and saves only PDF attachments to OneDrive for Business.

Connectors: Office 365 Outlook and OneDrive for Business, both standard.

What You Will Learn

- Create an automated cloud flow from a business requirement
- Configure an Outlook trigger with a subject filter
- Process several attachments with **Apply to each**
- Use a condition to select PDF files
- Insert values with the **dynamic content** picker
- Test a matching and a non-matching case, then inspect run history

Before You Begin

Complete Chapter 2. Check that the `Attachments` folder exists and the test email from section 2.3 is saved in Drafts. That draft uses the subject `[PA TRAINING] Attachment test` and has two fictional attachments from the Chapter 2 [test-files](#) folder:

File	Purpose
CourseOutline.pdf	The attachment that should be saved
TrainerPhoto.jpg	The attachment that should be skipped
SessionNotes.docx	Used only in the independent practice

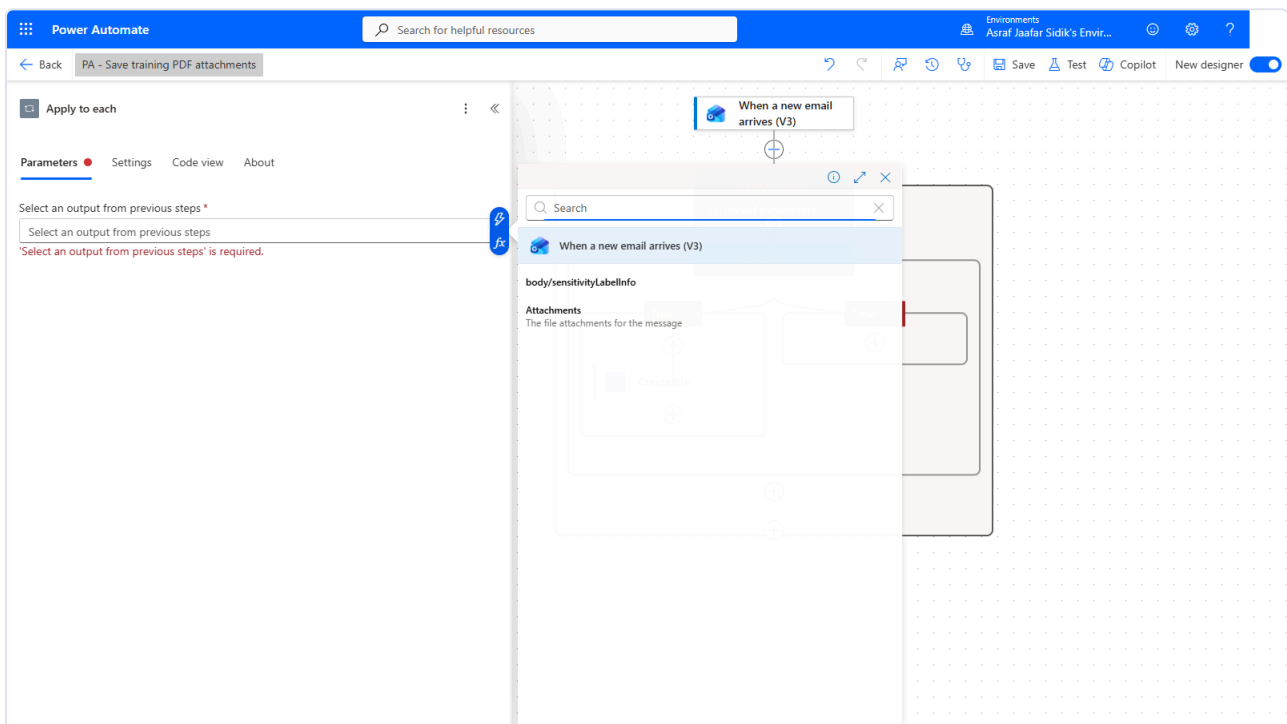
Note: OneDrive never silently overwrites a file. If you run the test twice with the same attachment, Create file either fails with a duplicate-name error or OneDrive saves `CourseOutline (1).pdf`. Both are correct behaviour. Delete the file from Attachments before a repeat test.

The rule: when a new email arrives with `[PA TRAINING]` in the subject, examine each attachment. If its name ends in `.pdf`, create a file in the Attachments folder.

How to Insert Dynamic Content

You'll do this in every chapter, so learn it once. **Dynamic content** is a value produced by an earlier step, such as an email's subject or an attachment's name.

1. Click into the field you want to fill.
2. Select the **lightning bolt** icon that appears beside the field (or type `/` and choose **Insert dynamic content**).
3. Pick the value from the list. Values are grouped under the step that produces them. Use the search box if the list is long.



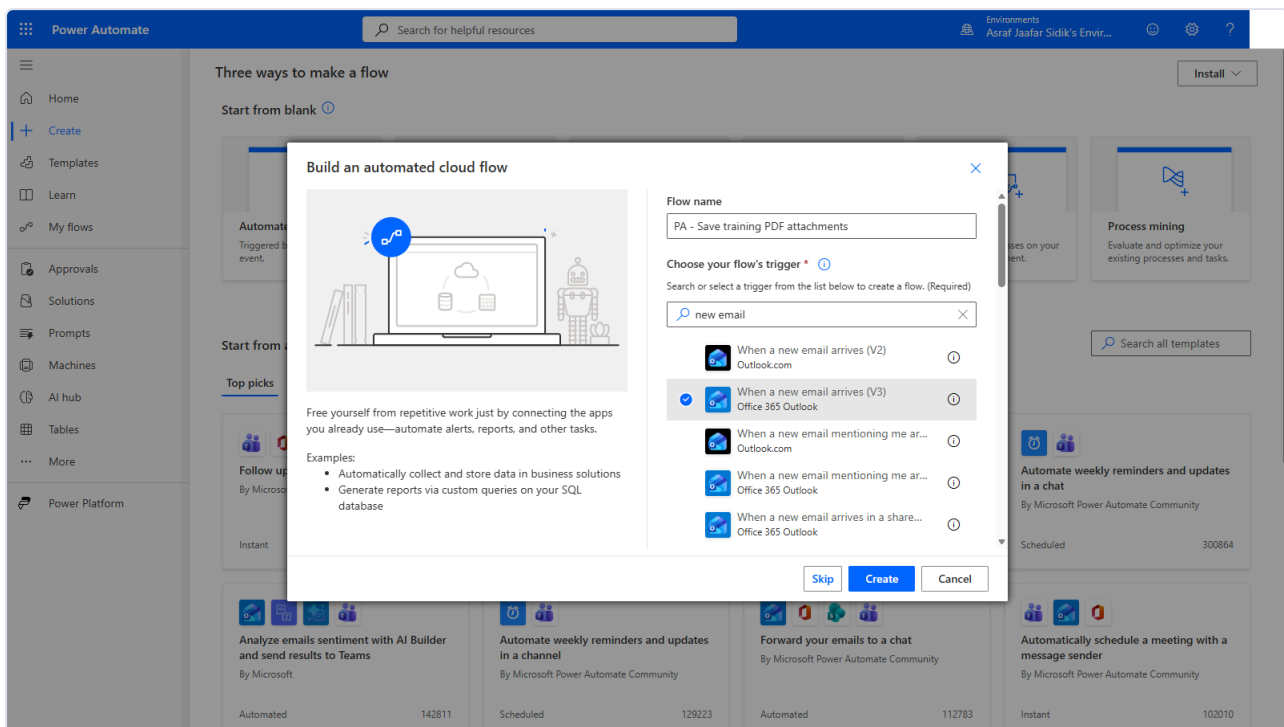
The lightning bolt opens the dynamic content picker. Values are grouped by the step that produced them.

The value appears in the field as a coloured token. To remove it, select the **x** on the token.

3.1 Create the Automated Cloud Flow

1. Open Power Automate and confirm the correct environment.
2. Select **Create**, then **Automated cloud flow**.
3. In **Flow name**, enter `PA - Save training PDF attachments`.

4. In the trigger search box, type `new email`, then select **When a new email arrives (V3)** under **Office 365 Outlook**.
5. Select **Create**. The designer opens with only the trigger on the canvas.

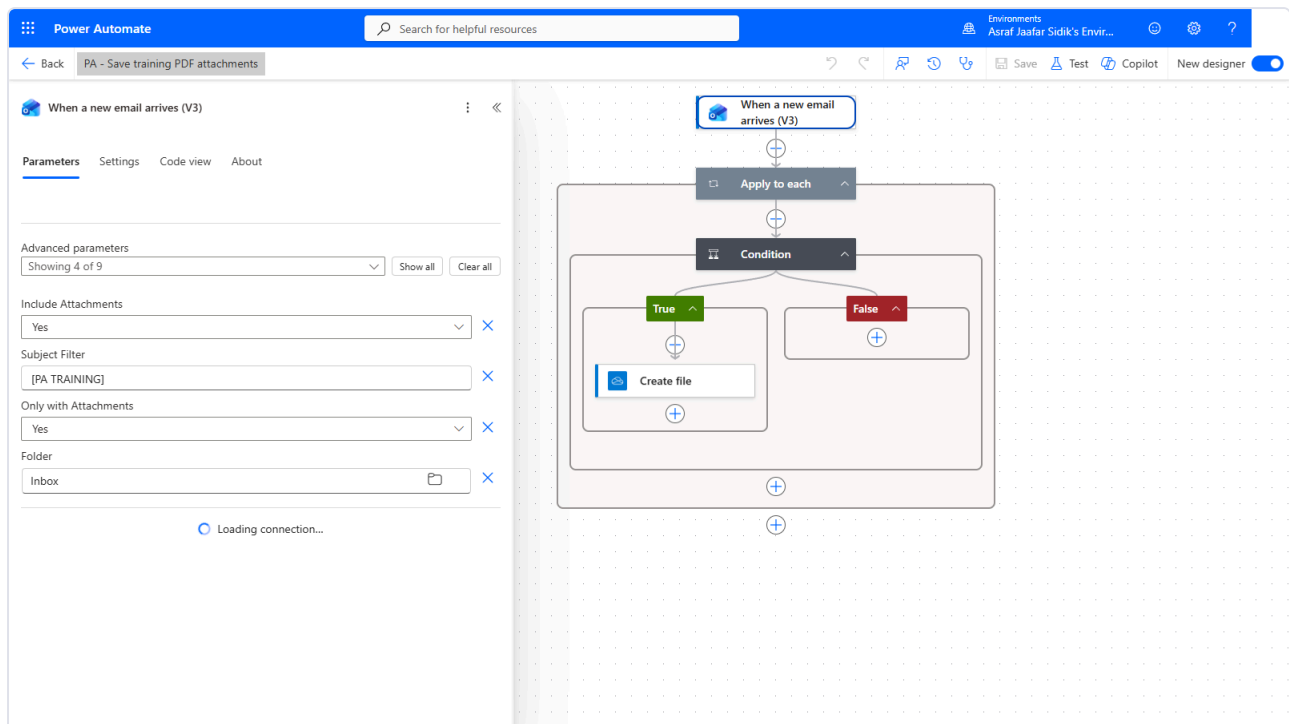


Name the flow and pick the Office 365 Outlook trigger before selecting Create.

3.2 Configure the Trigger

1. Select the trigger to open its settings.
2. Set **Include Attachments** to **Yes**.
3. Set **Folder** to **Inbox**.
4. Select **Show all** under **Advanced parameters**.
5. In **Subject Filter**, enter `[PA TRAINING]`.
6. Set **Only with Attachments** to **Yes**.

Don't save yet. Power Automate won't save a flow that has only a trigger, so you'll save once the first action is in place.

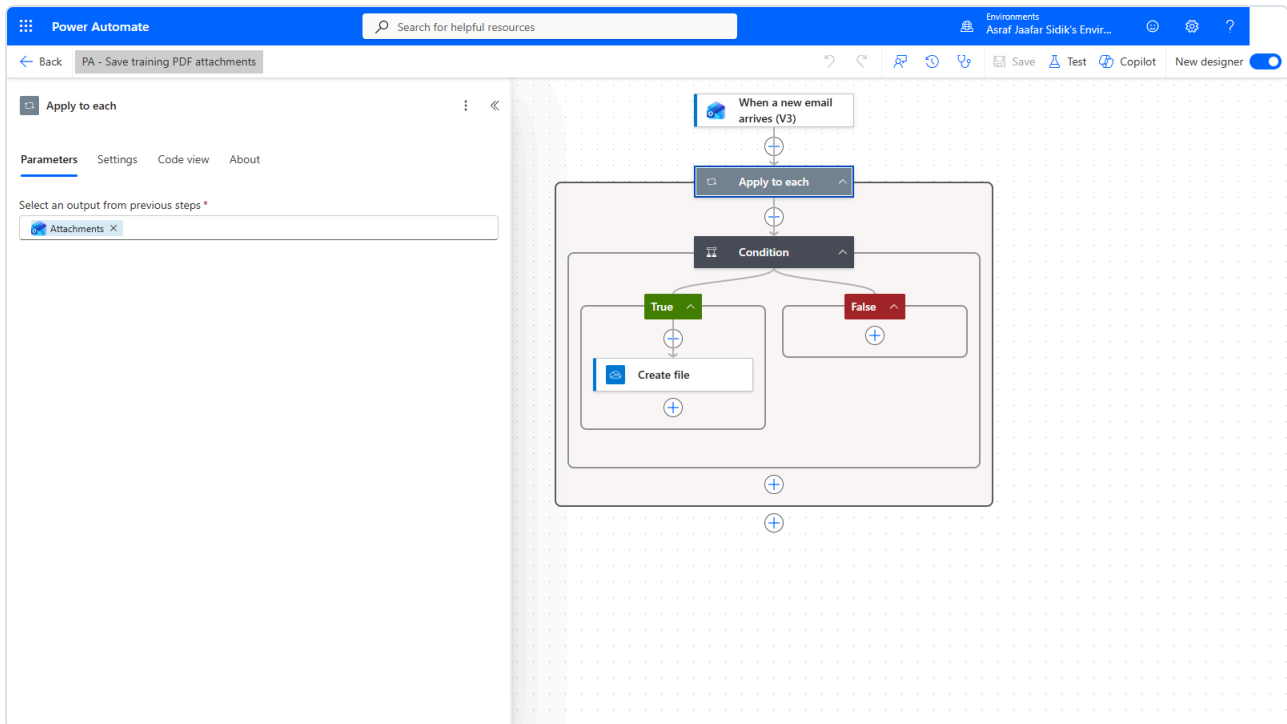


All four trigger fields set. Use Show all if a field is hidden.

Checkpoint: No field shows a red validation message. The flow only starts for new matching messages. It doesn't go back and process mail already in the inbox.

3.3 Add Apply to Each

1. Select the **+** below the trigger, then **Add an action**.
2. Search for **Apply to each** and select it (it's under **Control**).
3. Click into **Select an output from previous steps**, open the dynamic content picker, and select **Attachments** under **When a new email arrives (V3)**.

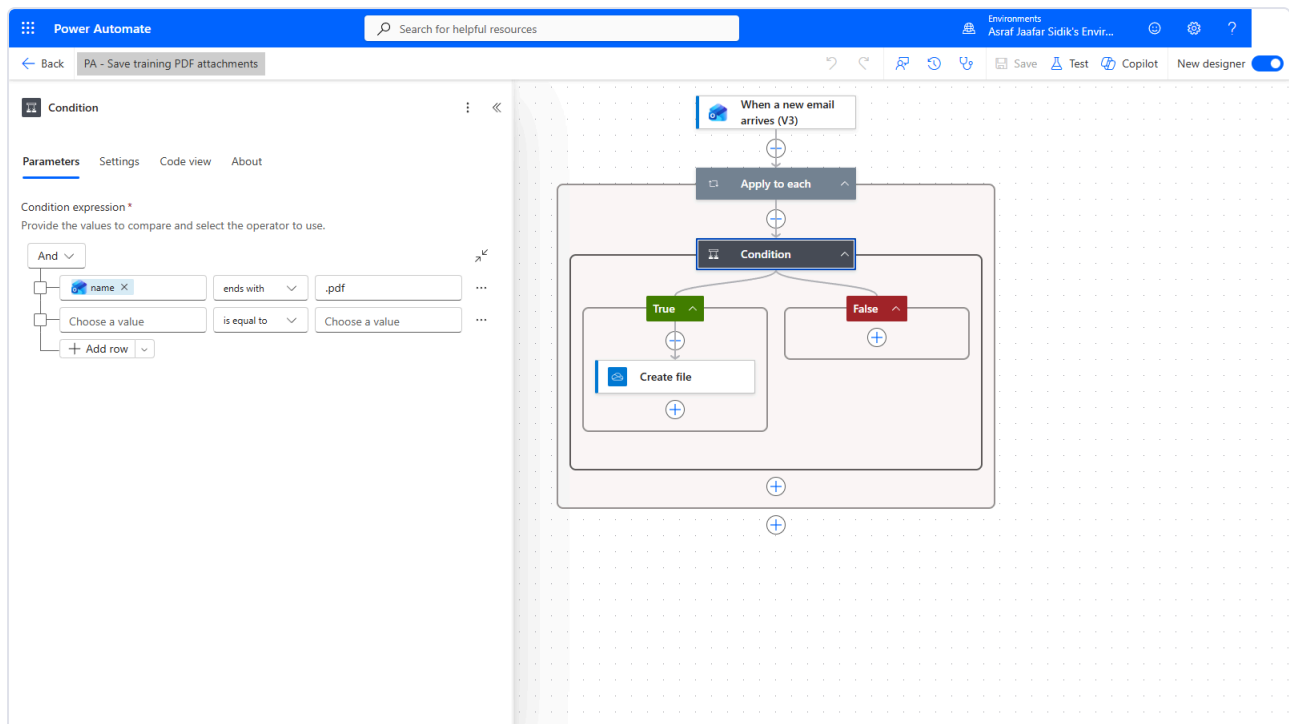


The loop runs once for every attachment in the email.

If **Attachments** isn't in the list, go back to the trigger and confirm Include Attachments is set to Yes.

3.4 Add the PDF Condition

1. Inside the loop, select **+**, then **Add an action**.
2. Search for **Condition** and select it (under **Control**).
3. Click into the left **Choose a value** box. Open the dynamic content picker and select **Attachments Name**.
4. Set the middle box to **ends with**.
5. In the right box, type **.pdf**.



The condition asks one question about the current attachment: does its name end in .pdf?

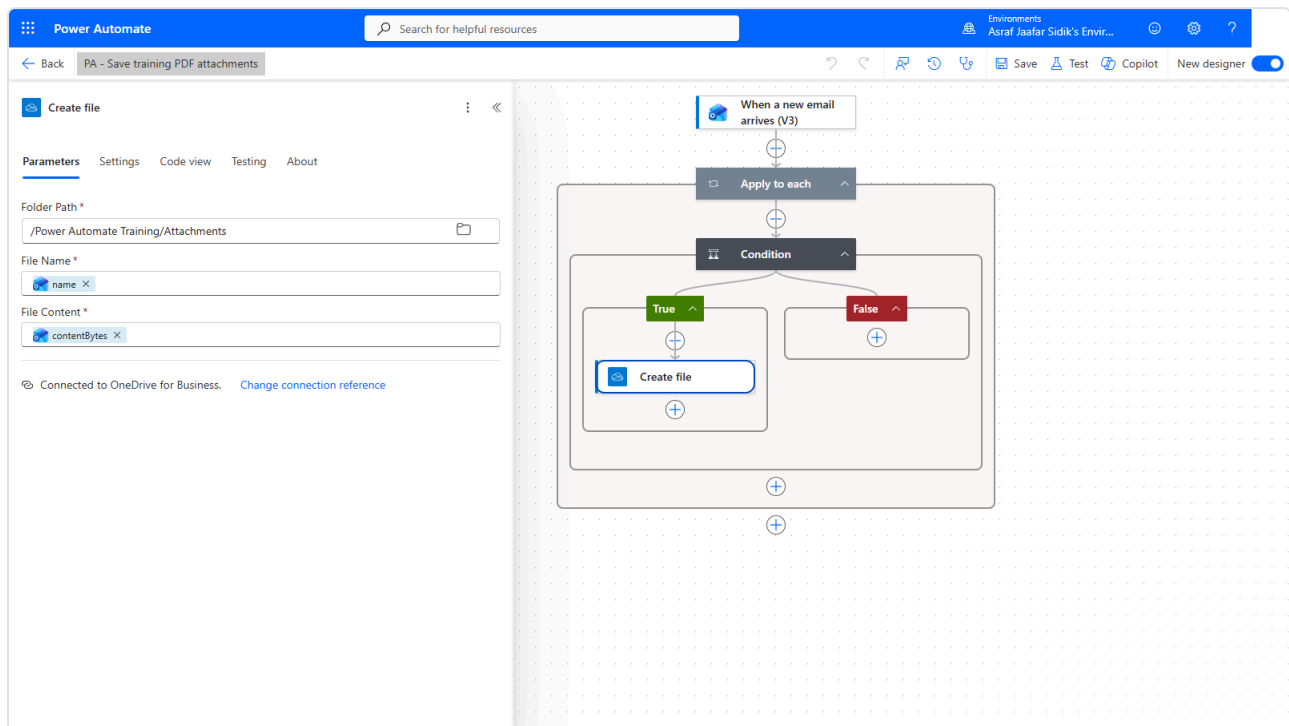
Tip: Make sure you picked **Attachments Name** (the current attachment's name), not **Subject** or another text value. Inside a loop, the "Attachments ..." values always refer to the item the loop is currently on.

3.5 Create the OneDrive File

1. In the **True** branch, select **+**, then **Add an action**.
2. Search for **OneDrive for Business**, then select **Create file** from that connector's group.

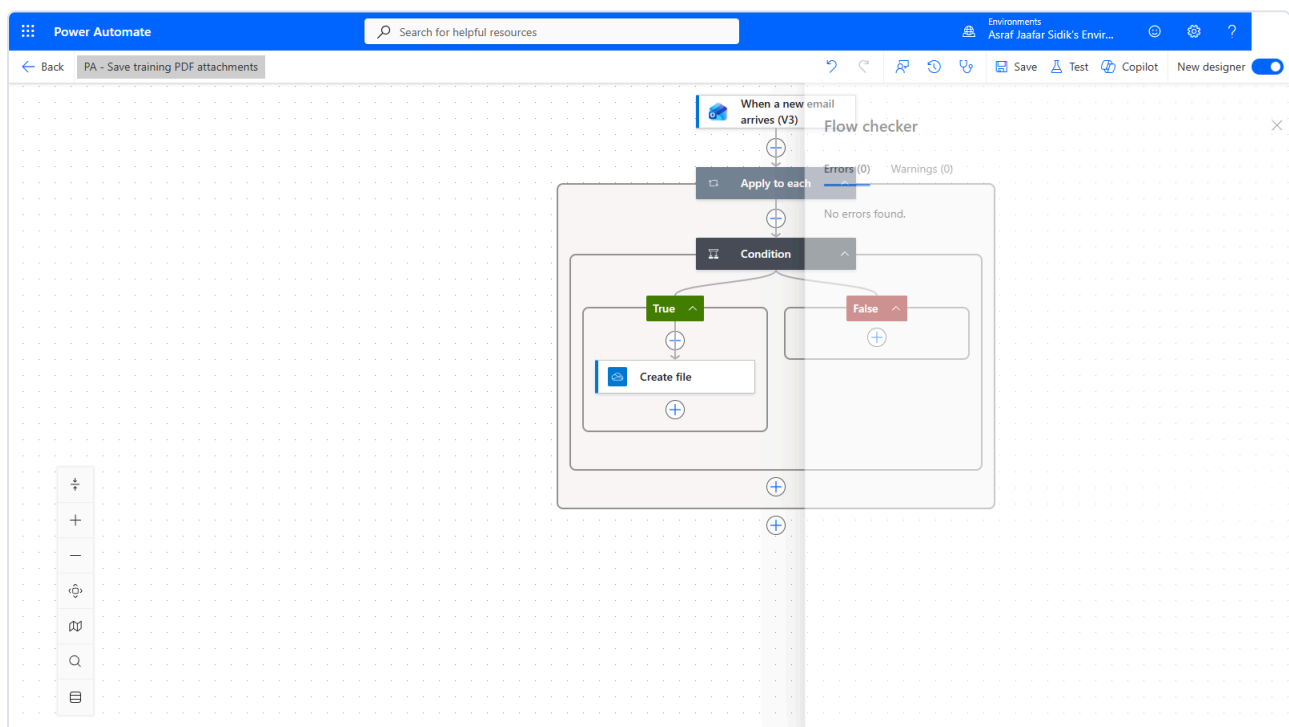
Tip: Search by connector name, not action name. Several connectors have an action called **Create file**, and it's easy to grab the wrong one.

3. In **Folder Path**, select the folder icon and browse to **Power Automate Training > Attachments**.
4. In **File Name**, insert **Attachments Name** from the dynamic content picker.
5. In **File Content**, insert **Attachments Content**.
6. Leave the **False** branch empty. That's the deliberate decision to skip non-PDF files.



Create file sits inside True. False stays empty.

7. Select **Save**, then **Flow checker**. Confirm 0 errors and 0 warnings.



The finished flow: trigger, loop, condition, and one action in True.

3.6 Test a Positive Case

1. Select **Test**, choose **Manually**, then **Test**.

2. Wait for the banner asking you to send a new email. The flow is now listening.
3. Open the draft from section 2.3 in Outlook and send it.
4. Back in Power Automate, wait for the run to finish. Every step shows a green tick.
5. Select **Apply to each**. The counter reads **2 of 2** (or 1 of 2). Select **Create file** to see that it succeeded.

Power Automate Search for helpful resources

Environments: Asraf Jaafar Sidik's Envir...

PA - Save training PDF attachments Resubmit Cancel Copilot Edit New view

✓ Your flow ran successfully.

Create file

Run results Settings Code view About

INPUTS Show raw inputs

Field	Value
apild	subscriptions/bd781310-3ad6-4677-8046-ca0...
connectionReferenceN...	shared_onedriveforbusiness
operationId	CreateFile

parameters

Field	Value
folderPath	/Power Automate Training/Attachments
name	CourseOutline.pdf
body	JVBERi0xLjQNCi9kTDQo8PC...

OUTPUTS Show raw outputs

Field	Value
statusCode	200

Flow Logic:

- When a new email arrives (V3) (0.2s ✓)
- Apply to each (1s ✓)
 - 1 of 2
 - Condition (0.6s ✓)
 - True (0.6s ✓) → Create file (0.6s ✓)
 - False (No Actions)

The run processed both attachments.

6. Open the Attachments folder in OneDrive. The PDF is there. No image file was created.

3.7 Test a Negative Case

You don't need another email. The mixed test already produced both outcomes.

1. In the same run, use the arrows on **Apply to each** to switch to the other iteration.
2. Select **Condition**. The result is **false**, Create file shows as skipped, and the False branch has nothing to run.

The image attachment took the False branch, so nothing was created.

Key point: A run can succeed while deliberately producing nothing. Succeeded means the process completed, not that every branch created an output.

Independent Practice

Change the condition to save `.docx` attachments instead of PDFs. Send one test email with both `SessionNotes.docx` and `CourseOutline.pdf`. Predict which file appears, run it, then change the condition back to `.pdf`.

Going further: your first look at an expression. Send the same PDF twice and OneDrive numbers the copy or refuses it. To give every file a unique name, replace the **File Name** token with an expression that adds the date and time in front: type `/`, choose **Insert expression**, and paste the timestamp expression from the copy-paste page. It produces names like `20260913-094512-CourseOutline.pdf`. You'll meet expressions properly in Chapters 4 and 5. Optional.

Tips and Troubleshooting

Problem	Check
The flow doesn't run	The message must be new, contain <code>[PA TRAINING]</code> in the subject, and reach the mailbox used by the Outlook connection
Attachments isn't in the dynamic content list	Turn on Include Attachments in the trigger, save, and reopen the loop

The loop runs but creates nothing

*Check the condition: left is **Attachments Name**, middle is ends with, right is `.pdf`*

Create file fails

OneDrive connection, folder path, file name and file content

Duplicate file error

Delete the old file from Attachments, or try the Going further box

The JPG is saved

Create file is outside the condition. Drag it into True

Lesson Summary

This flow combines an event trigger, a loop over attachments, a condition for the business rule and a OneDrive action for the result, all built by clicking and picking dynamic content. You tested both a file-producing path and a successful no-output path. Next, an instant flow reads the Excel table and sends a summary.

HANDS-ON

Hands-on exercises

Hover over a grey box and click the copy icon in its top-right corner. Everything in the main steps is **text**, typed or pasted straight into a field.

Flow name (text, section 3.1)

```
PA - Save training PDF attachments
```

Trigger subject filter (text, section 3.2)

```
[PA TRAINING]
```

Condition right value (text, section 3.4)

```
.pdf
```

Going further (optional)

Unique file name with a timestamp

Paste into the expression editor (type `/` in File Name, then choose **Insert expression**).

```
concat(formatDateTime(utcNow(),'yyyyMMdd-HH:mm:ss'), '-', item()?['name'])
```

`item()` means "the attachment the loop is on right now", the same thing the **Attachments Name** token points to.

04

CHAPTER 4

Create and Distribute an Excel Summary

The coordinator wants a readable list of training sessions on demand, without copying cells into an email by hand. An instant flow reads the register and sends one summary table. Along the way you write your first expression.

Copy-paste values: the flow name, subject and your first expression are on the copy-paste page.

Estimated time: 90 minutes

Your result: An instant cloud flow that reads the training register, picks useful columns, counts the rows and sends one summary email. A Teams update is an optional extension.

What You Will Learn

- Start a flow on demand with an instant trigger
- Read rows from an Excel table with **List rows present in a table**
- Choose report columns with the **Select** action
- Turn the rows into one HTML table and send it in a single email
- Write your first expression to count the rows
- Inspect run history to confirm what each action produced

How the Flow Works

Manually trigger a flow > List rows present in a table > Select > Create HTML table > Send an email (v2)

The Excel action returns a list of rows. Select keeps only the columns readers need. Create HTML table turns the whole list into one table. The email action runs once, after the table is complete.

Before You Begin

You need `Power Automate Training/TrainingRegister.xlsx` in OneDrive for Business with a formatted table named `tblTraining`:

Column	Contents	Used in this chapter for
TrainingID	TR-001 to TR-006	The independent practice
ParticipantName	Fictional names	A report column
Email	Placeholder addresses	Read but deliberately left out of the report
CourseTitle	Fictional course names	A report column
SessionDate	Real Excel dates	A report column
Status	Registered or Completed	A report column

Note: Addresses like `learner1@example.com` are just data in this chapter. `example.com` can't receive mail. The summary goes to your own training mailbox, not to the people in the table.

Tip: Before each run, finish any cell edit and let Excel save. The connector reads the saved cloud file, so an open edit gives you a stale report.

4.1 Confirm the Source Table

1. Open `TrainingRegister.xlsx` from the training folder. You built it in section 2.2, so you're only checking it here.
2. Check the header row. All six columns must be present and spelled exactly as above.
3. Select a cell in the data, open **Table Design**, and confirm the table name is exactly `tblTraining`.

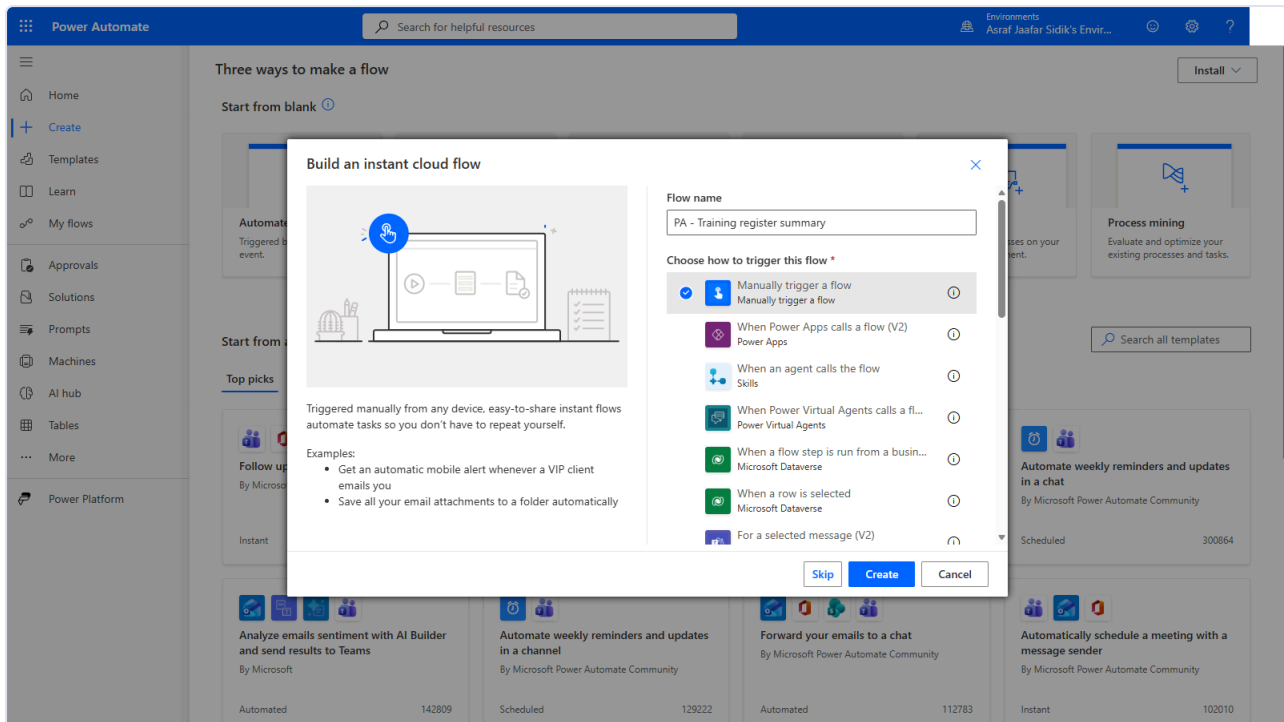
TrainingID	ParticipantName	Email	CourseTitle	SessionDate	Status
TR-001	Aisha Rahman	learner1@example.com	Power Automate Basics	9/21/2026	Registered
TR-002	Daniel Lee	learner2@example.com	Excel Reporting	9/22/2026	Registered
TR-003	Mei Chen	learner3@example.com	Microsoft Forms	9/23/2026	Completed
TR-004	Ravi Kumar	learner4@example.com	Teams Collaboration	9/24/2026	Registered
TR-005	Sofia Martinez	learner5@example.com	Approval Workflows	9/28/2026	Registered
TR-006	Noah Williams	learner6@example.com	Cloud Flow Essentials	10/5/2026	Completed
TR-007	Asraf	learner6@example.com	Power Automate Basics	9/21/2026	Completed

Select any cell in the table, then open the **Table Design** tab to see its name. The table name, not the sheet name, is what Power Automate looks for.

Key point: A worksheet name and a table name are different things. If the Table dropdown is empty later, a missing or misnamed table is almost always why.

4.2 Create an Instant Cloud Flow

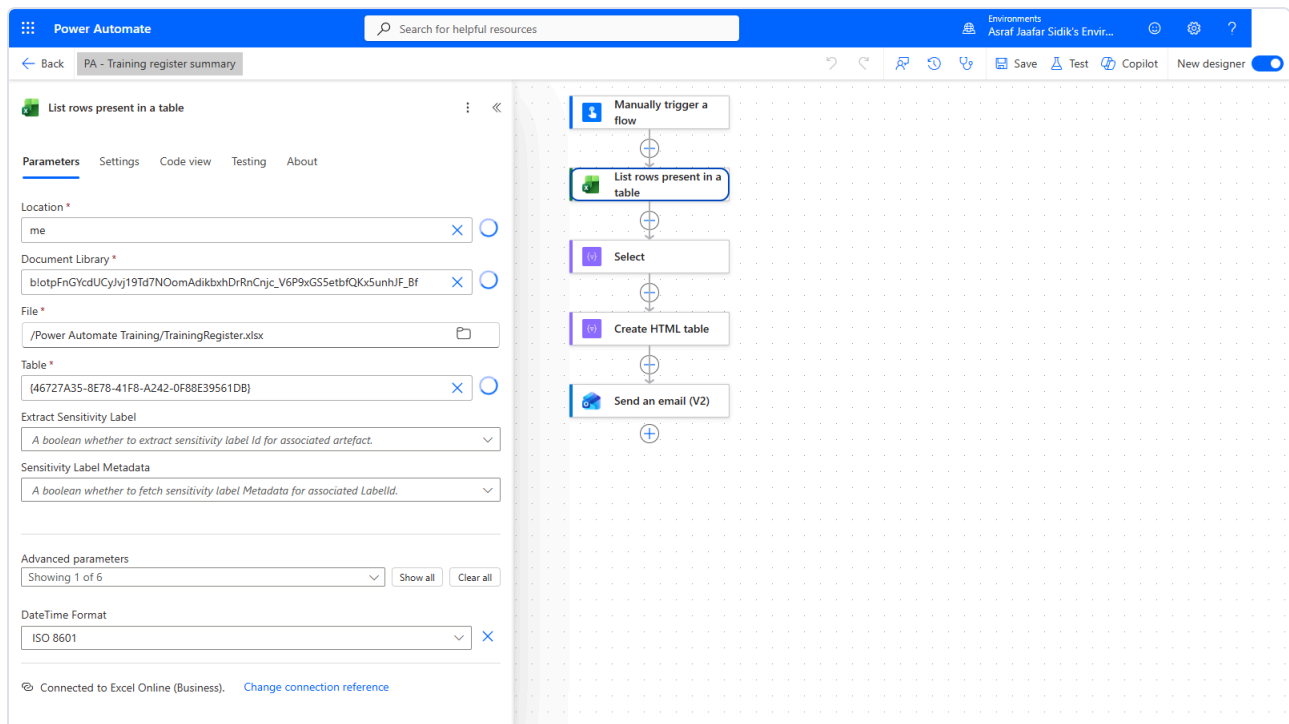
1. Confirm the training environment and select **Create > Instant cloud flow**.
2. In **Flow name**, enter **PA - Training register summary**.
3. Select **Manually trigger a flow**, then **Create**.



This trigger starts only when you run it.

4.3 Read the Excel Records

1. Select **+** below the trigger, then **Add an action**.
2. Search for *List rows present in a table* and select it under **Excel Online (Business)**.
3. Set **Location** to **OneDrive for Business**.
4. Set **Document Library** to **OneDrive**.
5. In **File**, select the folder icon and browse to *Power Automate Training > TrainingRegister.xlsx*.
6. In **Table**, select *tblTraining*.
7. Under **Advanced parameters**, select **DateTime Format** and choose **ISO 8601**. This returns dates as dates instead of serial numbers like *46286*.



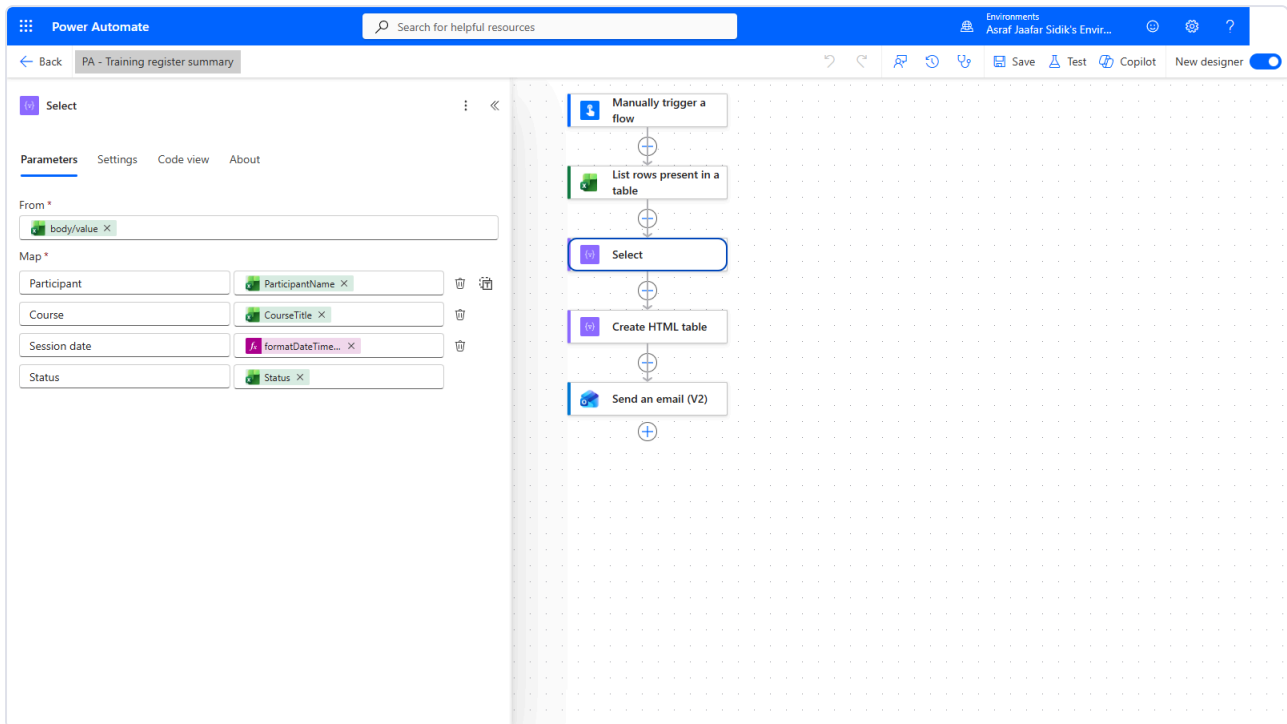
Pick the file by browsing, then the table from the dropdown.

If **Table** shows No items, stop. The workbook has no formatted table. Go back to section 2.2.

4.4 Choose the Report Columns

1. Add a **Select** action (under **Data Operation**) after the Excel action.
2. Click into **From** and insert **body/value** from List rows present in a table. This is the list of all rows. (Depending on your version it may be labelled **value**.)
3. In the **Map** area, type **Participant** in the first **Enter key** box. In its **Enter value** box, insert **ParticipantName** from the dynamic content picker.
4. Add three more rows the same way:

Enter key	Enter value (dynamic content)
Participant	ParticipantName
Course	CourseTitle
Session date	SessionDate
Status	Status

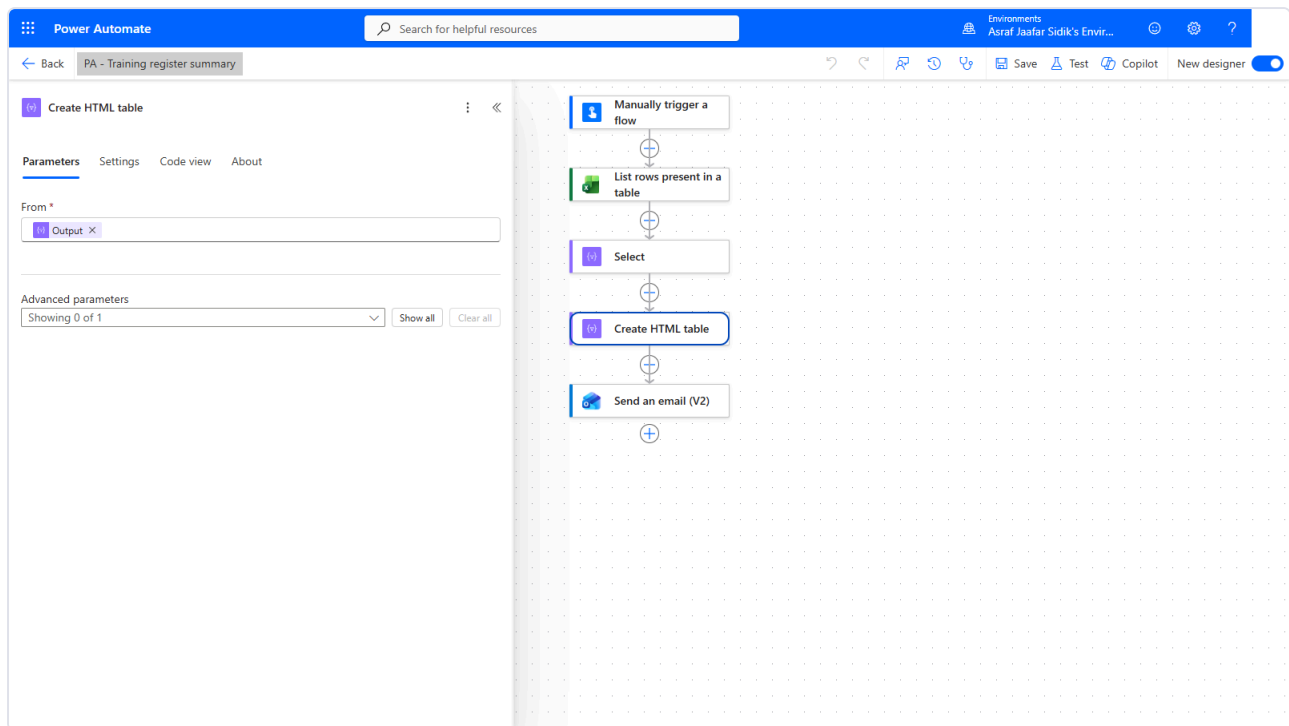


Each key becomes a column heading. Email and the internal row data are left out. (This screenshot's Session date already uses the date format from the Going further box. Yours shows a plain SessionDate token.)

Select handles every row for you, so you don't need an Apply to each here.

4.5 Build One HTML Table

1. Add **Create HTML table** (under **Data Operation**) after Select.
2. In **From**, insert **Output** from Select.
3. Leave **Columns** on **Automatic**. Select already defined the headings.

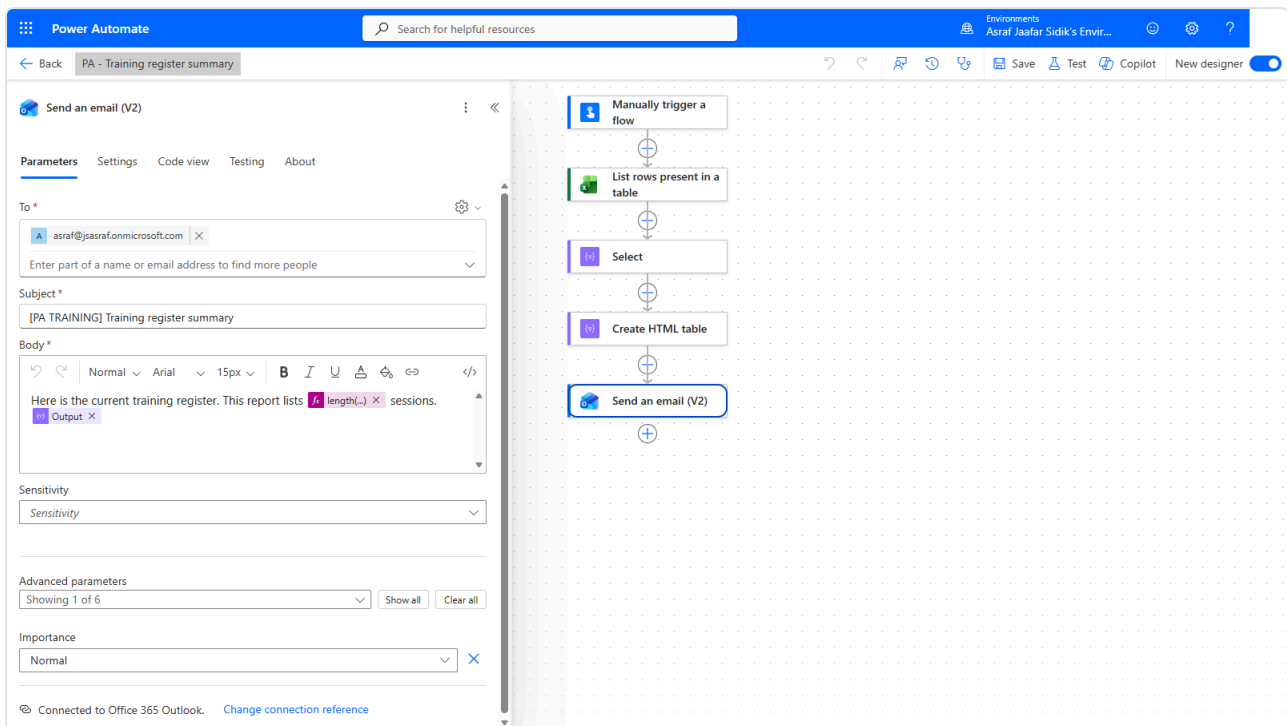


The whole list goes in, one table comes out.

Checkpoint: If an *Apply to each* suddenly wraps this action, you picked a single column instead of the whole **Output**. Delete the loop and pick **Output** again.

4.6 Send the Coordinator Summary

1. Add **Send an email (V2)** under **Office 365 Outlook** after **Create HTML table**.
2. In **To**, enter your own training email address.
3. In **Subject**, enter `[PA TRAINING] Training register summary`.
4. In **Body**, type `Here is the current training register.` then press Enter.
5. Insert **Output** from **Create HTML table** on the next line.

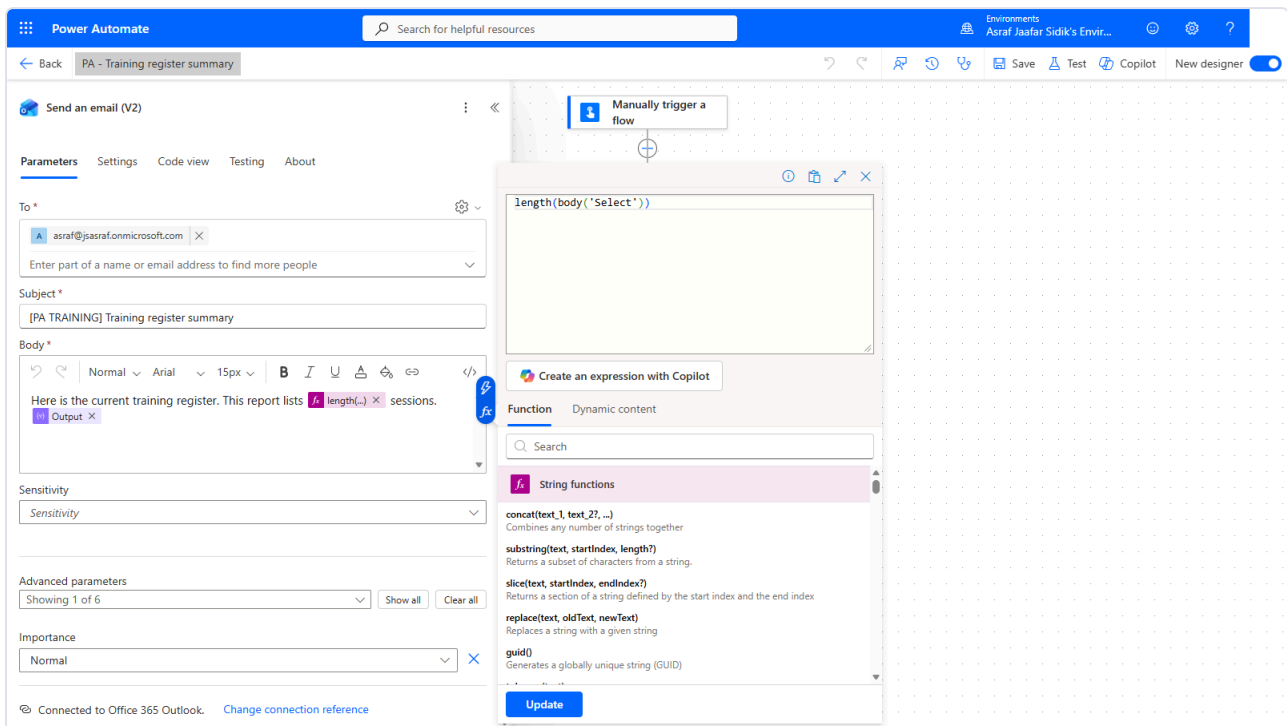


The table token goes in the body below a short introduction.

4.7 Your First Expression: Count the Rows

The coordinator wants a line like "This report lists 6 sessions." None of the dynamic content values is a count. Dynamic content gives you values that already exist. When you need a value calculated, you write an **expression**.

1. In the email **Body**, click at the end of the introduction line and type `This report lists` (with spaces).
2. Type `/` and choose **Insert expression**.
3. In the expression box, type `length(`
4. Switch to the **Dynamic content** tab in the same panel and select **Output** under **Select**. It drops into the expression.
5. Type `)` to close the bracket, then select **Add**.
6. After the new token, type `sessions.`

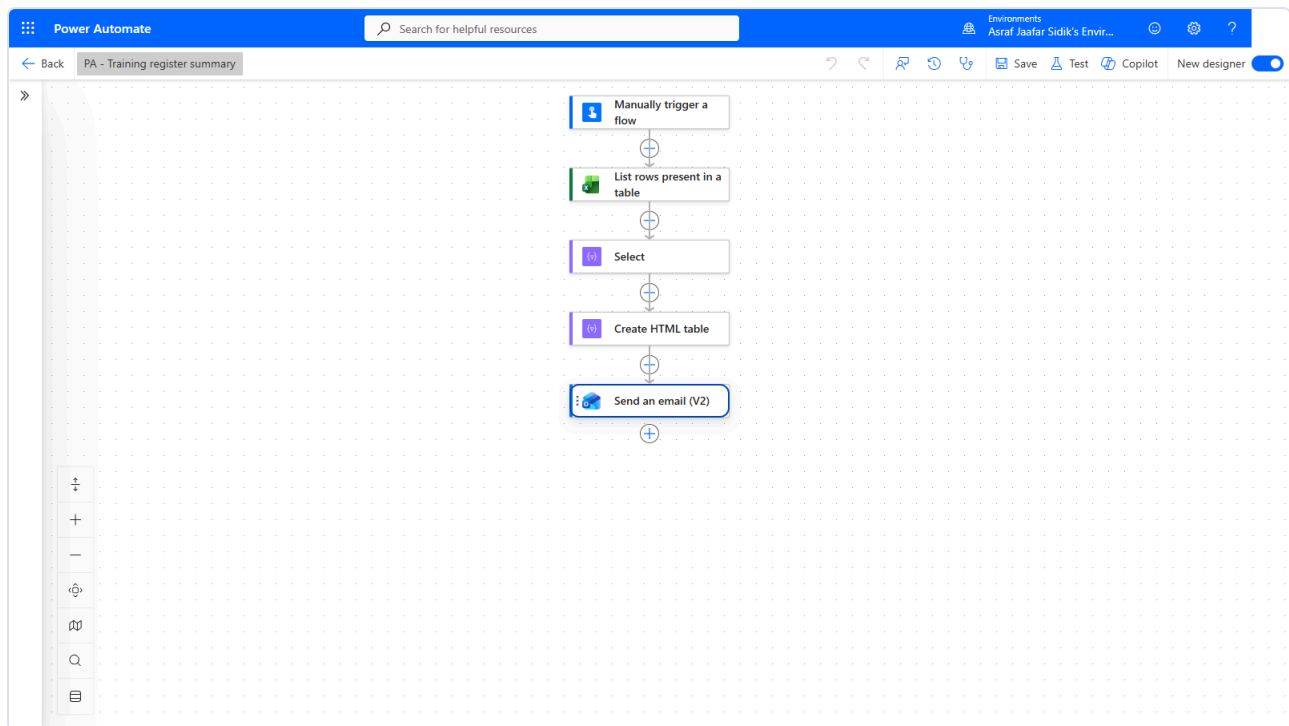


length() counts the items in a list. Here it counts the rows Select produced.

The expression reads `length(body('Select'))`. You can also paste it from the copy-paste page. `length()` is a **function**: you give it something inside the brackets and it gives back an answer.

Tip: If you renamed the Select action, the name inside the quotes changes too. Picking Output from the Dynamic content tab handles that for you, which is why step 4 picks it instead of typing it.

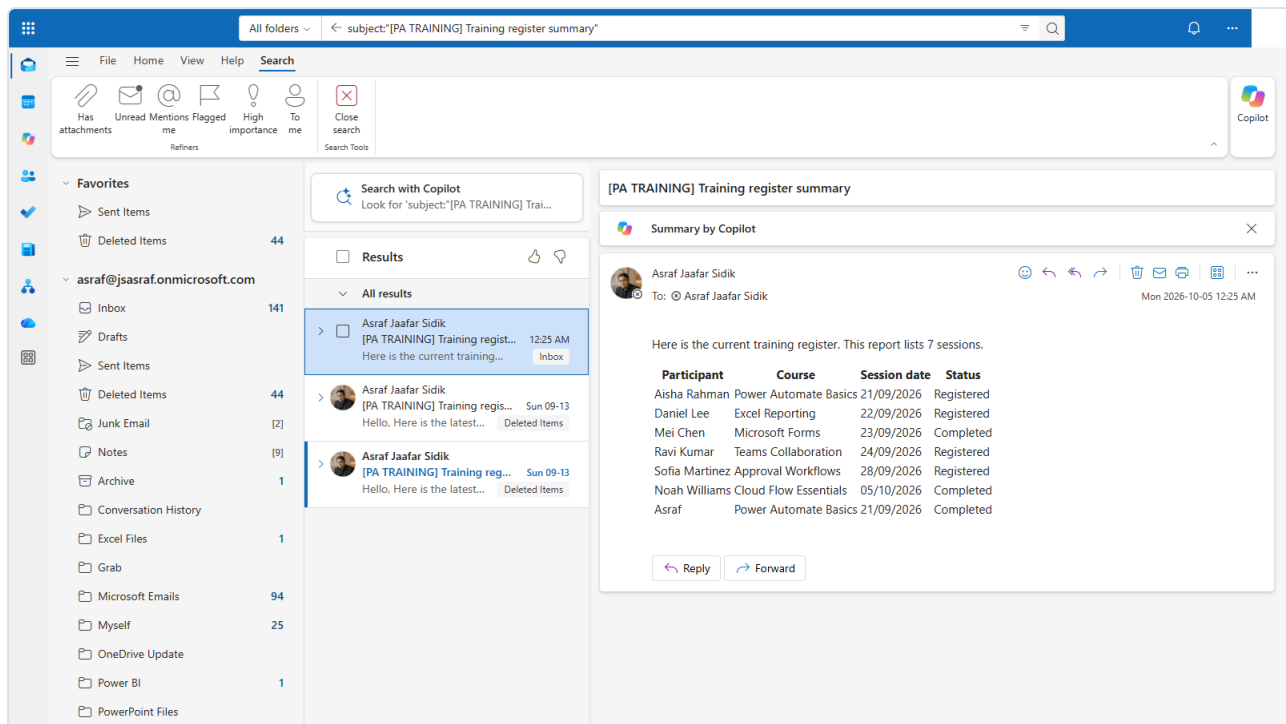
7. Select **Save**, then **Flow checker**, and fix anything it reports.



Five steps. One email.

4.8 Test and Inspect

1. Select **Test** > **Manually** > **Test**, then **Run flow**. This sends a real email to you, so follow your trainer's instruction first.
2. Open the completed run. Every action has a green tick, and **Send an email (V2)** ran once.
3. Select **Select** and then **Show raw outputs**. You see six records with real names and courses.
4. Open the email. You should see the sentence *This report lists 6 sessions.*, four headings, and six rows. The number always matches the rows in your table, so if you added a row it goes up too.



One email, one table, counted by your first expression. This workbook had a seventh test row, so it reads 7.

Each manual run sends one current report. Earlier emails stay as historical snapshots.

4.9 Optional Teams Update

Trainer-led only, once a permitted destination is confirmed. After the email, add **Microsoft Teams > Post message in a chat or channel**, choose **Flow bot** and **Chat with Flow bot**, pick yourself as the recipient, and post a short message such as Training register summary sent. Keep it short. Teams doesn't show the email's HTML table the same way.

Independent Practice

Add Training ID to the report without adding Email. Predict where the change belongs, make it, and check the received message. Then explain why a six-record table still produces only one email.

Going further: format the date. The Session date column shows values like 2026-09-21T00:00:00.000Z. In Chapter 5 you'll learn the `formatDateTime()` expression that turns it into 21 Sep 2026. Come back afterwards and use it in Select's **Session date** value. Optional.

Troubleshooting

Symptom	What to check
No Excel table is listed	Workbook location, saved table, table name and connector account

<i>One email arrives for every row</i>	<i>The email ended up inside a loop. Use Output from Create HTML table</i>
<i>The report includes internal columns</i>	<i>Use Select to define headings and values</i>
<i>The email shows HTML tags</i>	<i>Check you inserted Output from Create HTML table, not from Select</i>
<i>A date appears as a number</i>	<i>Set DateTime Format to ISO 8601 in List rows present in a table</i>
<i>The expression shows an error</i>	<i>Brackets must match: <code>length(...)</code>. Pick Output from the Dynamic content tab instead of typing it</i>
<i>The report is stale</i>	<i>Finish the Excel edit, wait for save, and run again</i>

Lesson Summary

An instant trigger lets the coordinator decide when to run. Excel supplies the records, Select defines the report columns, Create HTML table produces one report, and your first expression counted the rows. Next, a recurrence trigger starts a reminder process on a schedule.

For reference, see the [Excel Online \(Business\) connector](#) and [data operations in Power Automate](#).

HANDS-ON

Hands-on exercises

Hover over a grey box and click the copy icon in its top-right corner. Anything marked **text** is typed or pasted straight into a field.

Flow name (text, section 4.2)

```
PA - Training register summary
```

Select keys (text, section 4.4)

Type each key, then insert the matching column from dynamic content as its value.

```
Participant
```

```
Course
```

```
Session date
```

```
Status
```

Email subject (text, section 4.6)

```
[PA TRAINING] Training register summary
```

Email introduction (text, section 4.6)

```
Here is the current training register.
```

Your first expression: count the rows (section 4.7)

Type `/` in the Body, choose **Insert expression**, paste, then select **Add**. Works if the Select action still has its default name.

```
length(body('Select'))
```

05

CHAPTER 5

Send Weekly Training Reminders

Every week the coordinator opens the register and writes the same reminder for each participant. A scheduled flow can do that at a predictable local time.

Copy-paste values: the flow name, email text and the date expression are on the copy-paste page.

Estimated time: 75 minutes

Your result: A scheduled cloud flow that runs every Monday at 9:00 AM Malaysia time, reads the training register, and prepares one personalised reminder email for each row.

What You Will Learn

- Schedule a flow with the **Recurrence** trigger and a local time zone
- Convert the current time into readable local time
- Loop through Excel rows with **Apply to each**
- Build a personalised email by typing text and inserting dynamic content
- Use a second expression, `formatDateTime()`, to make a date readable

How the Flow Works

Recurrence > Current time > Convert time zone > List rows present in a table > Apply to each > Send an email (V2)

Recurrence decides when the flow starts. Current time and Convert time zone produce a readable local timestamp for the message. The Excel action returns the rows, and Apply to each handles them one at a time.

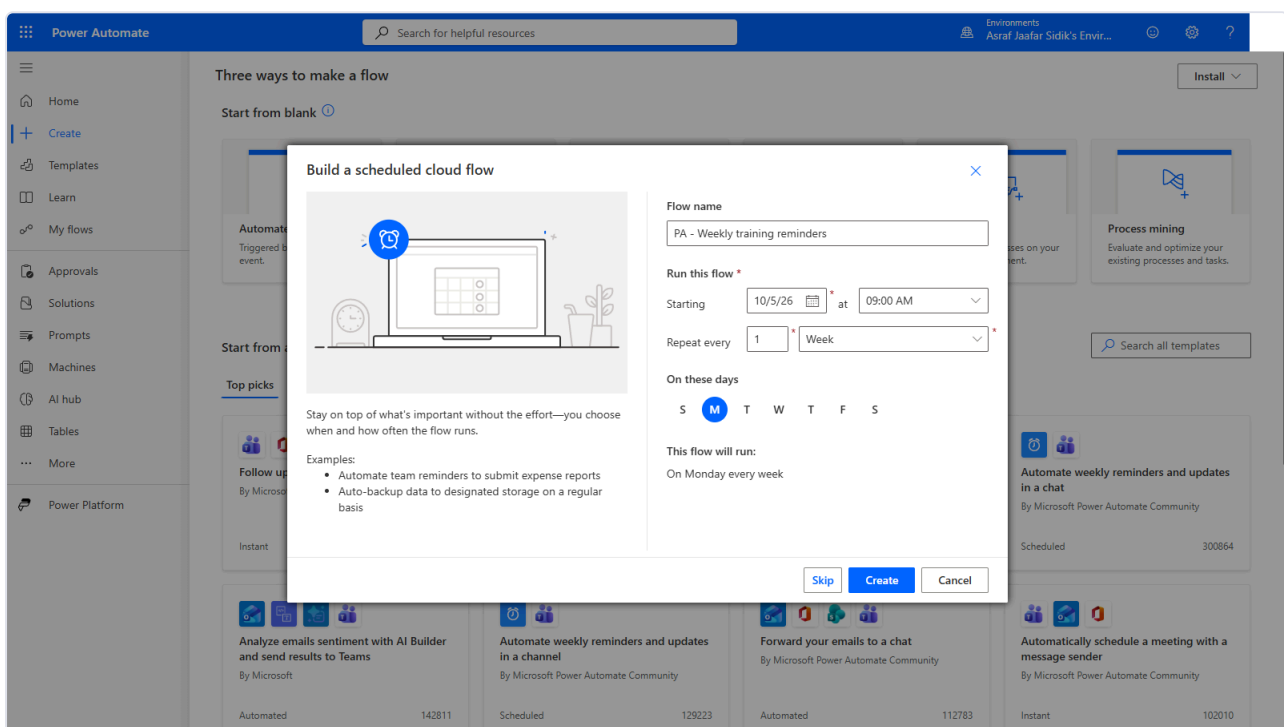
Before You Begin

You need `Power Automate Training/TrainingRegister.xlsx` with the `tblTraining` table. This chapter uses every column: `ParticipantName` for the greeting, `Email` as the recipient, `CourseTitle` in the subject and body, `SessionDate` and `Status` in the body.

Important: The sample register uses addresses like `learner1@example.com`. They can't receive mail, which is what you want while learning. Replace them with trainer-approved addresses only when the trainer authorises a live test.

5.1 Create the Weekly Schedule

1. Select **Create** > **Scheduled cloud flow**.
2. In **Flow name**, enter `PA - Weekly training reminders`.
3. Set **Repeat every** to **1 Week**, tick **M** (Monday), and set the start time to **9:00 AM**. Your starting date will differ.
4. Select **Create**.



The dialog creates the Recurrence trigger for you.

5. Select **Recurrence** and check these values. Open **Advanced parameters** > **Show all** to see the time zone fields.

Setting	Value
Interval	1
Frequency	Week
Time zone	(UTC+08:00) Kuala Lumpur, Singapore
On these days	Monday
At these hours	9

At these minutes

0

The screenshot displays the Power Automate 'Recurrence' configuration window. The 'Parameters' tab is selected, showing the following settings:

- Interval:** 1
- Frequency:** Week
- Time zone:** (UTC+08:00) Kuala Lumpur, Singapore
- Start time:** 2026-10-12T01:00:00.000Z
- On these days:** Monday
- At these hours:** 9
- At these minutes:** 0

The preview at the bottom indicates: "Runs at 9:00 on Monday every week".

The flow canvas on the right shows the following steps:

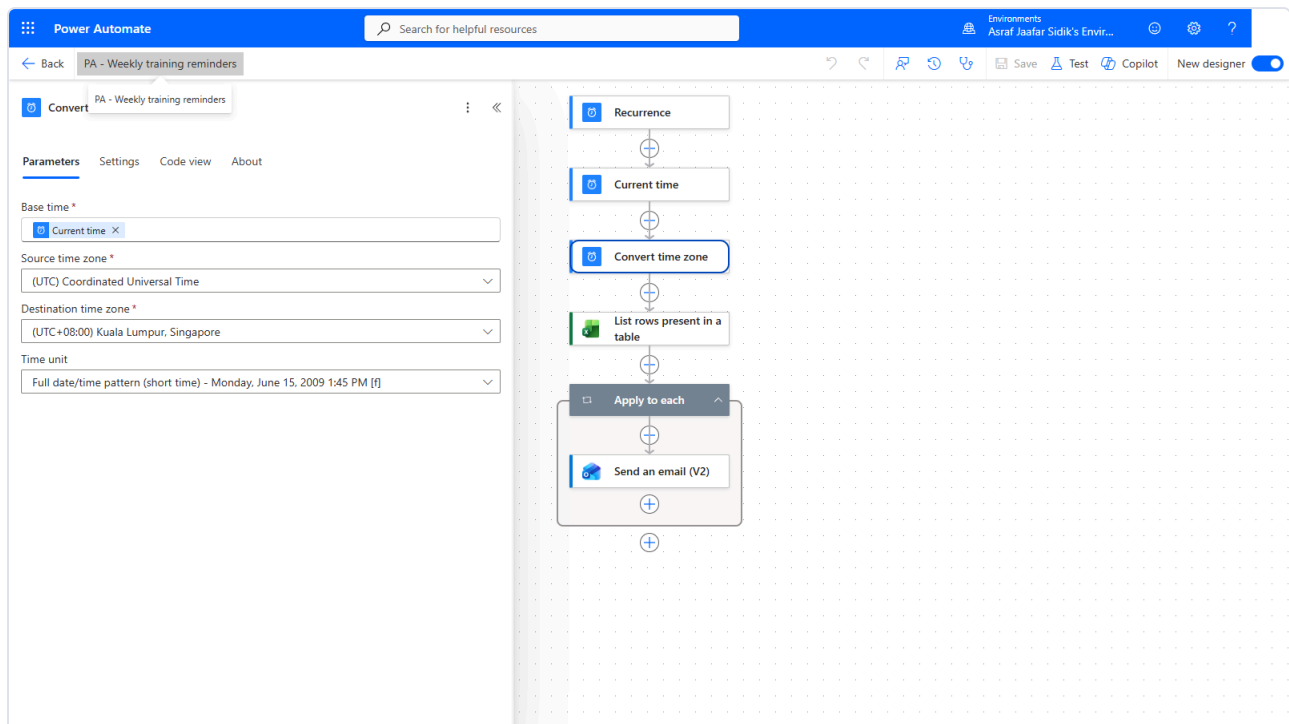
- Recurrence
- Current time
- Convert time zone
- List rows present in a table
- Apply to each (loop)
 - Send an email (V2)

Read the preview line at the bottom. It should say 9:00 on Monday every week.

5.2 Produce a Readable Local Timestamp

1. Below Recurrence, add **Current time** (under **Date Time**). It needs no settings.
2. Add **Convert time zone** (under **Date Time**) and set:

Setting	Value
Base time	Current time from dynamic content
Source time zone	(UTC) Coordinated Universal Time
Destination time zone	(UTC+08:00) Kuala Lumpur, Singapore
Format string (may be labelled Time unit)	Full date/time pattern (short time)



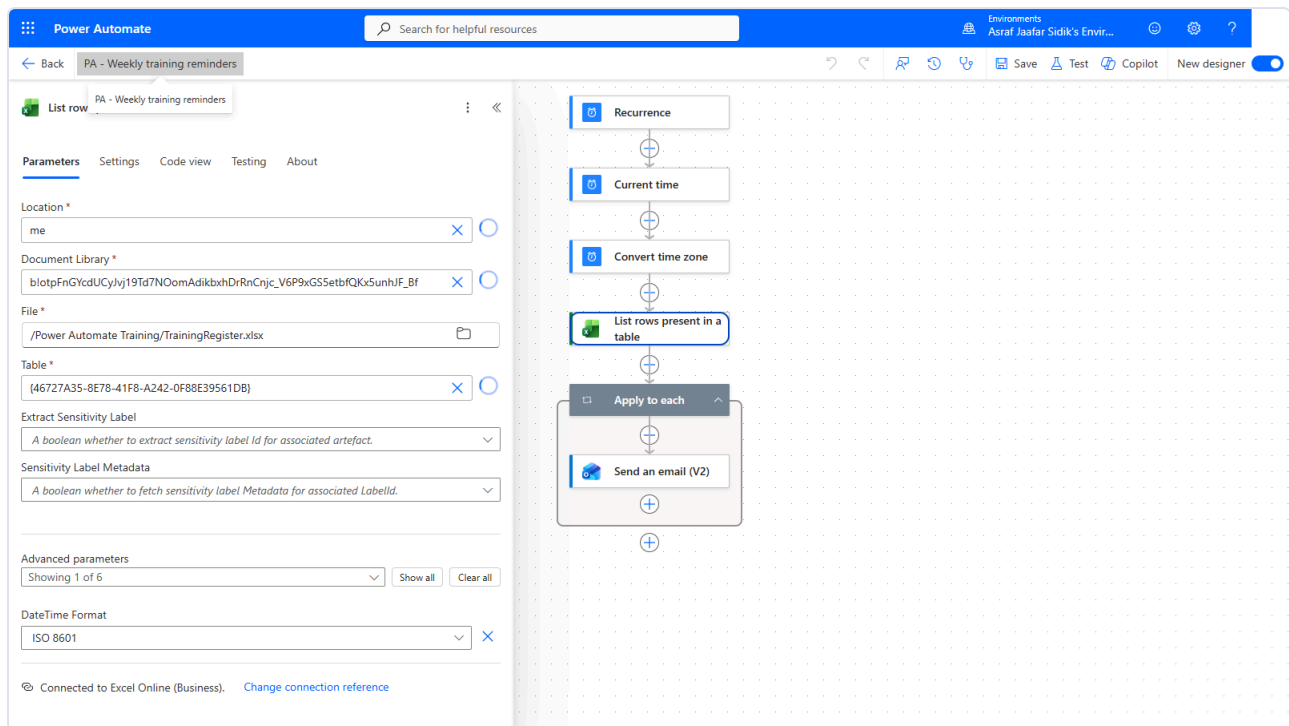
Pick the format from the dropdown. No expression needed.

Key point: The two time zone settings do different jobs. Recurrence decides when the flow starts. Convert time zone only changes a timestamp shown in the message.

5.3 Read the Excel Rows

Add **List rows present in a table** (Excel Online (Business)) and set it exactly as in Chapter 4: OneDrive for Business, OneDrive, `/Power Automate Training/TrainingRegister.xlsx`, `tblTraining`, and **DateTime Format** set to **ISO 8601**.

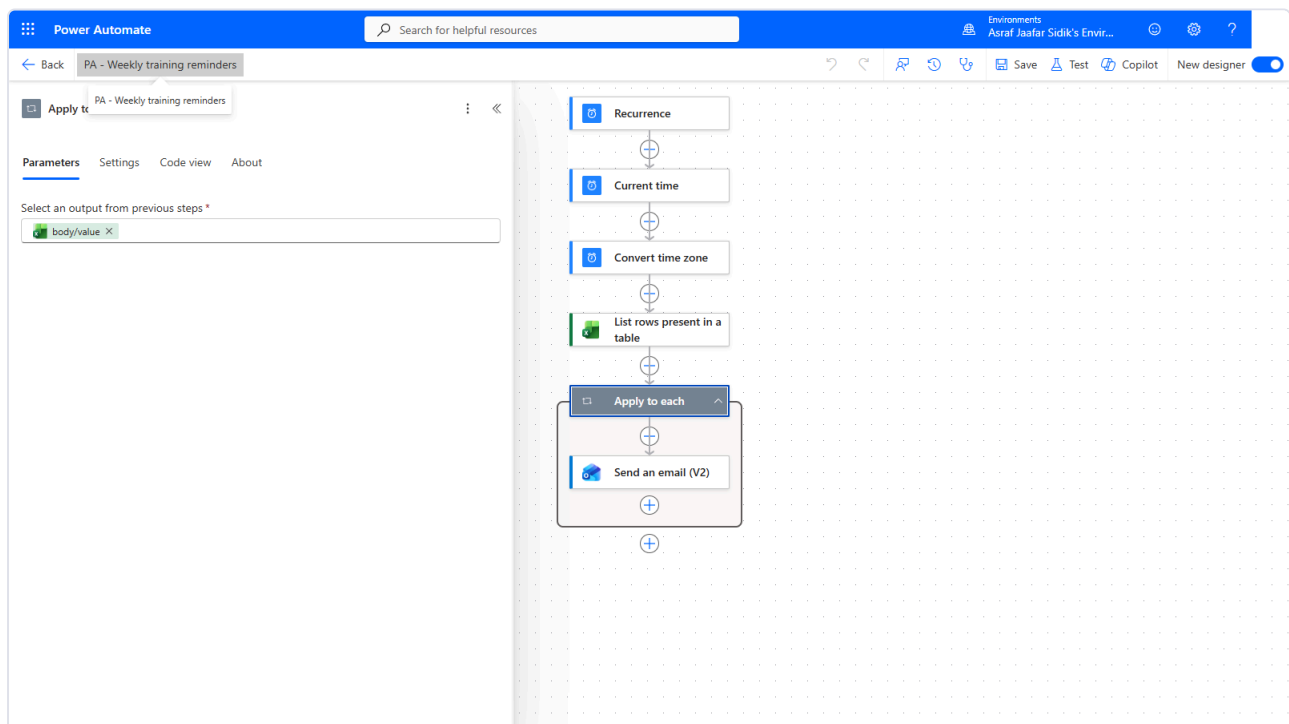
Tip: In the file browser, clicking a folder's name selects it but doesn't open it. Select the **>** arrow on the right of `Power Automate Training` to go inside, then pick the workbook.



Same settings as Chapter 4.

5.4 Process One Row at a Time

1. Add **Apply to each** (under **Control**).
2. In **Select an output from previous steps**, insert **body/value** (or **value**) from List rows present in a table.



The loop runs once per row in the table.

Checkpoint: The input must be the whole list (**value**). A single column such as Email isn't a list of rows.

5.5 Prepare the Reminder Email

Inside Apply to each, add **Send an email (V2)** (Office 365 Outlook).

1. **To:** this field opens a people picker. Select the small **settings** (gear) icon beside it and choose **Use dynamic content**, then insert **Email**.
2. **Subject:** type `[PA TRAINING] Reminder:` then insert **CourseTitle**.
3. **Body:** type the message and insert the values where they belong:

Hello **[ParticipantName]**,

This is your weekly training reminder.

Course: **[CourseTitle]**

Session date: **[SessionDate]**

Status: **[Status]**

Reminder generated: **[Converted time]**

Please contact the training coordinator if your plans change.

Each **[bold name]** is a dynamic content token. **Converted time** comes from Convert time zone. The rest come from List rows present in a table.

The screenshot displays the Microsoft Power Automate interface. On the left, the 'Send an email (V2)' action is configured with the following details:

- To:** Email (with a settings gear icon)
- Subject:** [PA TRAINING] Reminder: CourseTitle
- Body:**

Hello [ParticipantName],

This is your weekly training reminder.

Course: [CourseTitle]

Session date: [formatDateTime...]

Status: [Status]

Reminder generated: [Converted time]

Please contact the training coordinator if your plans change.
- Sensitivity:** Sensitivity
- Advanced parameters:** Showing 1 of 6

On the right, the flow steps are visible:

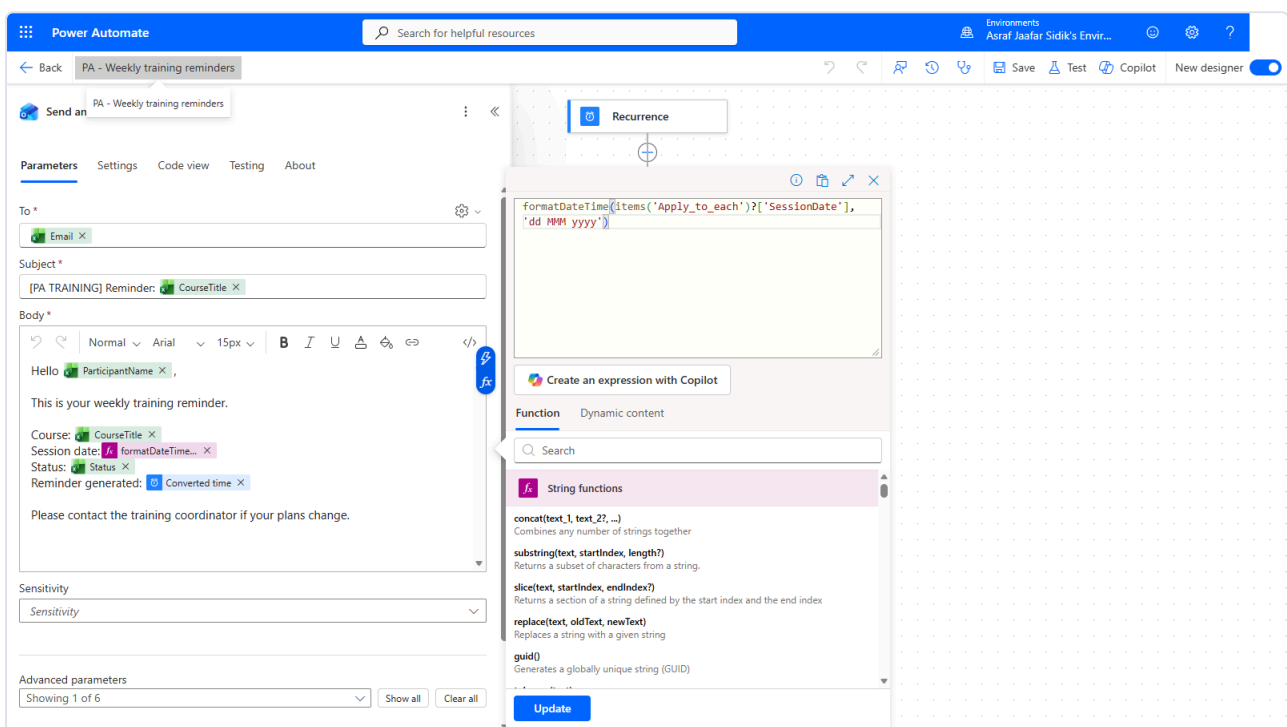
- Recurrence
- Current time
- Convert time zone
- List rows present in a table
- Apply to each (containing the 'Send an email (V2)' action)

Type the words, insert the tokens. The email reads like a normal message.

5.6 Make the Date Readable with an Expression

Run the flow now and the session date reads `2026-09-21T00:00:00.000Z`. That's correct, but nobody wants to read it. There's no dynamic content value for "the date, written nicely", so this is a job for an expression.

1. In the body, select the **x** on the **SessionDate** token to remove it, leaving the cursor where it was.
2. Type `/` and choose **Insert expression**.
3. Type `formatDateTime(`
4. Switch to the **Dynamic content** tab and select **SessionDate**.
5. Type `, 'dd MMM yyyy')` and select **Add**.

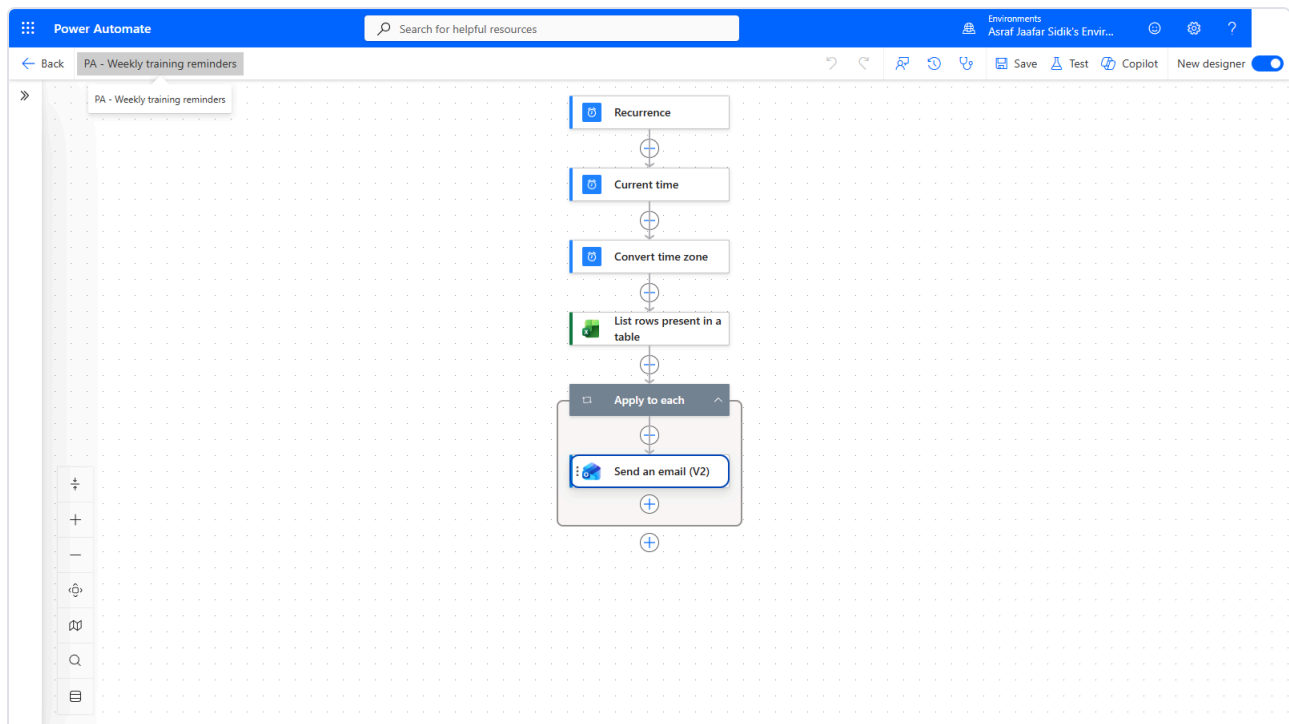


`formatDateTime()` takes a date and a pattern, and gives back the date written in that pattern.

The finished expression is on the copy-paste page if you'd rather paste it. The pattern `dd MMM yyyy` means two-digit day, short month name, four-digit year, so `21 Sep 2026`.

Tip: Compare this with Chapter 4. `length()` counted a list, `formatDateTime()` reshapes a date. Both follow the same shape: a function name, then what you give it in brackets.

6. Select **Save**, open **Flow checker**, and fix any error.



Recurrence, Current time, Convert time zone, List rows, and the loop with its email.

Trainer-Controlled Test

Important: Don't select Test while the workbook still has `example.com` placeholders. A test sends one email per row, so six messages with the sample data. The trainer confirms the recipients and authorises the run immediately before you select Run flow.

After an authorised test, check the run history:

- Every step before the loop succeeded
- Apply to each shows six iterations
- Each email used that row's Email, CourseTitle and Status, and the date reads like `21 Sep 2026`
- The reminder timestamp is in Malaysia time

In this version every row gets a reminder, including Completed ones. Chapter 7 fixes that.

Independent Practice

Change the scheduled hour to a value your trainer gives you, read the Recurrence preview, then set it back to 9:00. Explain why changing Convert time zone wouldn't change when the flow starts.

Going further: try other date patterns. Change `'dd MMM yyyy'` to `'dddd, d MMMM'` and the date reads Monday, 21 September. You can also go back to Chapter 4 and use the same expression in Select's **Session date** value. Optional.

Troubleshooting

Symptom	What to check
The flow starts at the wrong local time	Recurrence time zone, day, hour, minute and preview
The timestamp is eight hours early	Convert time zone source and destination
No Excel rows are returned	OneDrive location, workbook saved, formatted table and table name
Apply to each is empty	Use the Excel action's value list
A recipient or course is blank	Header spelling in the workbook. Re-pick the token
The date shows as a number	Set DateTime Format to ISO 8601 in List rows present in a table
The date expression shows an error	Brackets and quotes: <code>formatDateTime(... , 'dd MMM yyyy')</code>
Completed records get reminders	Expected here. Chapter 7 adds the filter

Lesson Summary

A scheduled trigger starts the flow at a predictable local time. Date Time actions give a readable timestamp, Excel supplies the rows, Apply to each hands the current row to the email, and a second expression turned a raw date into something a person wants to read. Next you add a human approval decision.

HANDS-ON

Hands-on exercises

Hover over a grey box and click the copy icon in its top-right corner. Anything marked **text** is typed or pasted straight into a field.

Flow name (text, section 5.1)

```
PA - Weekly training reminders
```

Email subject start (text, section 5.5)

Paste, then insert **CourseTitle** after it.

```
[PA TRAINING] Reminder:
```

Email body (text, section 5.5)

Paste, then replace each `[Name]` with the matching dynamic content token.

```
Hello [ParticipantName],

This is your weekly training reminder.

Course: [CourseTitle]
Session date: [SessionDate]
Status: [Status]
Reminder generated: [Converted time]

Please contact the training coordinator if your plans change.
```

Readable session date (section 5.6)

Type `/` where the `SessionDate` token was, choose **Insert expression**, paste, then select **Add**.

```
formatDateTime(items('Apply_to_each')['SessionDate'], 'dd MMM yyyy')
```

Note: If your loop has a different name (for example `Apply_to_each_1`), build the expression by picking **SessionDate** from the Dynamic content tab as in section 5.6 instead of pasting.

06

CHAPTER 6

Process a Training Approval

A training request needs a person to say yes or no before anything is confirmed. This flow collects the request with Microsoft Forms, asks an approver to decide, and posts a different Teams message for each outcome.

Copy-paste values: the flow name, form text, approval title and messages are on the copy-paste page.

Estimated time: 75 minutes

Your result: An automated cloud flow that reads a Forms response, asks a person to approve or reject it, and prepares a different Teams message for each outcome.

What You Will Learn

- Start a flow when a Microsoft Forms response is submitted
- Retrieve the answers with **Get response details**
- Request a decision with **Start and wait for an approval**
- Branch on the approval outcome and post a different Teams message for each result

How the Flow Works

When a new response is submitted > Get response details > Start and wait for an approval > Condition > Approved or rejected Teams message

The Forms trigger only supplies a response ID. Get response details uses that ID to fetch the answers. The approval action pauses the flow until someone decides. The Condition reads the approval **Outcome** and sends the flow down True or False.

Before You Begin

You need Microsoft Forms, Approvals and Microsoft Teams through your work or school account. Your trainer names an approved test approver and Teams destination before any live test.

Important: The screenshots use `approver@example.com`, a documentation placeholder. Replace it with a trainer-approved account before testing. Don't submit the form or run the flow while the placeholder is still there.

6.1 Prepare the Request Form

In Microsoft Forms, create a form named **Training Request** with the description from the copy-paste page. Add four required questions:

Question	Type	Options or setting
Requester name	Text	Single line
Course	Choice	Power Automate Basics; Approval Workflows; Excel Reporting
Preferred date	Date	Required
Business reason	Text	Long answer

The screenshot shows the Microsoft Forms editor interface for a form titled 'Training Request'. The form contains four questions, each marked with a red asterisk to indicate it is required:

- 1. Requester name ***: A single-line text input field with the placeholder 'Enter your answer'.
- 2. Course ***: A choice question with three radio button options: 'Power Automate Basics', 'Approval Workflows', and 'Excel Reporting'.
- 3. Preferred date ***: A date input field with the placeholder 'Please input date (M/d/yyyy)' and a calendar icon.
- 4. Business reason ***: A long-answer text input field with the placeholder 'Enter your answer'.

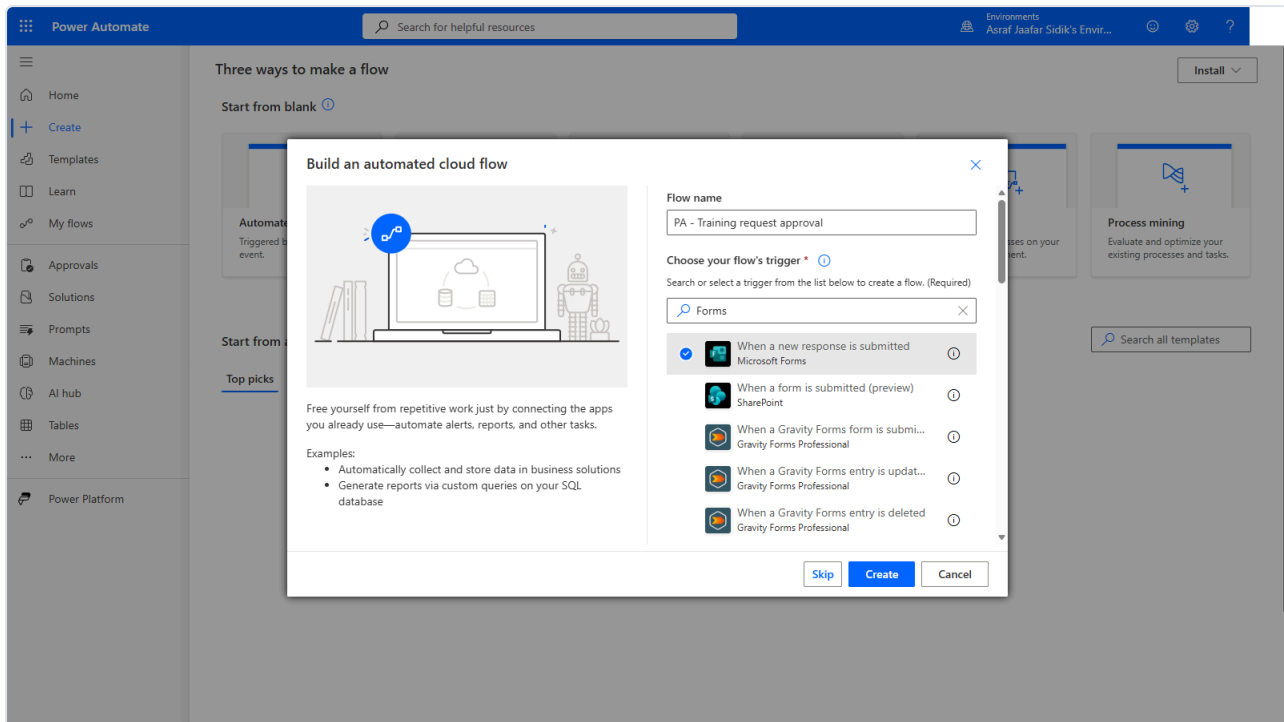
The editor interface includes a top navigation bar with options like 'Style', 'Settings', 'Preview', 'Collect responses', 'View responses', and 'Present'. A left sidebar shows a 'Templates' section. The background of the form preview area features a decorative image of a modern interior with a sofa and a large letter 'S'.

Four required questions. The red asterisk marks each one as required.

Checkpoint: All four questions show the red required marker. A missing answer gives the approver an incomplete card.

6.2 Create the Automated Flow

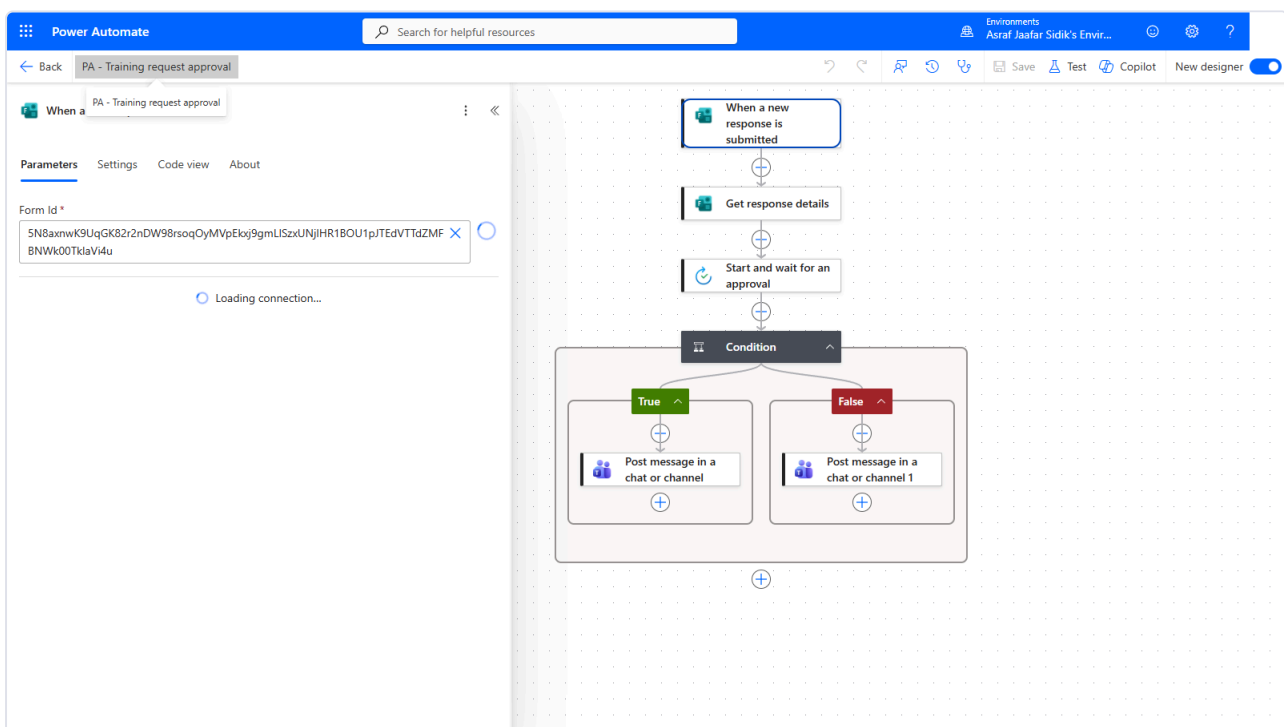
Select **Create > Automated cloud flow**. Name it `PA - Training request approval`, search for **Forms**, select **When a new response is submitted**, and select **Create**.



The Forms trigger starts the flow whenever the form gets a response.

6.3 Select the Form

Open the trigger and set **Form Id** to **Training Request**.

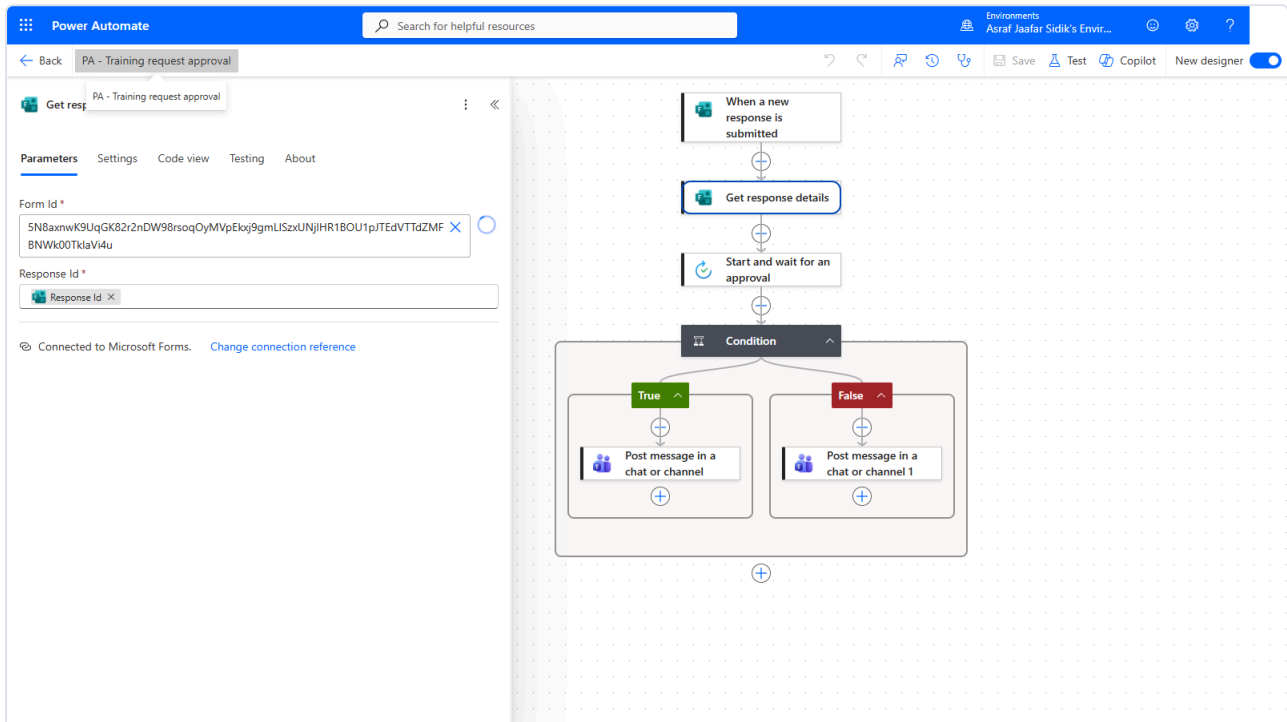


Pick the form from the dropdown.

If the form isn't listed, check that you own or can access it, refresh the list, and confirm the Forms connection uses the right account.

6.4 Retrieve the Answers

Add **Microsoft Forms > Get response details**. Set **Form Id** to *Training Request*, and in **Response Id** insert **Response Id** from the trigger.



The Response Id token links this step to the exact submission that started the flow.

The trigger only says a response exists. Get response details returns the individual answers so later actions can use them.

6.5 Request the Decision

Add **Approvals > Start and wait for an approval**:

Field	Value
Approval type	Approve/Reject - First to respond (if your list doesn't have it, choose Basic)
Title	[PA TRAINING] Training request
Assigned to	Trainer-approved approver
Details	Requester name, Course, Preferred date and Business reason from Get response details

Lay out Details so each label is followed by its matching value.

The screenshot displays the Microsoft Power Automate interface for a flow named "PA - Training request approval".

Left Pane (Parameters):

- Approval type:** Basic
- Title:** [PA TRAINING] Training request
- Assigned to:** asraf@jasraf.onmicrosoft.com
- Details:**
 - **Requester:** body/r96281c9...
 - **Course:** body/rc6d429a1...
 - **Preferred Date:** body/rbc5b7da...
 - **Business reason:** body/r1e51584f...
- Item link:** Add a link to the item to approve
- Item link description:** Describe the link to the item
- Advanced parameters:** Showing 2 of 4
- Enable notifications:** (checkbox)

Right Pane (Flowchart):

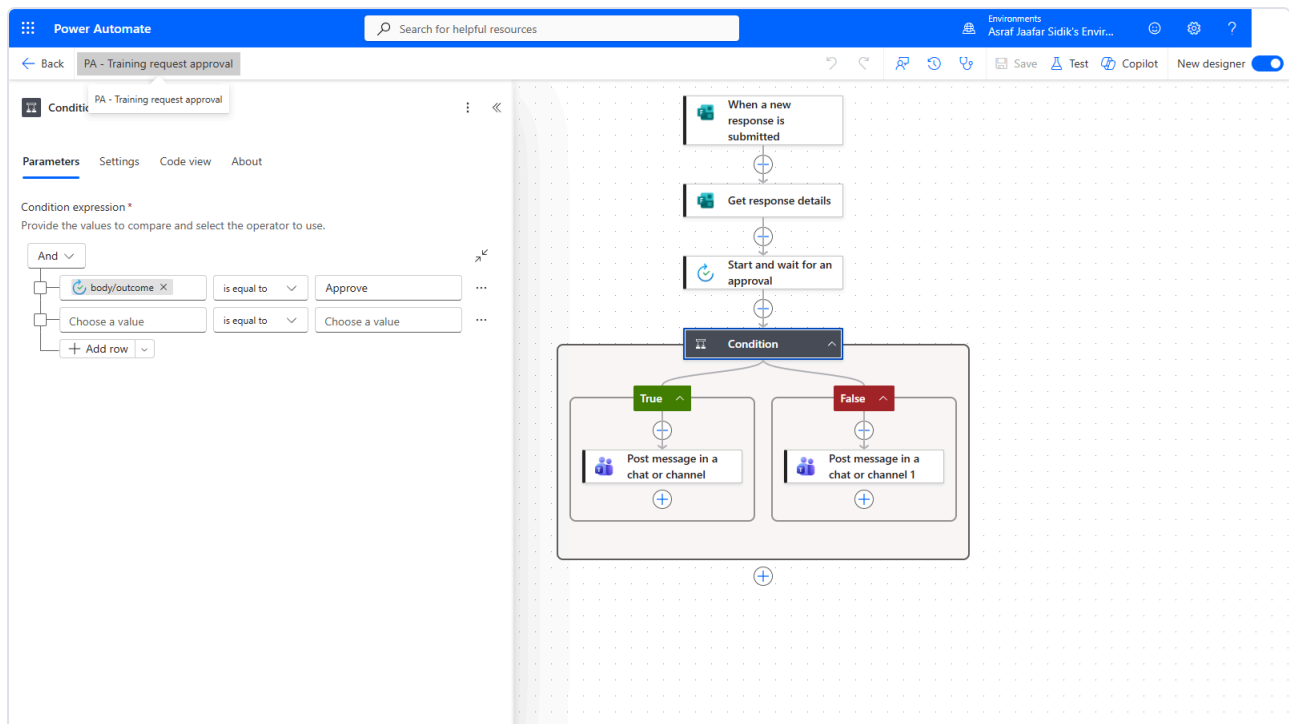
- When a new response is submitted** (Trigger)
- Get response details** (Action)
- Start and wait for an approval** (Action)
- Condition** (Control):
 - True:** Post message in a chat or channel
 - False:** Post message in a chat or channel 1

Each label in Details is followed by its answer from Get response details.

Checkpoint: Use the values from **Get response details**, not similarly named values from another action.

6.6 Branch on the Outcome

Add **Control > Condition**. Set the left value to **Outcome** from **Start and wait for an approval**, choose **is equal to**, and enter **Approve**.



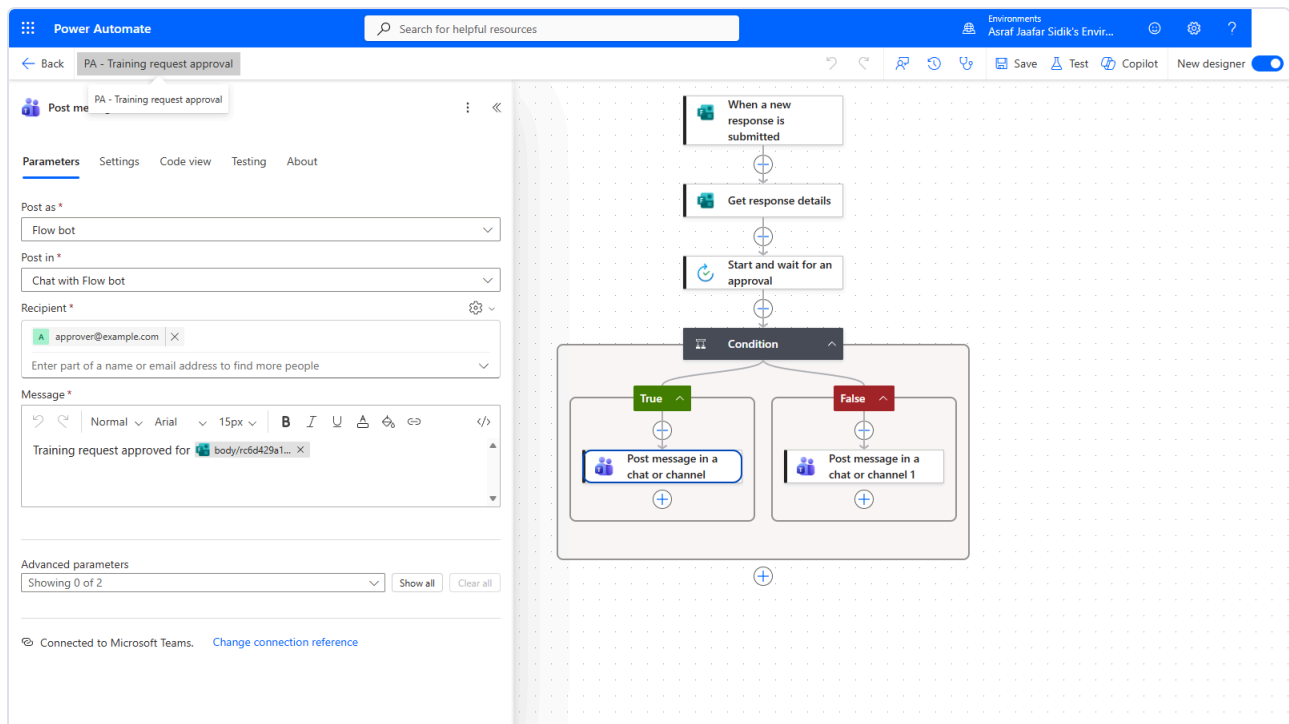
An Approve outcome goes to True. Anything else goes to False.

Key point: The text must be exactly `Approve`. A typo or a trailing space sends every approval down the False branch.

6.7 Prepare the Approved Message

In the **True** branch, add **Microsoft Teams > Post message in a chat or channel**:

Field	Value
Post as	Flow bot
Post in	Chat with Flow bot
Recipient	Trainer-approved Teams account
Message	Training request approved for followed by Course from Get response details



The True branch posts the approved message.

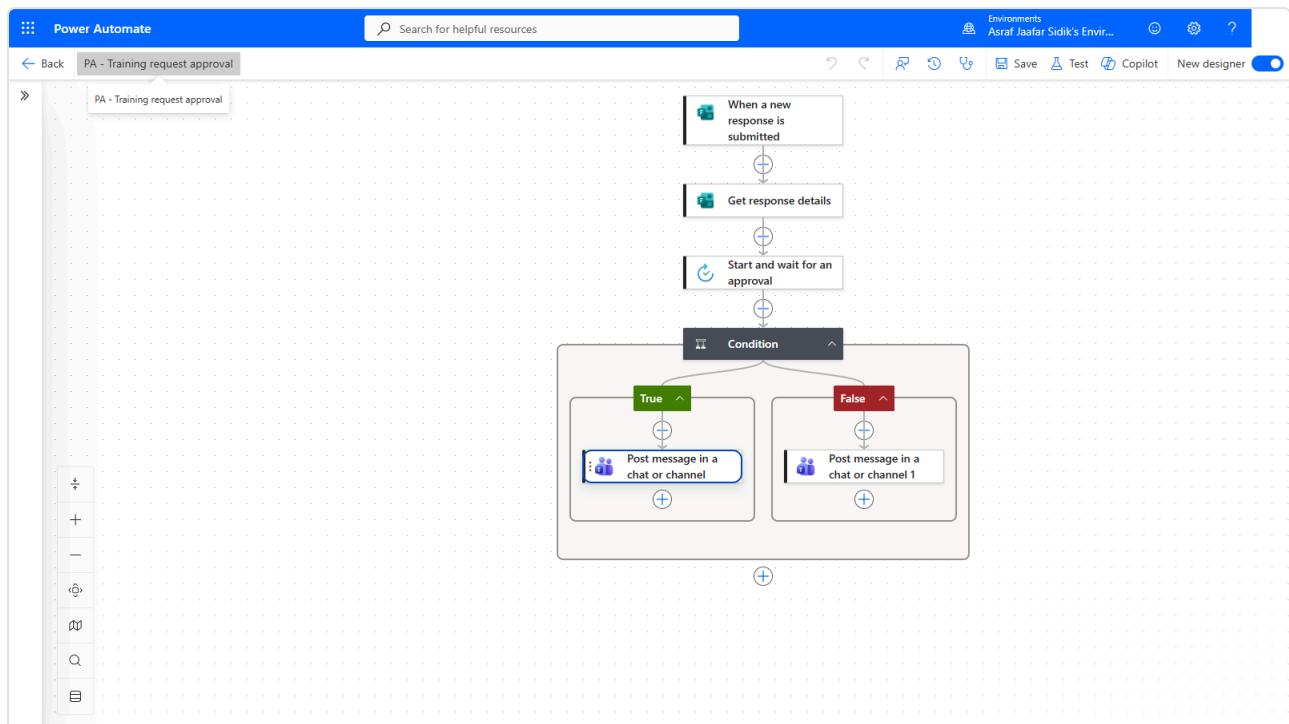
6.8 Prepare the Rejected Message

In the **False** branch, add a second **Post message in a chat or channel** with the same **Post as**, **Post in** and **recipient**. Set **Message** to `Training request rejected for` followed by **Course**.

A production process would also handle outcomes like cancelled or timed-out approvals. This exercise sticks to the two standard Approve and Reject buttons.

6.9 Save and Check the Flow

1. Select **Save** and open **Flow checker**. Fix every error before testing.
2. Confirm the canvas: three steps before the **Condition**, and one Teams action in each branch.



Three steps, then one Teams message per branch.

Trainer-Controlled Test

Testing creates an approval request and may post to Teams. Replace both `approver@example.com` placeholders first and confirm the recipient is ready. Then, with the trainer's go-ahead:

1. Submit one fictional Training Request response.
2. Approve it, and check the True branch and the approved Teams message.
3. Submit a second fictional response.
4. Reject it, and check the False branch and the rejected Teams message.

After each test, open run history and confirm the right branch succeeded while the other was skipped.

Independent Practice

Without running the flow, change the approval title so it also includes the **Course** value. Which action supplies that value, and why can't the trigger supply it on its own?

Troubleshooting

Symptom	What to check
Training Request isn't in Form Id	Form ownership or access, the Forms connection account, and a refreshed list
The approval has no request details	Get response details Form Id, the Response Id token and the Details tokens

<i>The flow waits forever</i>	<i>The assigned approver, the notification, and whether a decision was made</i>
<i>An approval goes down False</i>	<i>The Outcome token, is equal to, and the exact text Approve</i>
<i>Teams can't resolve the recipient</i>	<i>Replace the placeholder with a trainer-approved account</i>
<i>No Teams message appears</i>	<i>The branch taken, Teams connection, Post in setting, recipient and the action result</i>
<i>Flow checker is clean but you can't test</i>	<i>Flow checker checks structure only, not placeholder recipients or policy</i>

Lesson Summary

A Forms trigger starts the flow with a response ID, Get response details turns it into usable answers, Start and wait for an approval records a human decision, and a Condition routes the request to the matching branch. The flow is ready for a trainer-controlled test once approved recipients replace the placeholders.

HANDS-ON

Hands-on exercises

Hover over a grey box and click the copy icon in its top-right corner. Everything on this page is **text**, typed or pasted straight into a field.

Form name (text, section 6.1)

```
Training Request
```

Form description (text, section 6.1)

```
Submit a fictional training request for the Power Automate approval exercise.
```

Course choices (text, section 6.1)

```
Power Automate Basics  
Approval Workflows  
Excel Reporting
```

Flow name (text, section 6.2)

```
PA - Training request approval
```

Approval title (text, section 6.5)

```
[PA TRAINING] Training request
```

Condition right value (text, section 6.6)

```
Approve
```

Teams messages (text, sections 6.7 and 6.8)

Type the text, then insert **Course** from Get response details after it.

```
Training request approved for
```

```
Training request rejected for
```

07

CHAPTER 7

Capstone: Weekly Reminders and Summary

Chapter 5 sent a reminder to every row, including people who had already finished. The capstone turns that into a process a coordinator would actually use: skip completed training, limit the window to the next 14 days, count what was sent, and handle the week when nothing matches.

Copy-paste values: action names, the variable name and summary text are on the copy-paste page.

Estimated time: 90 minutes

Your result: A copy of the weekly reminder flow that keeps only upcoming incomplete records, counts the reminders, and follows a clear summary or no-records branch.

What You Will Learn

- Filter a list before a loop with **Filter array**
- Work out a future date with **Get future time**
- Use a condition with two rules that must both be true
- Count processed items with an integer variable
- Branch after a loop, including a week with no matching records

How the Flow Works

Recurrence > Current time > Convert time zone > List rows > Filter array > Get future time > Initialize variable > Apply to each (Condition > Send reminder > Increment variable) > Condition > Summary or no-records message

Filter array removes completed rows before the loop starts. Inside the loop, a condition checks that the session falls in the next 14 days. A counter goes up once per reminder. After the loop, a second condition checks the counter and picks what to tell the coordinator.

Before You Begin

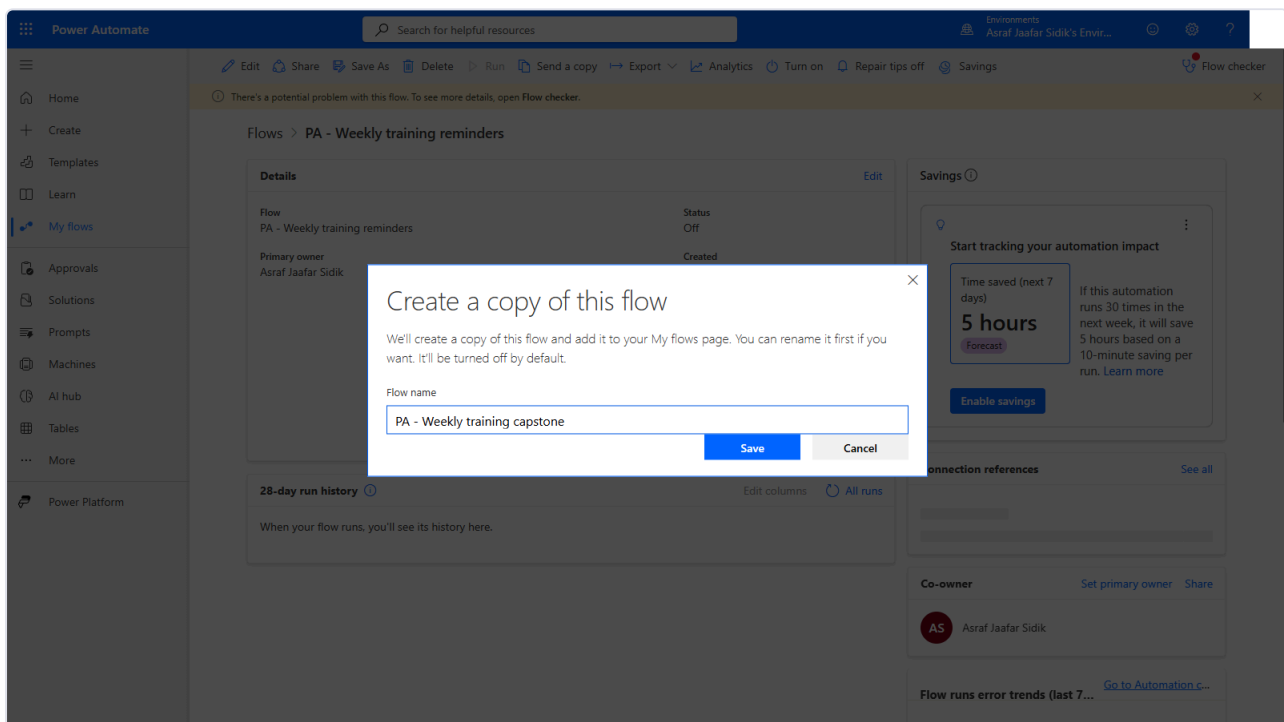
Complete Chapter 5.

Important: The sample register uses `example.com` addresses, which can't receive mail. Keep the capstone turned off and don't test it until the trainer has replaced every recipient with an approved destination.

Note: The sample sessions run from 21 September to 5 October 2026. If your class is on a different date, ask your trainer to shift the `SessionDate` values so some fall in the next 14 days.

7.1 Make a Safe Capstone Copy

1. Go to **My flows** and open `PA - Weekly training reminders`.
2. Select **Save As** (in the ... menu if it isn't visible).
3. Name the copy `PA - Weekly training capstone` and select **Save**. The copy starts turned off.
4. Go back to **My flows** and open the capstone copy.



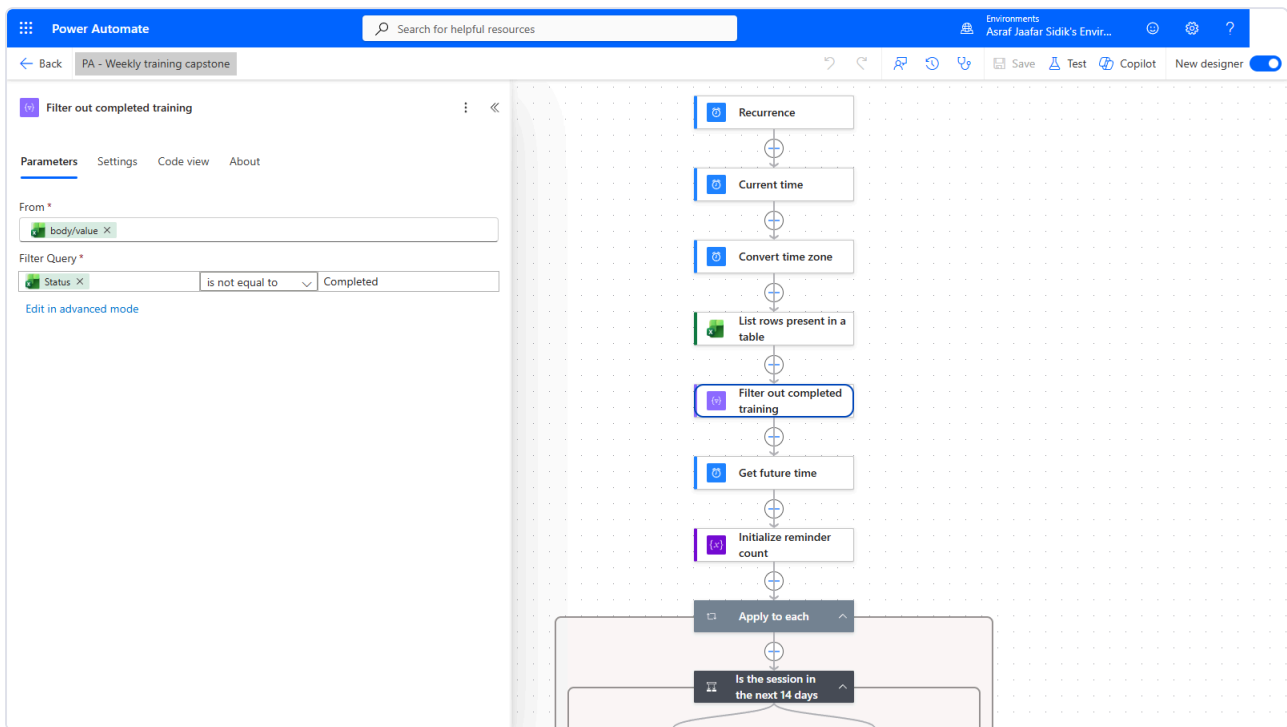
Working on a copy keeps your Chapter 5 flow safe.

Checkpoint: The name at the top of the designer reads `PA - Weekly training capstone` before you change anything.

7.2 Remove Completed Rows with Filter Array

1. Select **+** between **List rows present in a table** and **Apply to each**, then **Add an action**.
2. Search for `Filter array` (under **Data Operation**) and select it.
3. Rename it: select the action's title and type `Filter out completed training`.
4. In **From**, insert **body/value** (or **value**) from **List rows present in a table**.

5. In the left box, insert **Status** from dynamic content.
6. Set the middle box to **is not equal to**.
7. In the right box, type `Completed`.

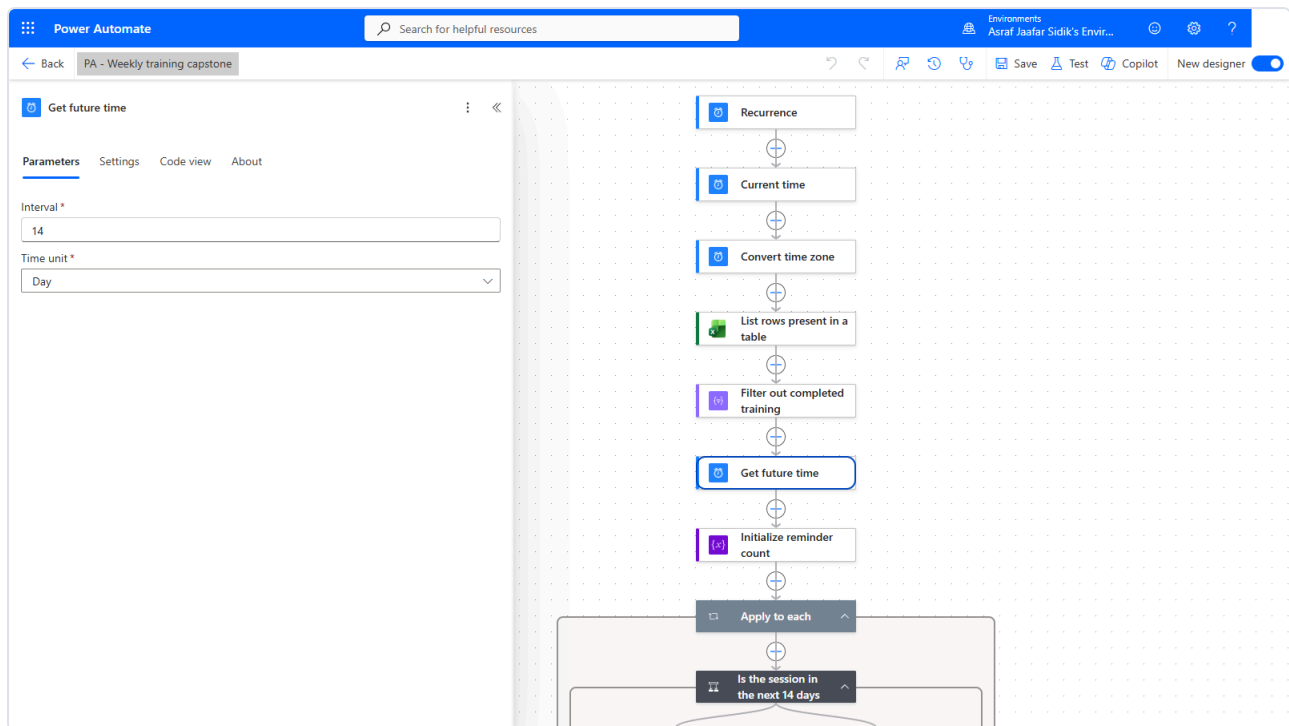


Filter array keeps only the rows where the rule is true. Completed rows are dropped before the loop.

Tip: The comparison is exact, including capital letters. `Completed` and `completed` count as different. The sample data uses `Completed`.

7.3 Work Out the End of the Window

1. Below Filter array, add **Get future time** (under **Date Time**).
2. Set **Interval** to `14` and **Time unit** to **Day**.



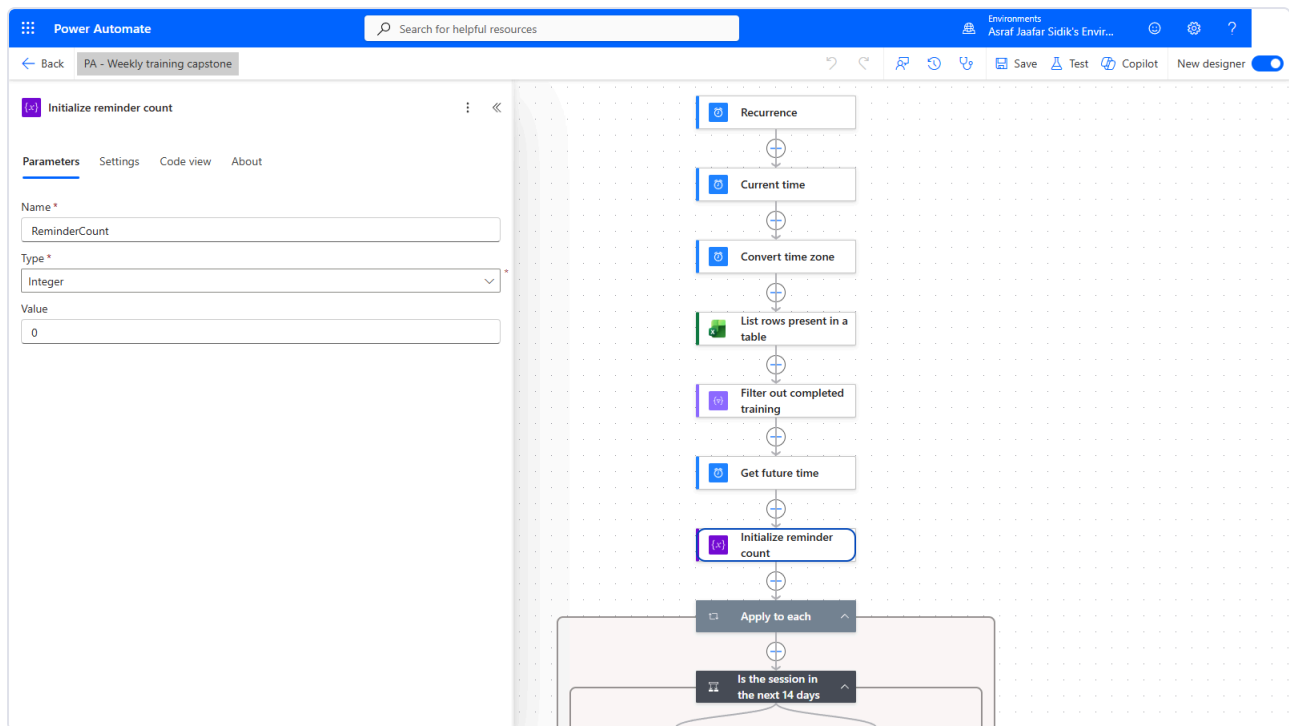
This gives you "14 days from now" without any expression.

You now have both ends of the window: **Current time** (already in the flow from Chapter 5) and **Future time** from this step.

7.4 Start the Reminder Counter

1. Below *Get future time*, add **Initialize variable** (under **Variables**).
2. Rename it `Initialize reminder count`.
3. Set:

Field	Value
Name	ReminderCount
Type	Integer
Value	0

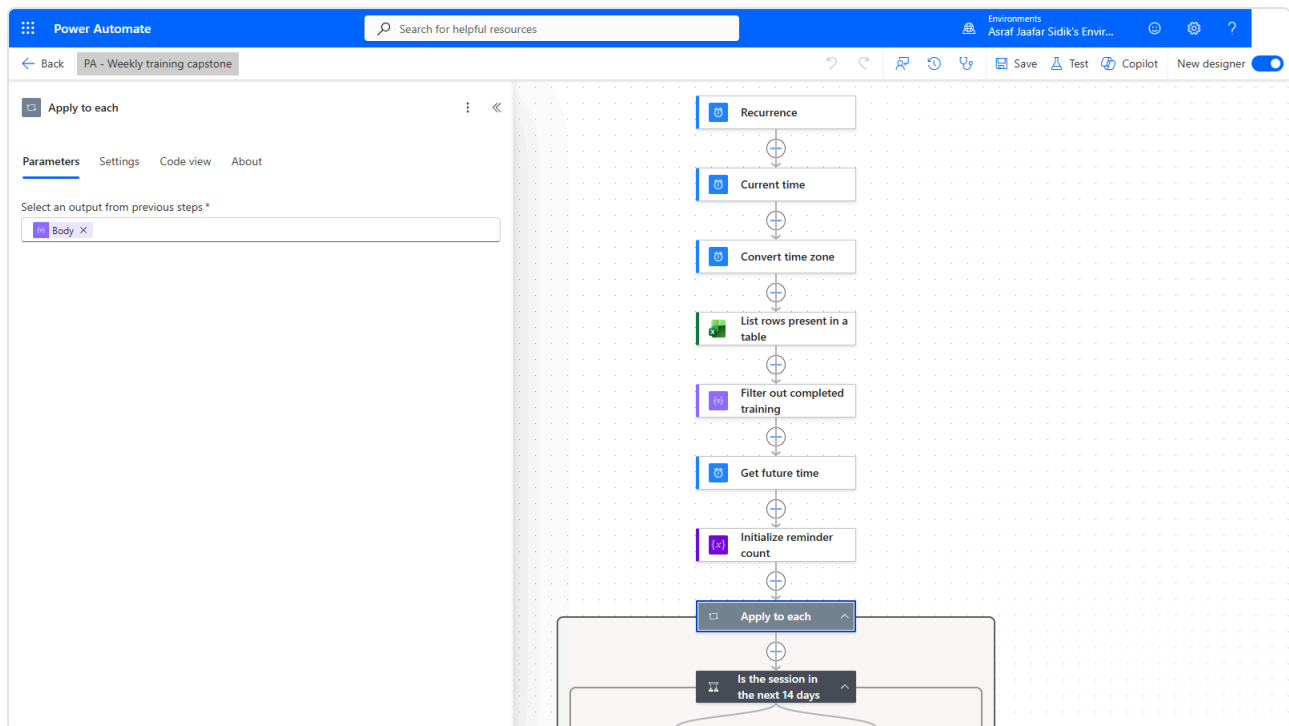


A variable is a named box that can change while the flow runs. This one starts at zero.

Key point: Variables must be created at the top level of the flow, never inside a loop or a condition. That's why this step comes before Apply to each.

7.5 Loop Through the Remaining Rows

1. Select **Apply to each**.
2. Remove the current input (select the **x** on the token).
3. Insert **Body** from Filter out completed training.

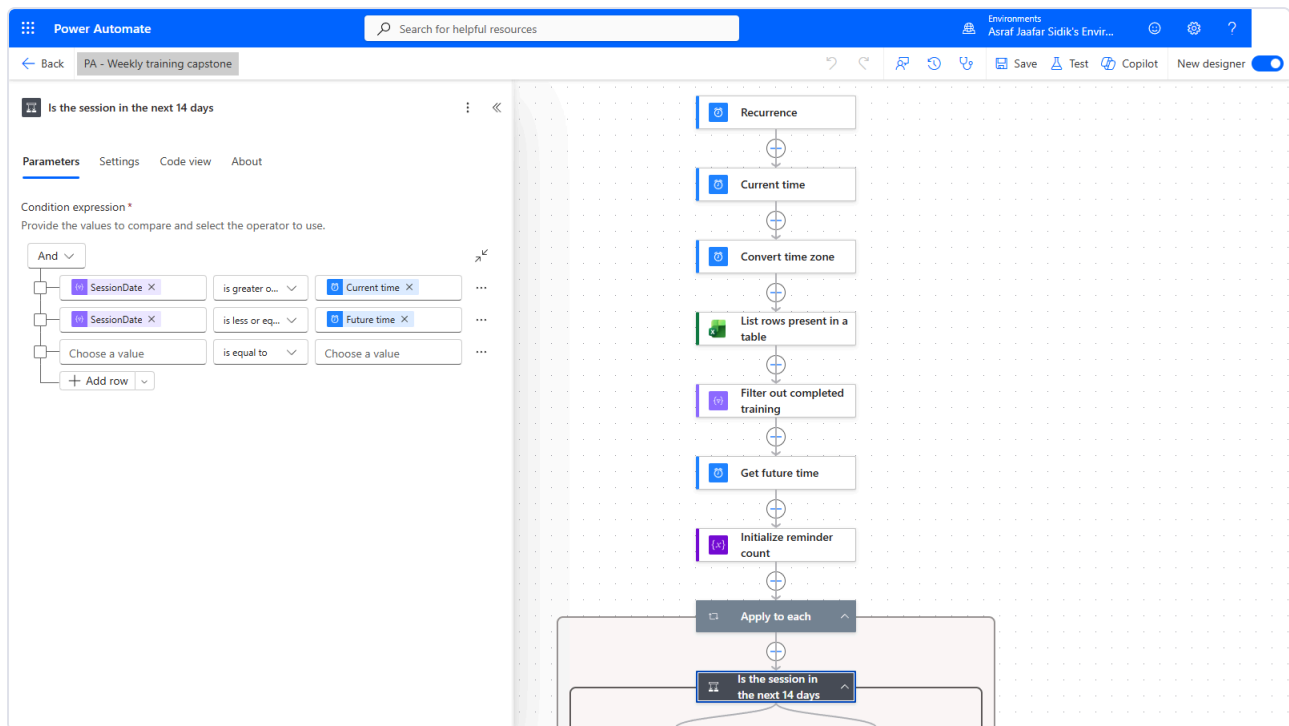


The loop now only sees rows that aren't completed.

Key point: Don't leave the original Excel value here. That brings back the Chapter 5 behaviour and includes completed rows.

7.6 Check the Date Window

1. Inside **Apply to each**, select **+** above **Send an email (V2)**, then **Add an action**, and add a **Condition**.
2. Rename it **Is the session in the next 14 days**.
3. First row, left box: type `/`, choose **Insert expression**, paste `items('Apply_to_each')['SessionDate']` and select **Add**. (See the box below for why.) Choose **is greater or equal to**, then insert **Current time** on the right.
4. Select **Add row**. Second row: insert the same expression on the left, choose **is less or equal to**, and insert **Future time** on the right.
5. Make sure the rows are joined by **AND**, so both must be true.
6. Drag **Send an email (V2)** into the **True** branch. (Or delete it and add it again inside True with the same settings.)



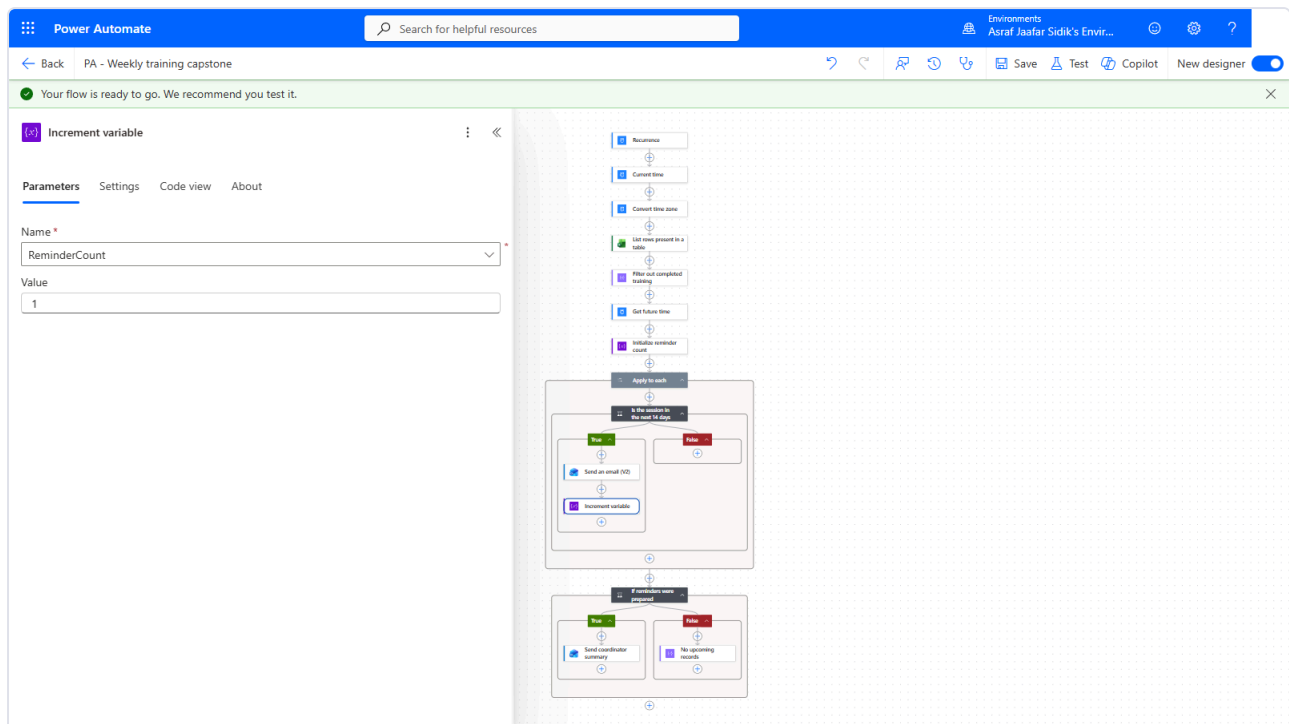
Two rules joined by AND: on or after now, and on or before 14 days from now.

Key point: why an expression here? Once the loop runs over **Filter array's Body**, the dynamic content picker no longer lists the Excel columns. If you pick **SessionDate** from **List rows present in a table** anyway, the designer wraps the condition in a second, unwanted loop. The expression `items('Apply_to_each')['SessionDate']` simply means "the SessionDate of the row this loop is on right now". It's on the copy-paste page. The email tokens you added in Chapter 5 keep working, because they already point at the loop's current row.

This works because the Excel dates are in ISO 8601 format (set in Chapter 5), the same format as Current time and Future time. Same format means they compare correctly.

7.7 Count Each Reminder

1. In the **True** branch, below **Send an email (V2)**, add **Increment variable** (under **Variables**).
2. Select **ReminderCount** and enter **1** for **Value**.

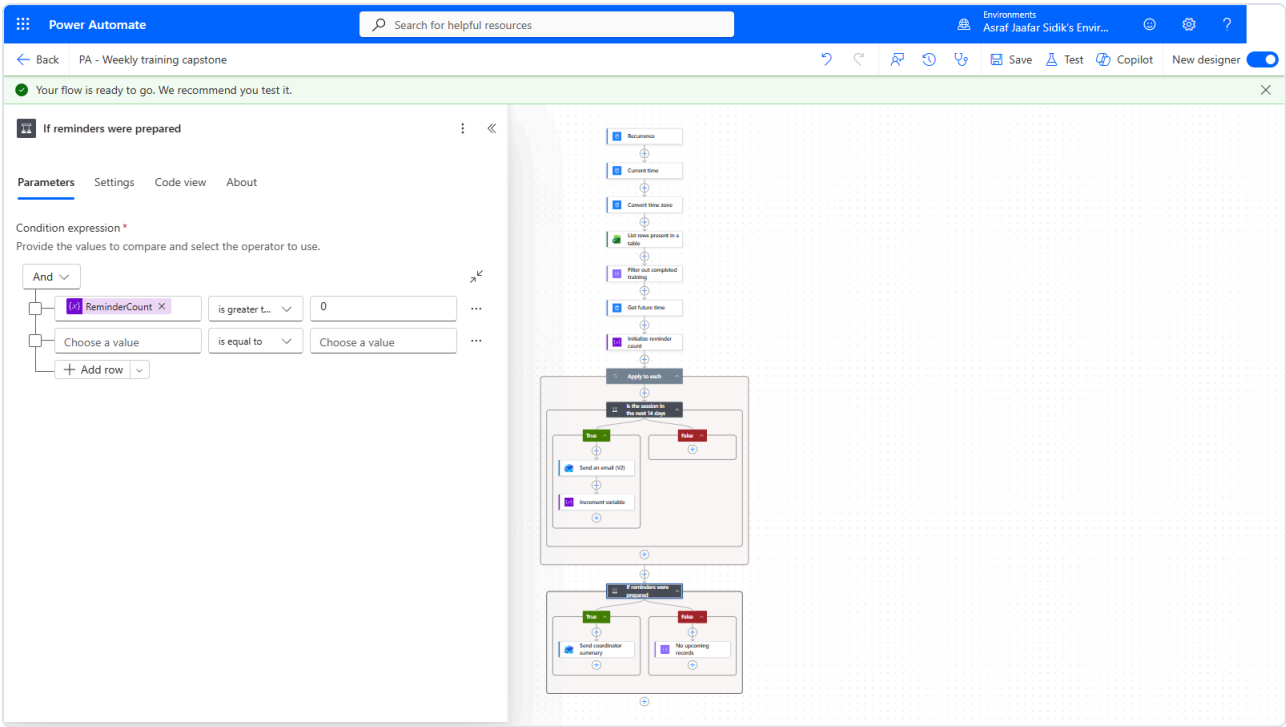


Each reminder adds one to the counter.

Keep the increment after the email, so the count only includes reminders that reached the email step.

7.8 Decide Whether a Summary Is Needed

1. Below **Apply to each**, outside the loop, add a **Condition**.
2. Rename it *If reminders were prepared*.
3. Insert **ReminderCount** (under Variables), choose **is greater than**, type **0**.

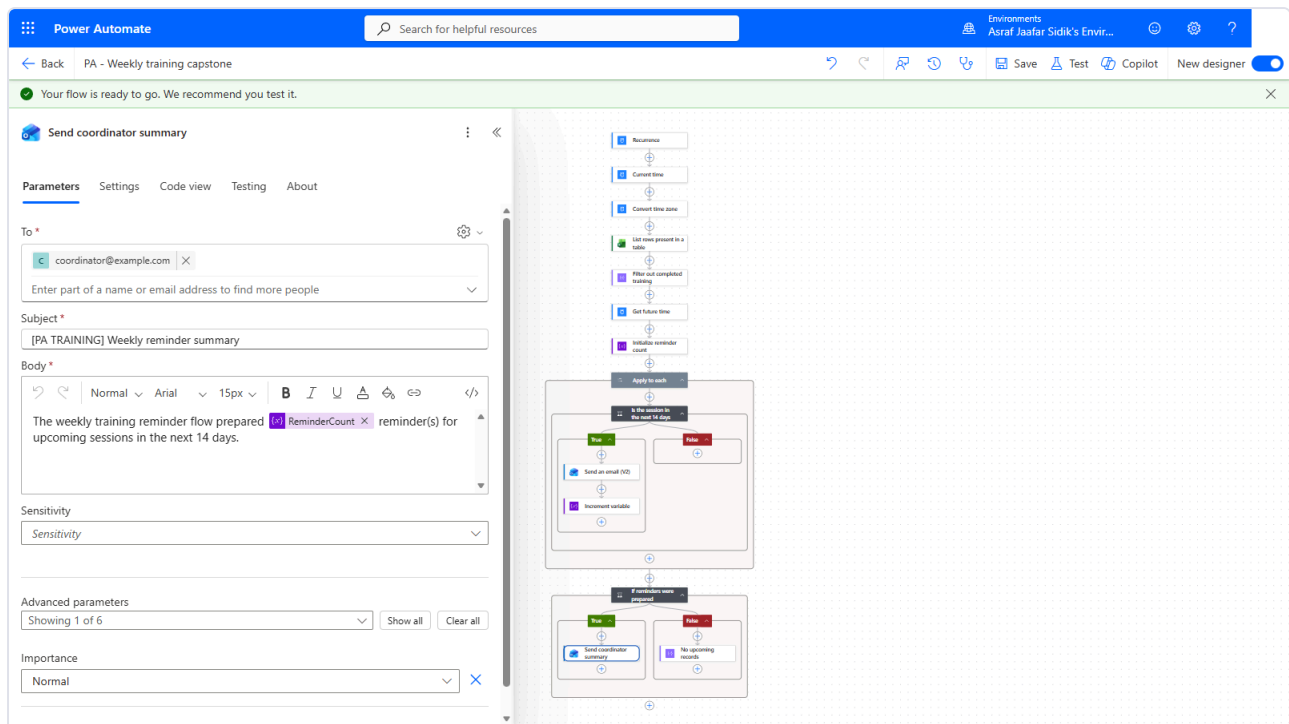


A positive count goes to True. Zero goes to False.

7.9 Prepare the Coordinator Summary

In the **True** branch, add **Send an email (V2)** and rename it `Send coordinator summary`:

Field	Value
To	<code>coordinator@example.com</code>
Subject	<code>[PA TRAINING] Weekly reminder summary</code>
Body	Type <code>The weekly training reminder flow prepared</code> , insert ReminderCount , then type <code>reminder(s)</code> for upcoming sessions in the next 14 days.



The variable drops into the email like any other dynamic content.

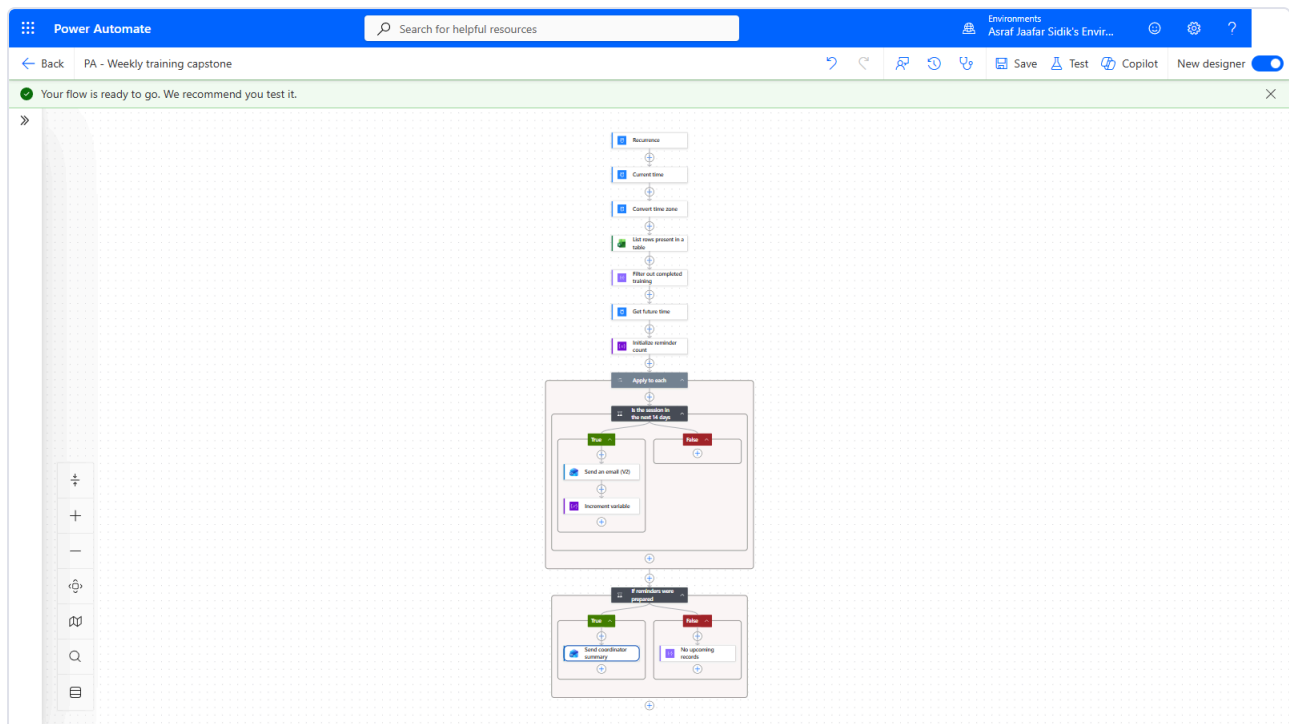
7.10 Handle a Week with No Matching Rows

In the **False** branch, add **Compose** (under **Data Operation**), rename it *No upcoming records*, and type *No upcoming training records were found for the next 14 days.* in **Inputs**.

That records a clear outcome in run history without sending an unnecessary email.

7.11 Save and Check the Capstone

1. Select **Save**, open **Flow checker**, and confirm zero errors and zero warnings.
2. Close Flow checker and select **Zoom view to fit** (in the zoom controls at the bottom left). Check the shape: filter before the loop, date check and count inside the loop, decision after the loop.



Filter before, check and count inside, decide after.

Trainer-Controlled Test

A test can send one learner reminder per matching row plus, when the count is positive, a coordinator summary. With the sample data on 17 September 2026, four rows match (21, 22, 24 and 28 September). The trainer replaces every `example.com` address, saves the workbook, confirms the coordinator address and authorises the run first.

Afterwards, check the run history:

- Filter out completed training returned four rows
- Apply to each ran four times, and the date condition was true each time
- ReminderCount ended at 4
- The final condition took True and prepared the coordinator summary

Independent Practice

Without running the flow, change the window from 14 days to 7 by editing only **Get future time**. Which sample rows would match on 17 September 2026? Then change it back to 14.

Going further: one filter that does it all. Experienced makers often replace the filter and the date condition with a single Filter array in **advanced mode**, using an expression that also ignores capital letters and stray spaces. The expression is on the copy-paste page. You'll build flows like that in the advanced course. Optional.

Troubleshooting

Symptom	What to check
A completed row still gets a reminder	Filter array right value is exactly <code>Completed</code> , and the loop uses Filter's Body
Every date fails the condition	Date/Time Format is ISO 8601 in List rows present in a table
A second Apply to each appears inside the loop	You picked SessionDate from the Excel action. Delete the extra loop and use the expression from section 7.6
No date passes the condition	The sample dates may be in the past. Ask the trainer to update SessionDate
ReminderCount stays at zero	Increment variable is inside the True branch of the date condition
Initialize variable can't be added	You're inside the loop. Variables are created at the top level
The summary runs before reminders finish	Put the final Condition below Apply to each, outside its box
Flow checker is clean but a test is unsafe	Flow checker checks structure. It doesn't approve recipients

Lesson Summary

The capstone filters out completed rows before looping, checks a date window with a two-rule condition, keeps a running count in a variable, and branches on the final count. That turns a broad weekly reminder into a controlled process with a clear result for the coordinator. Next, you'll use variables again, alongside parallel branches, in a flow that's all about you.

HANDS-ON

Hands-on exercises

Hover over a grey box and click the copy icon in its top-right corner. Everything in the main steps is **text**, typed or pasted straight into a field.

Flow name for the copy (text, section 7.1)

```
PA - Weekly training capstone
```

Filter array (text, section 7.2)

Action name:

```
Filter out completed training
```

Right value:

```
Completed
```

Variable (text, section 7.4)

Action name:

```
Initialize reminder count
```

Variable name:

```
ReminderCount
```

Date condition name (text, section 7.6)

```
Is the session in the next 14 days
```

Current row's session date (section 7.6)

Type / in the left box of each condition row, choose **Insert expression**, paste, then select **Add**.

```
items('Apply_to_each')?['SessionDate']
```

Summary condition name (text, section 7.8)

```
If reminders were prepared
```

Coordinator summary (text, section 7.9)

Action name:

Send coordinator summary

Subject:

[PA TRAINING] Weekly reminder summary

Body: paste the first part, insert **ReminderCount**, then paste the second part.

The weekly training reminder flow prepared

reminder(s) for upcoming sessions in the next 14 days.

No-records Compose (text, section 7.10)

Action name:

No upcoming records

Inputs:

No upcoming training records were found for the next 14 days.

Going further (optional)

One filter that does it all

Replaces both Filter array and the date condition. In Filter array, choose **Edit in advanced mode** and paste. It ignores capital letters and stray spaces in Status, and compares dates from the start of today.

```
@and(  
  not(equals(toLower(trim(item()?['Status'])), 'completed')),  
  greaterOrEquals(ticks(item()?['SessionDate']), ticks(startOfDay(utcNow()))),  
  lessOrEquals(ticks(item()?['SessionDate']), ticks(addDays(startOfDay(utcNow()), 14)))  
)
```

08

CHAPTER 8

My Morning Briefing: Variables and Parallel Branches

Every morning you check the weather, your calendar and your inbox before the day starts. This flow does all three at once and sends you one email. It only reads your own data and only emails you, so it's safe to build in a live environment.

Copy-paste values: the variable names, branch text and email body are on the copy-paste page.

Estimated time: 60 minutes

Your result: A scheduled flow that runs on weekday mornings, looks up the weather, your meetings and your important unread email in three parallel branches, and sends you one briefing email.

What You Will Learn

- Create variables with **Initialize variable** and explain why they live at the top of a flow
- Change variables with **Increment variable**, **Append to string variable** and **Set variable**
- Run independent steps side by side with **parallel branches**
- Bring parallel branches back together before a final step
- Use a variable's value in a condition and an email

How the Flow Works

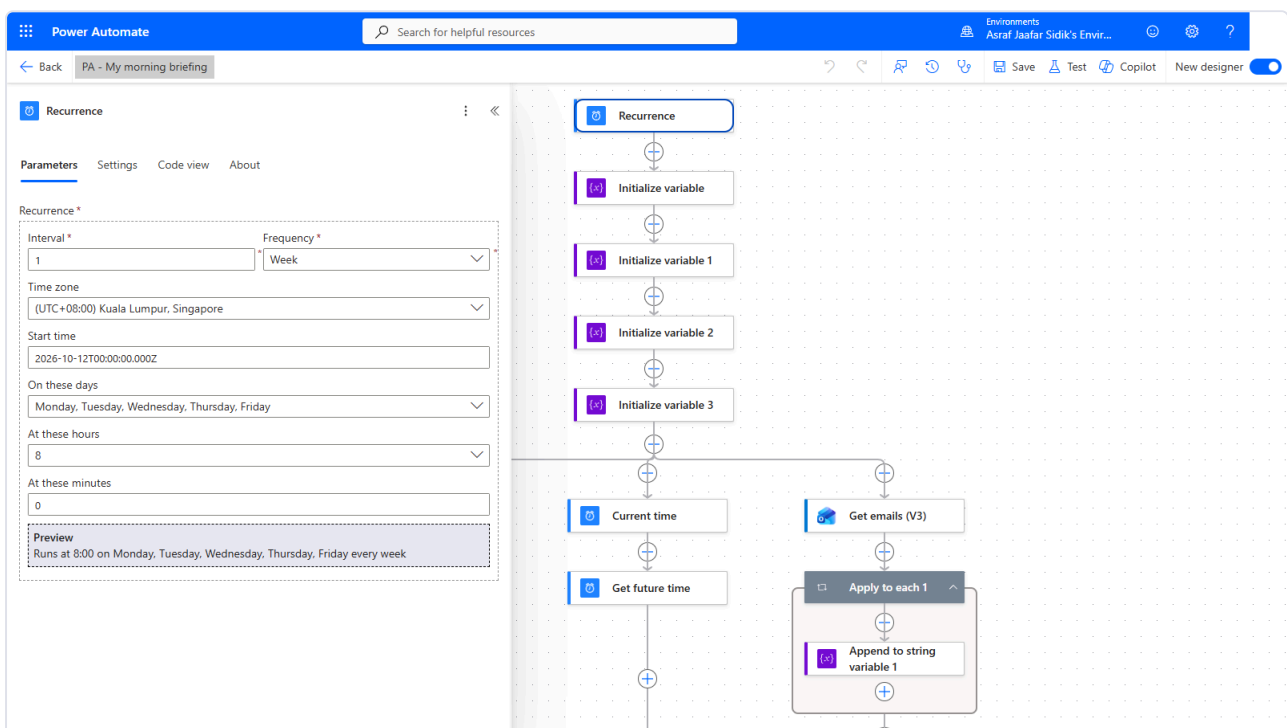
```
Recurrence
> Initialize four variables
> Three parallel branches:
  Weather: Get current weather
  Meetings: Current time > Get future time > Get calendar view > loop (count + list)
  Email:    Get emails > loop (list)
> Condition: more than 4 meetings? > Set the subject
> Send me the briefing
```

The three lookups don't depend on each other. The weather doesn't need your calendar and your calendar doesn't need your inbox. When steps are independent, they can run **in parallel**, side by side, instead of waiting in a queue. The flow only moves on to the email once all three branches have finished.

Note: Your trainer has confirmed that MSN Weather, Office 365 Outlook and the Date Time actions are allowed in your environment. Nothing in this flow changes your calendar or mailbox.

8.1 Create the Scheduled Flow

1. Select **Create** > **Scheduled cloud flow**.
2. In **Flow name**, enter *PA - My morning briefing*.
3. Set **Repeat every** to **1 Week**, tick **M T W T F**, and set the time to **8:00 AM**.
4. Select **Create**.
5. Open **Recurrence** and confirm the **Time zone** is **(UTC+08:00) Kuala Lumpur, Singapore** and the preview reads 8:00 on Monday to Friday.



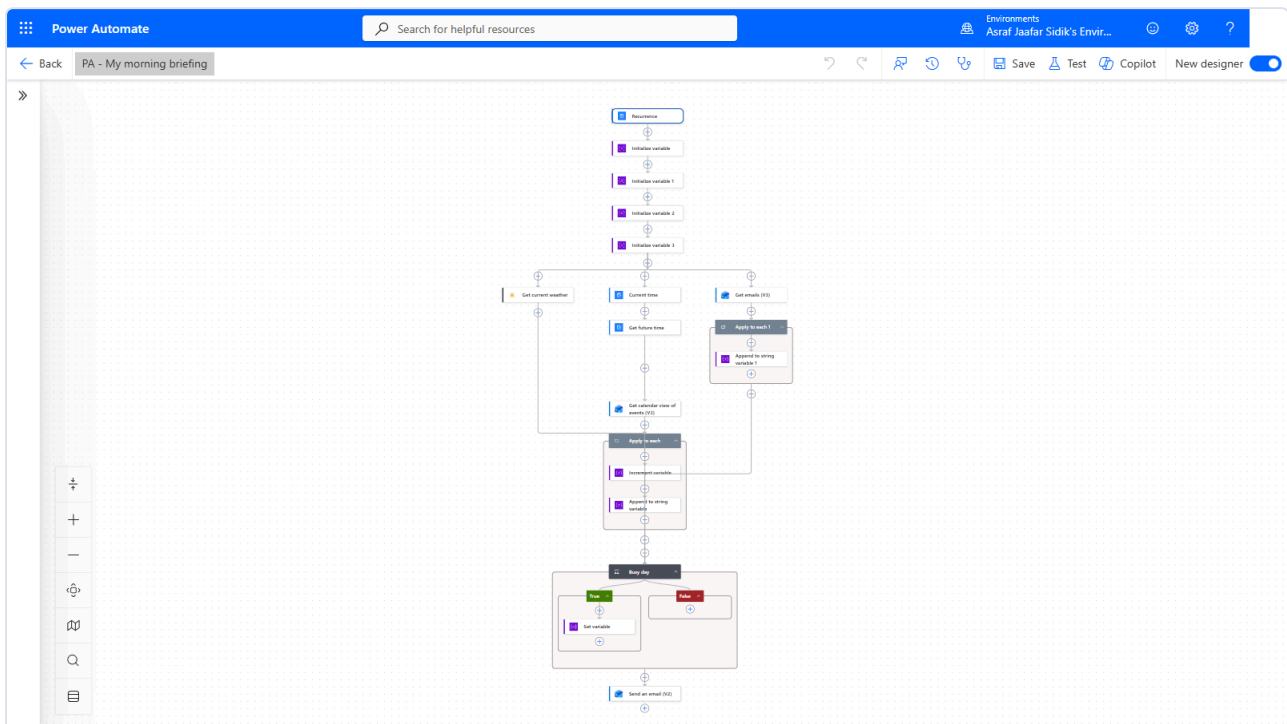
Weekday mornings at 8:00, Malaysia time.

8.2 Create the Variables

A **variable** is a named box that holds a value and can change while the flow runs. You've used one already: *ReminderCount* in Chapter 7. This flow uses four, of two types.

Name	Type	Starting value	What it's for
MeetingCount	Integer	0	Counts today's meetings
MeetingList	String	(leave empty)	Collects the meeting names
EmailList	String	(leave empty)	Collects the important email subjects
BriefingSubject	String	Your day ahead	The email subject. May change later

1. Below Recurrence, add **Initialize variable** (under **Variables**).
2. Set **Name** `MeetingCount`, **Type** **Integer**, **Value** `0`.
3. Add three more **Initialize variable** actions, one below the other, for the other rows in the table.

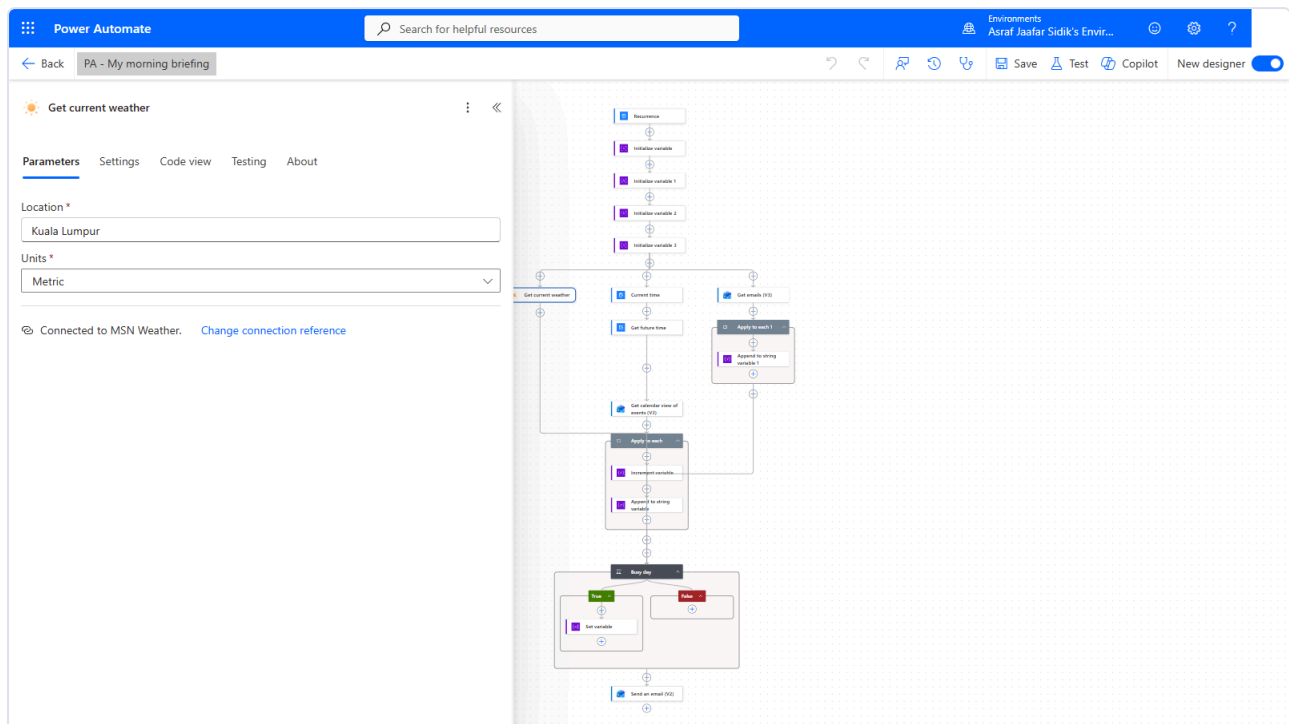


All four variables are created before anything else happens.

Key point: Initialize variable only works at the top level of a flow, not inside a loop, condition or branch. So every variable is created first, even ones you won't use until later.

8.3 Branch 1: The Weather

1. Below the last **Initialize variable**, select **+** > **Add an action**.
2. Search for `MSN Weather` and select **Get current weather**.
3. Set **Location** to `Kuala Lumpur` and **Units** to **Metric**.

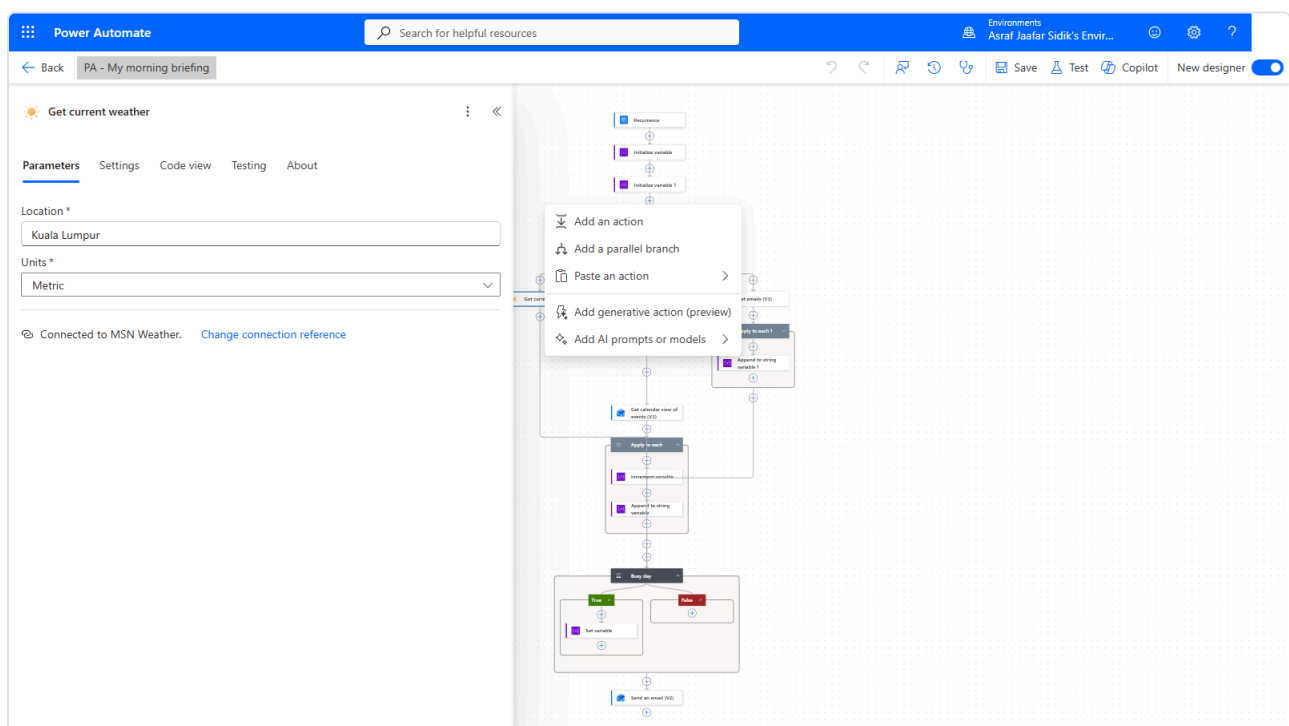


One action. Its values (conditions, temperature) are used in the email later.

8.4 Branch 2: Your Meetings

This branch starts beside the weather, not below it.

1. Select the **+** between the last **Initialize variable** and **Get current weather** (right-click it if a menu doesn't open), then choose **Add a parallel branch**.

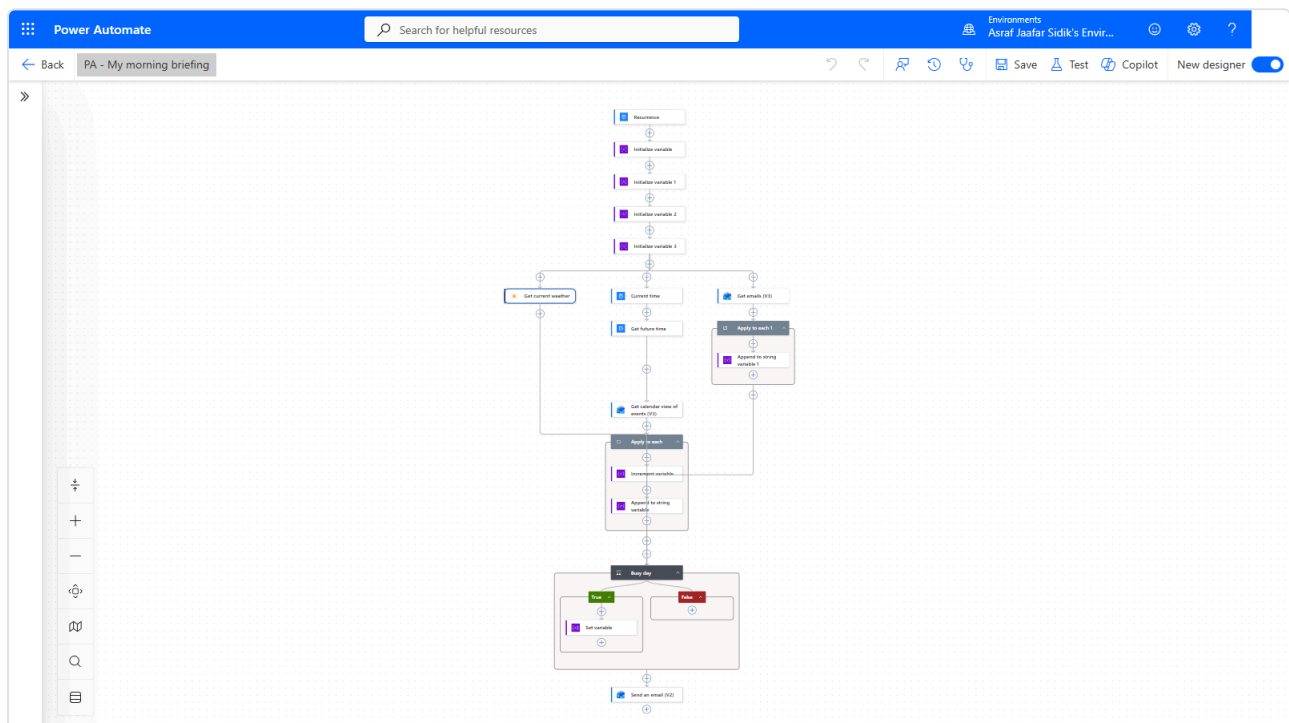


Add a parallel branch starts a new column next to the existing one.

2. In the new branch, add **Current time** (under **Date Time**).
3. Below it, add **Get future time** (under **Date Time**). Set **Interval** **12**, **Time unit Hour**.
4. Below it, add **Get calendar view of events (V3)** (Office 365 Outlook):

Field	Value
Calendar Id	Calendar
Start Time	Current time from dynamic content
End Time	Future time from dynamic content

5. Below it, add **Apply to each** (under **Control**). In **Select an output from previous steps**, insert **body/value** from Get calendar view of events (V3). That's the list of events.
6. Inside the loop, add **Increment variable**. Select **MeetingCount**, value **1**.
7. Inside the same loop, below **Increment**, add **Append to string variable**. Select **MeetingList**. In **Value**, type `<br>•` and then insert **Subject** from Get calendar view of events (V3).



Each meeting adds one to the count and one line to the list.

Tip: Email bodies are written in HTML, the language of web pages. `<br>` is HTML for "new line", so each meeting starts on its own line in the email.

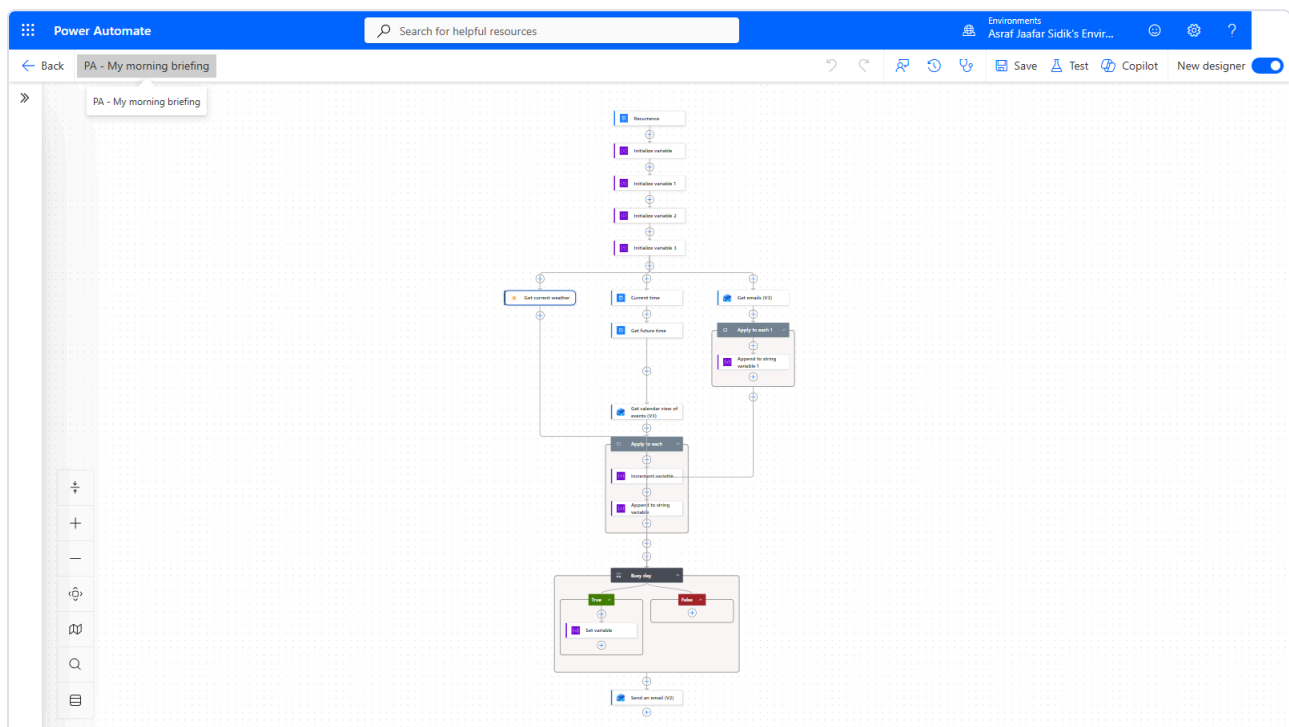
8.5 Branch 3: Important Unread Email

1. Add a third parallel branch the same way: **+** on the arrow below the last **Initialize variable** > **Add a parallel branch**.
2. Add **Get emails (V3)** (Office 365 Outlook):

Field	Value
Folder	Inbox
Fetch Only Unread Messages	Yes
Importance	High
Top	5

3. Below it, add **Apply to each** and insert **body/value** from Get emails (V3).

4. Inside the loop, add **Append to string variable**. Select **EmailList**. In **Value**, type `<br>•`, insert **Subject**, type `(from, insert From, type )`.



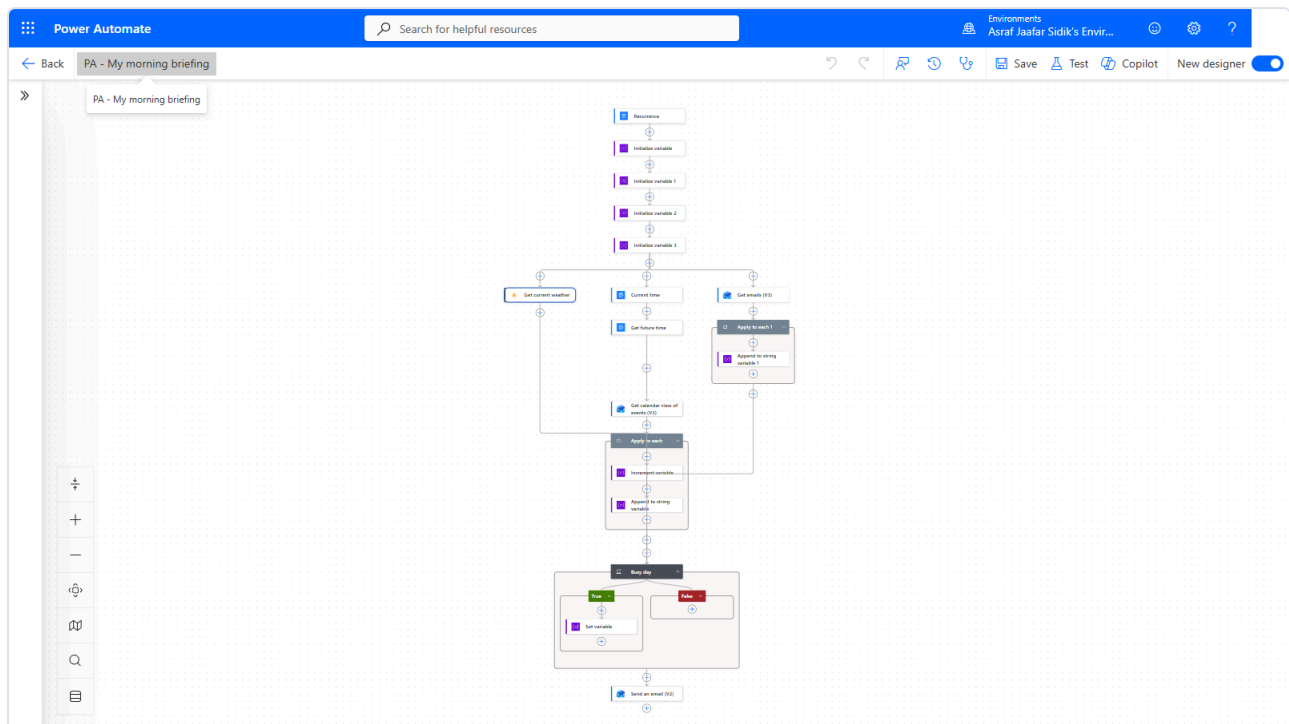
Three independent branches, running at the same time.

Key point: Each branch writes to its **own** variable. If all three appended to one shared variable, the sections would arrive in whatever order the branches happened to finish. Separate variables keep the email in a fixed order.

8.6 Bring the Branches Back Together

The next step must wait until all three branches have finished.

1. At the bottom of the **meetings** branch, below its loop, add a **Condition**. Rename it `Busy day`.
2. Open the Condition's **Settings** tab. Under **Run after**, select **Select actions** and tick the last action of each branch: **Get current weather**, the meetings **Apply to each**, and the email **Apply to each**. Leave **Is successful** ticked for each.
3. Look at the canvas. Lines from all three branches now lead into **Busy day**.

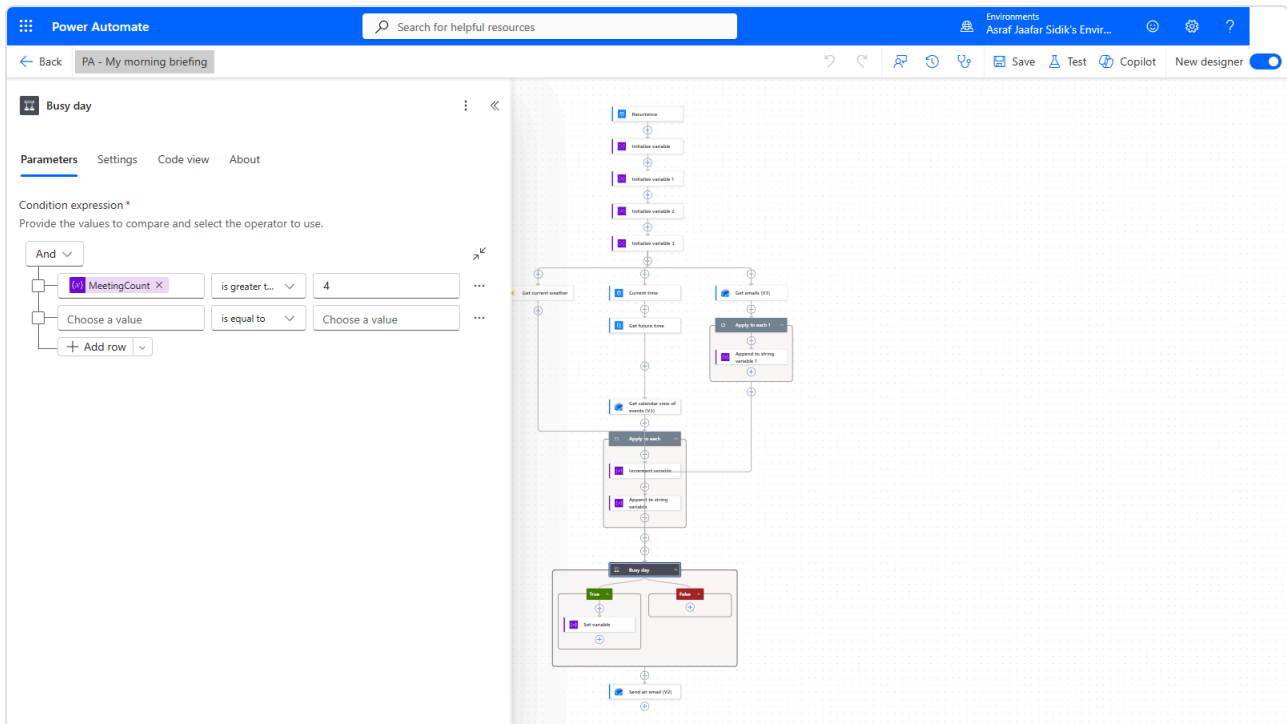


All three branches flow into one step. It waits for the slowest branch.

Note: If your designer shows a single **+** where the three branches end, you can add the Condition there instead. It joins the branches automatically. Either way, check that three lines lead into it.

8.7 Change the Subject on a Busy Day

1. In **Busy day**, insert **MeetingCount**, choose **is greater than**, type **4**.
2. In the **True** branch, add **Set variable**. Select **BriefingSubject**. In **Value**, type **Busy day ahead:** , insert **MeetingCount**, type **meetings**.
3. Leave **False** empty. The subject keeps its starting value, **Your day ahead**.



Set variable replaces a variable's value. Append adds to it. Increment adds to a number.

8.8 Send the Briefing

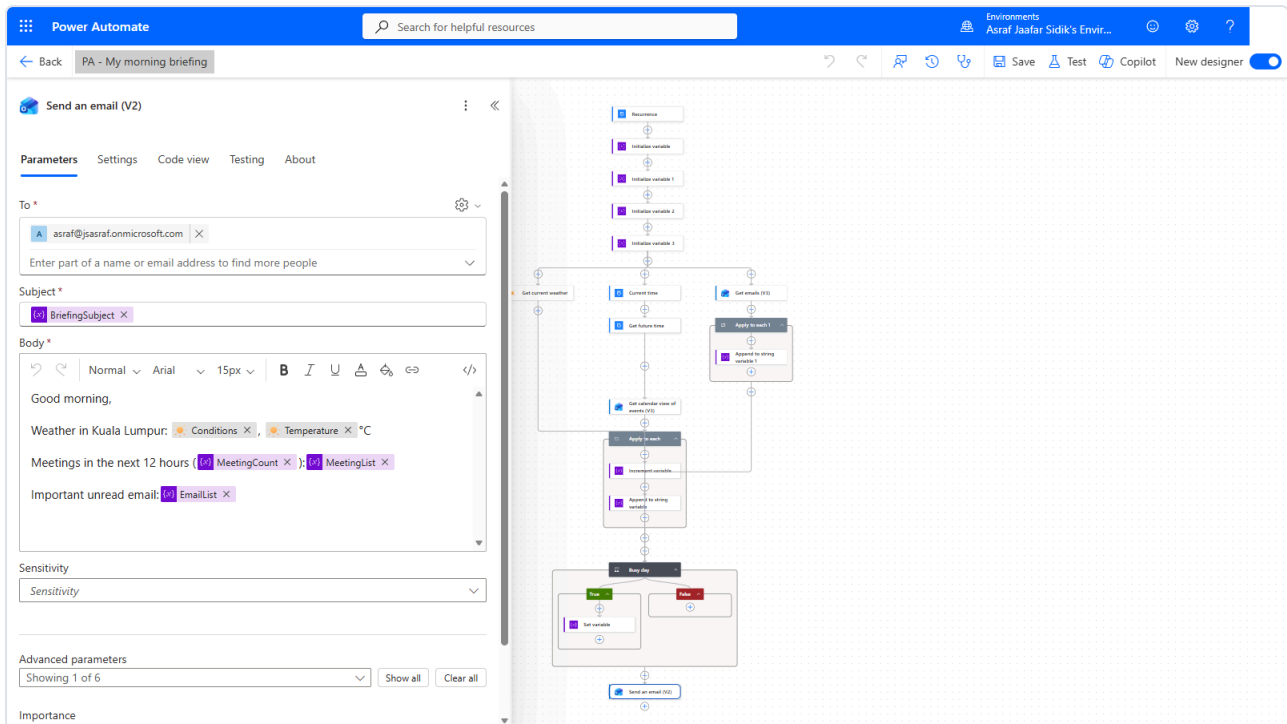
1. Below **Busy day** (outside it), add **Send an email (V2)** (Office 365 Outlook).
2. **To:** your own email address.
3. **Subject:** insert **BriefingSubject**.
4. **Body:** type the text below and insert the tokens shown in brackets. The weather values come from **Get current weather**. The rest are under **Variables**.

Good morning,

Weather in Kuala Lumpur: **[Conditions]**, **[Temperature]**°C

Meetings in the next 12 hours (**[MeetingCount]**):**[MeetingList]**

Important unread email:**[EmailList]**



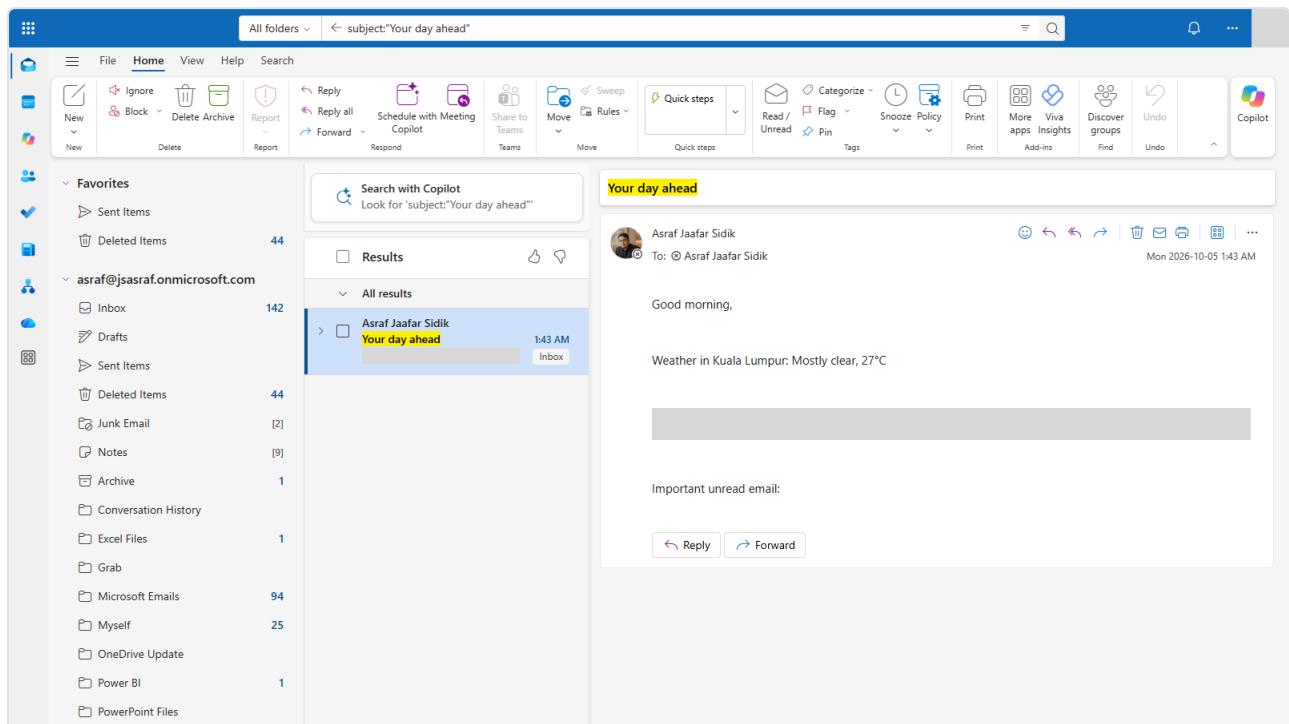
Variables drop into the email like any other dynamic content.

5. Select **Save** and open **Flow checker**. Fix anything it reports.

8.9 Test It

This flow only emails you, so you can test it yourself.

1. Select **Test** > **Manually** > **Test** > **Run flow**.
2. Open the run. Notice that the three branches started at almost the same moment.
3. Select **Busy day** and check which branch it took. Select a **Set variable** or **Increment variable** step to see the value it stored.
4. Open the email in Outlook.



Your briefing. Each section came from a different branch.

If you have no meetings or no important unread email, those lists are simply empty and the count reads 0. That's correct.

Independent Practice

Add a fourth parallel branch that counts up to 25 unread emails of any importance. Create an Integer variable `UnreadCount` at the top, use **Get emails (V3)** with **Fetch Only Unread Messages** set to Yes and **Top** set to 25, and increment the variable for each email. Add a line to the briefing: Unread email: `[UnreadCount]`.

Going further: skip empty sections. Use a condition with **EmailList** is equal to (leave the right side empty) to set EmailList to `<br>Nothing urgent. Enjoy your morning. when there's no important email. Optional.`

Troubleshooting

Symptom	What to check
Initialize variable isn't offered	You're inside a branch or loop. Add it below Recurrence
Get current weather is blocked	Your environment may block MSN Weather. Ask the trainer, or skip branch 1
The meeting list is empty but you have meetings	Start Time is Current time , End Time is Future time , Calendar Id is Calendar

Meetings and email appear on one line

The `<br>` is missing at the start of the Append value

The email sends before a branch finishes

Busy day's **Run after** must include the last action of every branch

The subject never changes

Set variable is in the True branch, and the condition uses MeetingCount is greater than 4

Times look eight hours off

The meeting window uses UTC from Current time. For a briefing, a 12-hour window still covers your day

Lesson Summary

Variables give a flow named boxes that change as it runs. You created four at the top, then used **Increment** to count, **Append** to build lists and **Set** to replace a value. Parallel branches let independent lookups run side by side, each writing to its own variable, and a join makes the final email wait for all of them. Next, you'll ask Copilot to plan a flow for you, and review what it suggests.

HANDS-ON

Hands-on exercises

Hover over a grey box and click the copy icon in its top-right corner. Everything on this page is **text**, typed or pasted straight into a field.

Flow name (text, section 8.1)

PA - My morning briefing

Variable names (text, section 8.2)

MeetingCount

MeetingList

Emaillist

BriefingSubject

Starting value for BriefingSubject:

Your day ahead

Weather location (text, section 8.3)

Kuala Lumpur

Start of each list line (text, sections 8.4 and 8.5)

Paste, then insert **Subject** after it.

•

Busy day subject (text, section 8.7)

Paste, insert **MeetingCount**, then type `meetings`.

Busy day ahead:

Condition name (text, section 8.6)

Busy day

Briefing email body (text, section 8.8)

Paste, then replace each `[Name]` with the matching dynamic content token.

```
Good morning,  
  
Weather in Kuala Lumpur: [Conditions], [Temperature]°C  
  
Meetings in the next 12 hours ([MeetingCount]):[MeetingList]  
  
Important unread email:[EmailList]
```

09

CHAPTER 9

Plan an Automation with Copilot

Copilot in Power Automate can turn a plain-language description into a suggested flow. A suggestion isn't a finished design, though. In this chapter you review what Copilot proposes, correct it precisely, and walk away without creating anything.

Copy-paste values: the three prompts for this chapter are on the copy-paste page.

Estimated time: 30 minutes

Your result: A reviewed and improved flow plan produced with Copilot, without creating or running a cloud flow.

What You Will Learn

- Describe an automation to Copilot with a clear, bounded prompt
- Review an AI-generated flow plan against the business rule
- Refine a suggestion by naming the exact change you need
- Leave the planning experience without creating a flow

The Business Problem

Copilot may leave out a calculation, add an action you don't need, or read a broad instruction differently from what you meant. You ask it to plan a weekly coordinator summary, check every proposed step, and correct it until it matches this intended plan:

Recurrence > List rows present in a table > Filter array > Compose count > Send one coordinator email

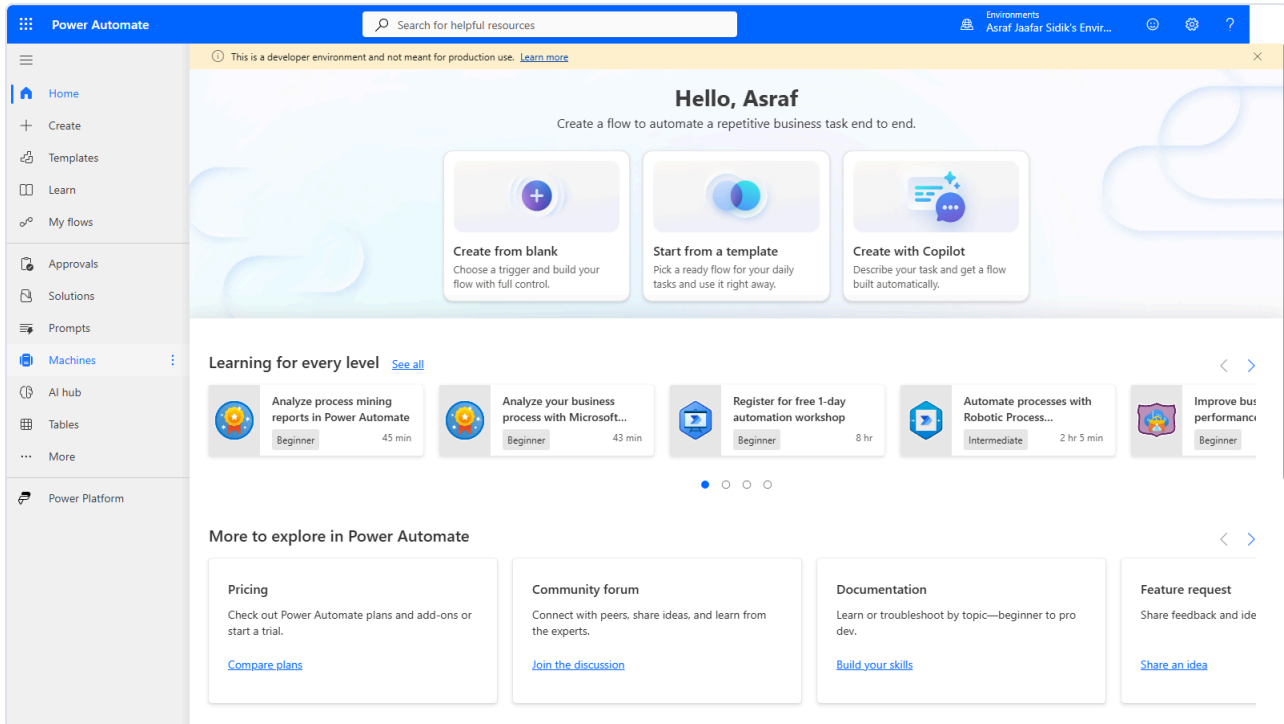
Before You Begin

Copilot availability depends on your organisation, environment, region and admin settings. If **Create with Copilot** or **Describe it to design it** isn't available, follow along with the manual's screenshots and answer the review questions without entering a prompt.

Important: Use only fictional details and `coordinator@example.com`. Never put confidential information, personal data, passwords or real recipients into a training prompt.

9.1 Open the Copilot Planning Experience

On the Power Automate home page, select **Create with Copilot**. The Create page may call the same thing **Describe it to design it**.



Create with Copilot starts from a plain-language description.

9.2 Describe the Complete Business Outcome

In **What will your flow do?**, paste prompt 1 from the copy-paste page and select **Submit**.

Power Automate

Search for helpful resources

Environments
Asraf Jaafar Sidik's Envir...

Describe it to design it

Step 1 of 2

What will your flow do?

Describe what you want to automate and AI will help you make it happen. [How it works](#)

Every Friday at 4:00 PM Singapore time, read rows from the tblTraining table in TrainingRegister.xlsx in OneDrive for Business. Keep rows whose Status is Registered and SessionDate is within the next 14 days. Email the training coordinator a summary count. Do not send participant emails.

Or try one of these examples to get started

- When someone mentions me by email, send me a message on Teams
- Copy all rows from an Excel file to another excel file with a click of a button
- Send me an email message every time an item on SharePoint is updated

[View more examples](#)

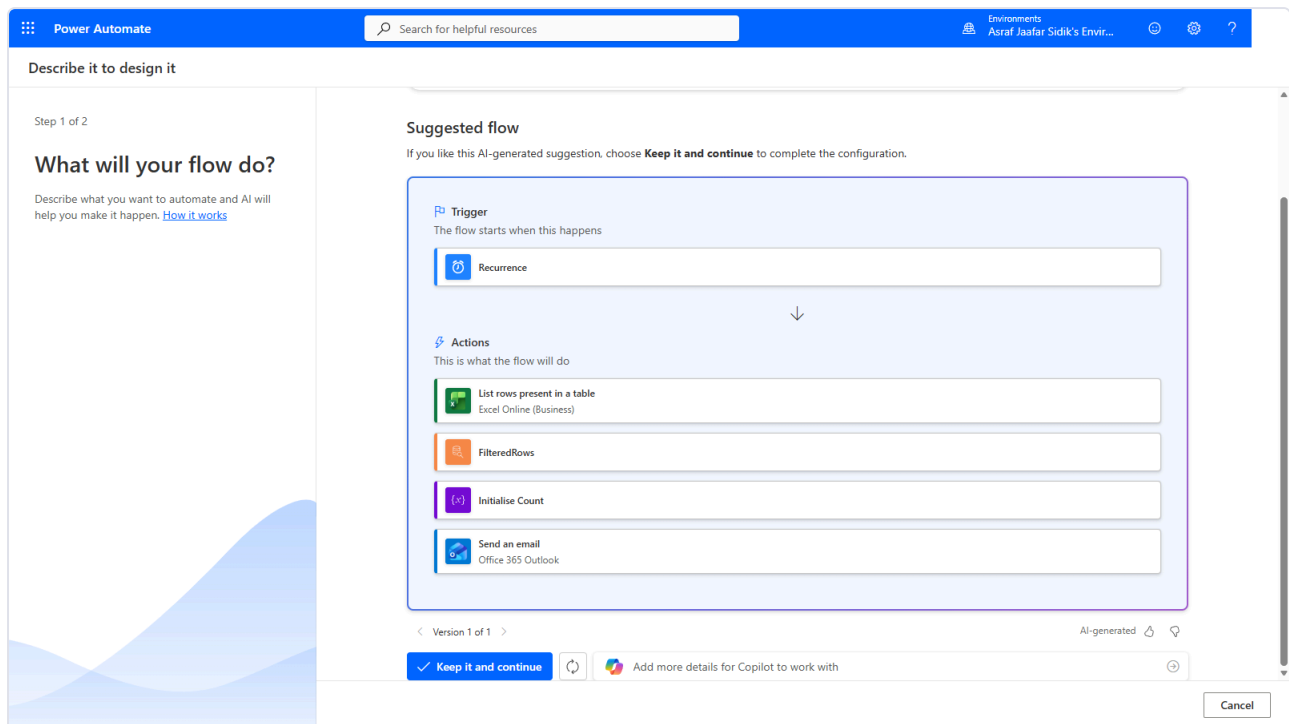
Cancel

The prompt names the schedule, source, rule, output and a boundary.

A strong prompt states the event, the data source, the rule, the output and the boundaries. Even so, Copilot doesn't know your approved recipient, the exact workbook location, your organisation's policies, or how you'll test the result.

9.3 Review the First Suggestion

*Read the trigger and every proposed action before you select anything. In the manual's example, the first version suggested Recurrence, List rows present in a table, FilteredRows, Initialise Count and Send an email. It looks plausible, but **Initialise Count** doesn't say how the count is calculated.*



A plausible start, but the count isn't explained.

Use these questions on any AI-generated flow plan:

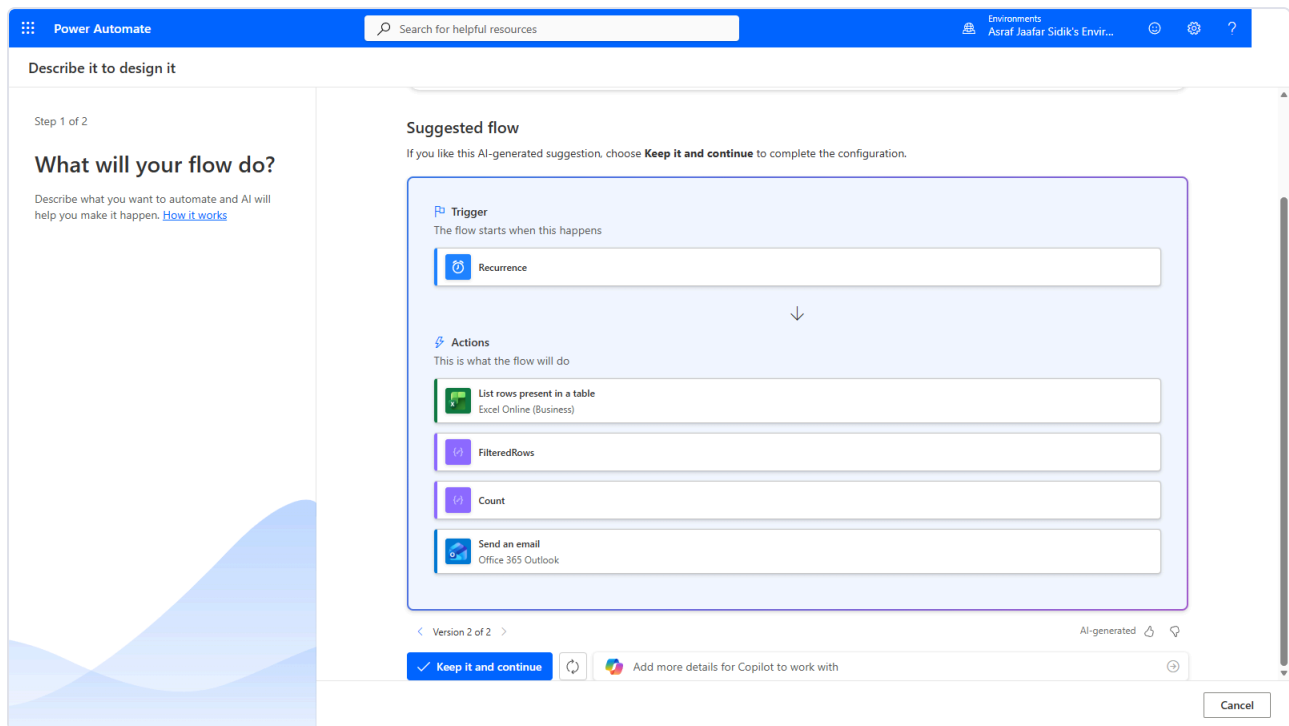
Review area	Question
Trigger	Does it start at the intended event, time and time zone?
Data	Does it use the correct connector, file, table, list, form or mailbox?
Logic	Are filtering, looping, conditions and calculations explicit?
Output	Is the destination approved, and could the action contact real people?
Licensing	Are all proposed connectors and actions available to participants?
Testing	Can the plan be tested safely with fictional data and approved destinations?

9.4 Clarify the Filter and Count

In **Add more details to improve the flow**, paste prompt 2 and select **Send**. It names the actions, gives the counting expression, and draws a clear line around who gets email.

9.5 Identify an Unnecessary Action

Copilot's answers vary from run to run. Check whether the second suggestion added anything you didn't ask for. A common one is **Get file metadata using path** before **List rows present in a table**. You don't need it: **List rows present in a table** can select the workbook directly, so the extra action is just another dependency. If your suggestion is already clean, as in the screenshot below, note that and still send prompt 3: it locks in the exact structure.



The count improved, but an unneeded step appeared.

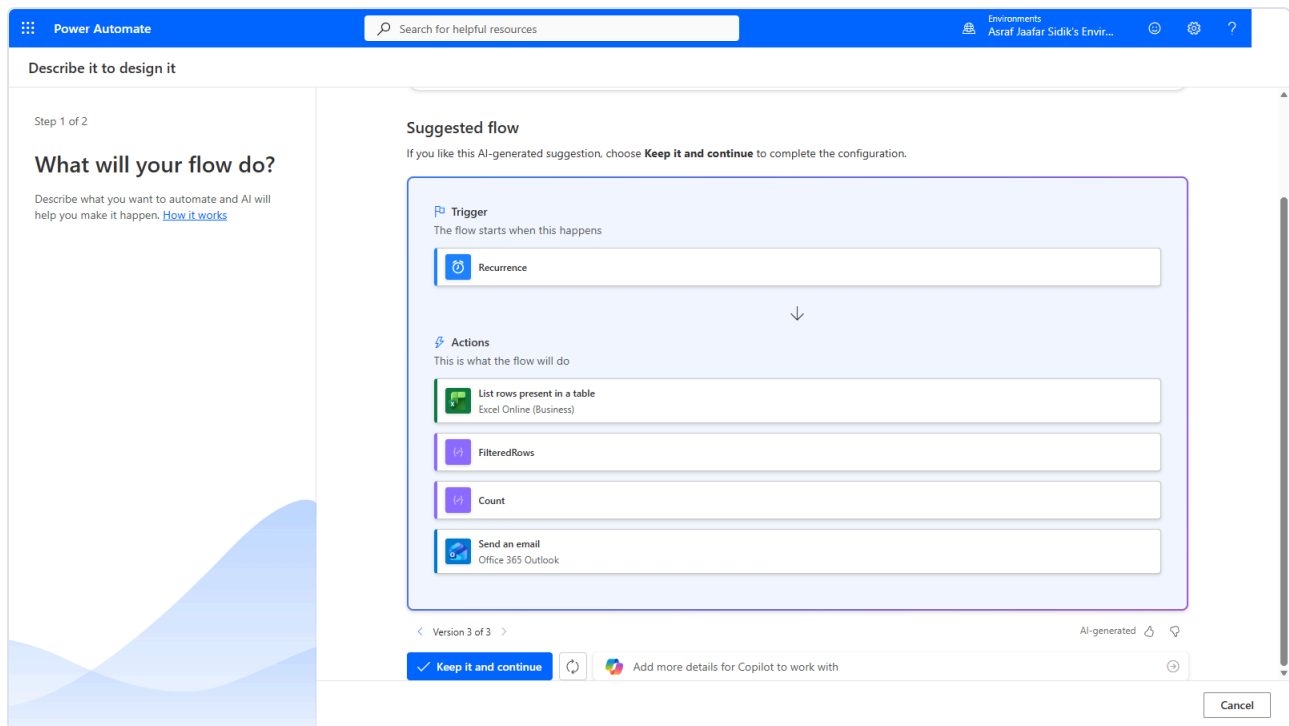
9.6 Request a Streamlined Design

Paste prompt 3 and select **Send**. It says what to remove, why, and exactly which structure to keep.

9.7 Validate the Final Suggestion

The third suggestion should have exactly these steps:

Order	Proposed step
1	Recurrence
2	List rows present in a table
3	FilteredRows
4	Compose Count
5	Send an email



The outline matches the intended plan.

This only checks the outline. If you continued, you'd still need to configure the Friday schedule and time zone, the workbook and table, the filter and count expressions, the recipient, subject and body, error handling, and test data.

9.8 Exit Without Creating the Flow

Select **Cancel**, not **Keep it and continue**. Power Automate returns to the Create page. This exercise is planning only.

Independent Practice

Write a prompt for a monthly training-capacity report. Include the schedule, data source, inclusion rule, output and one explicit boundary. Swap prompts with another participant and find one ambiguity before asking Copilot for a suggestion.

Troubleshooting

Symptom	What to check
Create with Copilot is missing	Organisation settings, environment, region, account entitlement. Use the manual's example instead
Copilot suggests the wrong trigger	State the exact event or schedule: frequency, day, time and time zone

<i>The plan has a participant email loop</i>	<i>Say only one coordinator summary is needed and explicitly rule out participant emails</i>
<i>The count is unclear</i>	<i>Name the filtered array and ask for <code>length(body('FilteredRows'))</code></i>
<i>An unnecessary connector appears</i>	<i>Explain which existing action already provides the data and ask Copilot to remove the extra one</i>
<i>The final outline looks right</i>	<i>Keep reviewing. Fields, expressions, connections, recipients and testing aren't configured yet</i>

Lesson Summary

Copilot can propose a trigger and action sequence quickly, keep versions, and respond to refinements. You stay responsible for the business rule, connector choice, licensing, recipient safety, expressions, configuration and testing. The best result came from reviewing each suggestion and stating the exact correction.

HANDS-ON

Hands-on exercises

Hover over a grey box and click the copy icon in its top-right corner, then paste into Copilot.

These prompts use fictional details only. Never put confidential information, personal data, passwords or real recipients into a training prompt.

1. Describe the complete business outcome (section 9.2)

Paste into **What will your flow do?** and select **Submit**.

```
Every Friday at 4:00 PM Singapore time, read rows from the tblTraining table in TrainingRegister.xlsx in OneDrive for Business. Keep rows whose Status is Registered and SessionDate is within the next 14 days. Email the training coordinator a summary count. Do not send participant emails.
```

2. Clarify the filter and count (section 9.4)

Paste into **Add more details to improve the flow** and select **Send**.

```
Use Filter array to keep rows where Status is Registered and SessionDate is between today and 14 days from today. Calculate the count with length(body('FilteredRows')). Send one summary email only to coordinator@example.com. Do not add an Apply to each or any participant email.
```

3. Request a streamlined design (section 9.6)

```
Remove Get file metadata using path because List rows present in a table can select the workbook directly. Keep only Recurrence, List rows present in a table, Filter array named FilteredRows, Compose named Count using length(body('FilteredRows')), and one Send an email action to coordinator@example.com.
```

Remember: select **Cancel** at the end (section 9.8). This exercise is planning only.

10

CHAPTER 10

Move Automations with Environments and Solutions

A flow that works in one environment can still be hard to move safely. It depends on connections, tables and other components, and copying them one at a time makes it easy to miss something. Solutions package those pieces together.

Copy-paste values: the solution names are on the copy-paste page.

Estimated time: 60 minutes (trainer demonstration)

Your result: You can explain how a flow moves between environments, after watching your trainer package the capstone flow in a solution and walk through where an import starts.

What You Will Learn

- Explain what an environment is and why organisations separate development from production
- Describe what a solution can contain
- Explain how Power Automate, Power Apps and Copilot Studio can share solution components
- Follow how a solution is created and an existing cloud flow added
- Follow how an unmanaged solution is published and exported
- Identify the safe import, connection-repair, verification and testing sequence

The Migration Path

Development environment > Solution > Publish > Export package > Target environment > Import > Repair connections > Verify > Authorised test

The live demonstration stops after opening the import screen. Importing back into the same environment isn't a real migration test, and testing the capstone could send email.

Before You Begin

Important: This chapter is a **trainer demonstration**. Your class works in a live environment, and solutions create real components there (a solution, a publisher, connection references). Watch the demo and follow along on this page. Don't create, export or import solutions yourself unless your trainer gives you a separate practice environment.

The demo uses *PA - Weekly training capstone* from Chapter 7, kept turned off. Solutions also need Microsoft Dataverse in the environment, and Power Automate Free alone doesn't guarantee that.

Environments in Plain Language

An environment is a separate workspace for apps, flows, data, connections and security. The environment selector at the top of Power Automate shows which one you're in.

Environment	Typical purpose	Practical rule
Development	Build and change automations	Use fictional or approved test data
Test	Validate behaviour before release	Reconnect services and run controlled tests
Production	Run approved business processes	Restrict changes and monitor real operation

Separating these stages stops unfinished changes reaching real users, but only when permissions, connection ownership, data and release steps are controlled too.

Power Automate, Power Apps and Copilot Studio all sit on the Power Platform, so one solution can package the flows, apps, agents, tables, connection references and environment variables behind a single business process. What's available depends on the environment and licences.

10.1 Confirm the Current Environment

Check the environment selector before you create or import anything, and confirm with the trainer that it's the development or training environment. If a flow or solution seems to be missing, check the environment before rebuilding it.

10.2 Create the Solution

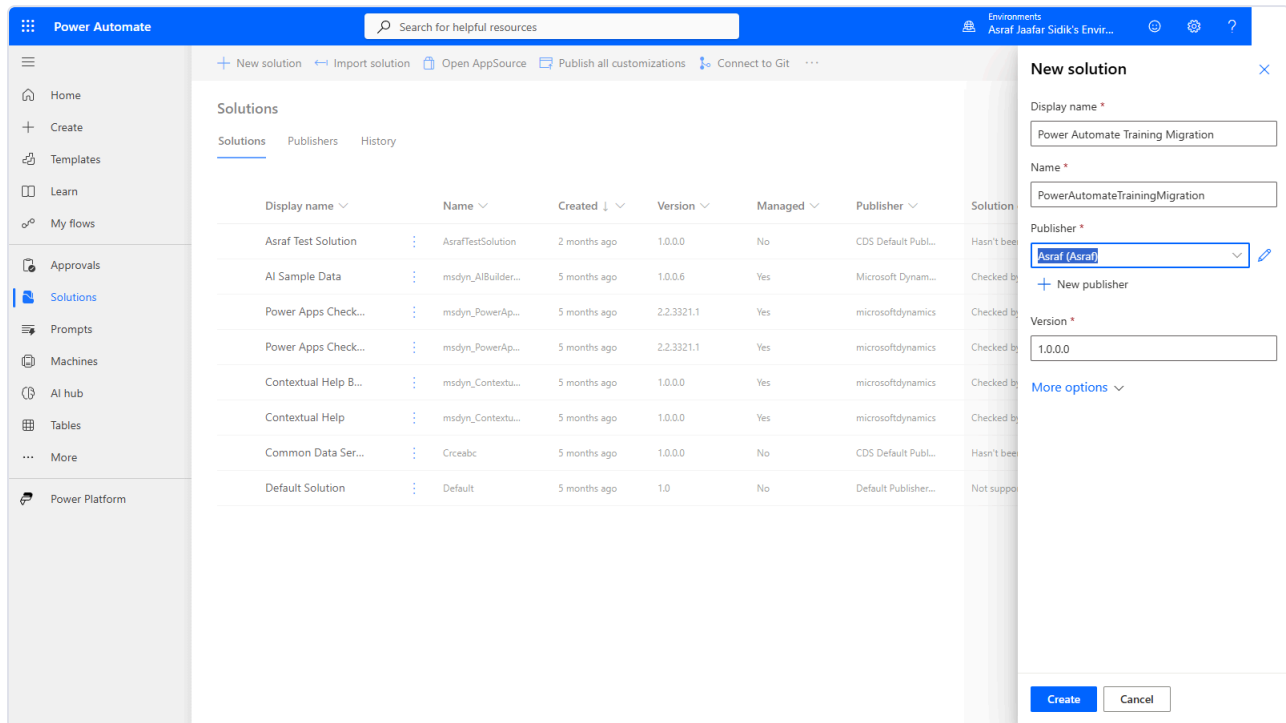
Open **Solutions**, select **New solution**, and enter:

Field	Value
Display name	Power Automate Training Migration
Name	PowerAutomateTrainingMigration
Publisher	The trainer-approved publisher

Version

1.0.0.0

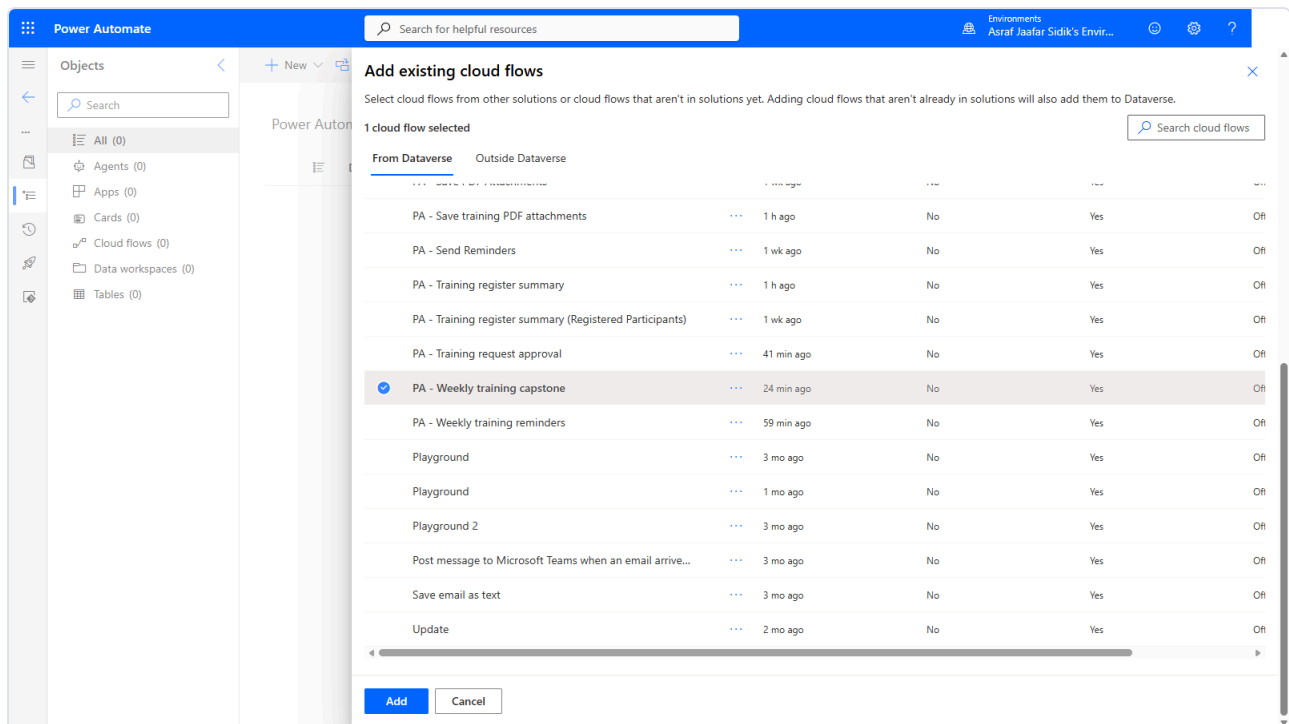
Then select **Create**. The display name is the friendly label. The unique name is used internally and normally shouldn't change later.



The display name is for people. The name is used internally.

10.3 to 10.7 Add the Capstone Flow

1. Open the new solution. Its object list is empty: a new solution is just a container.
2. Select **Add existing** and point to **Automation**.
3. Under Automation, select **Cloud flow**.
4. Find *PA - Weekly training capstone*. Depending on how your environment stores flows, it's on the **From Dataverse** tab or the **Outside Dataverse** tab.
5. Select the capstone, then **Add**.
6. If only the flow appears in the solution, select it, then **Advanced** > **Add required objects**. This adds the connection references it needs.

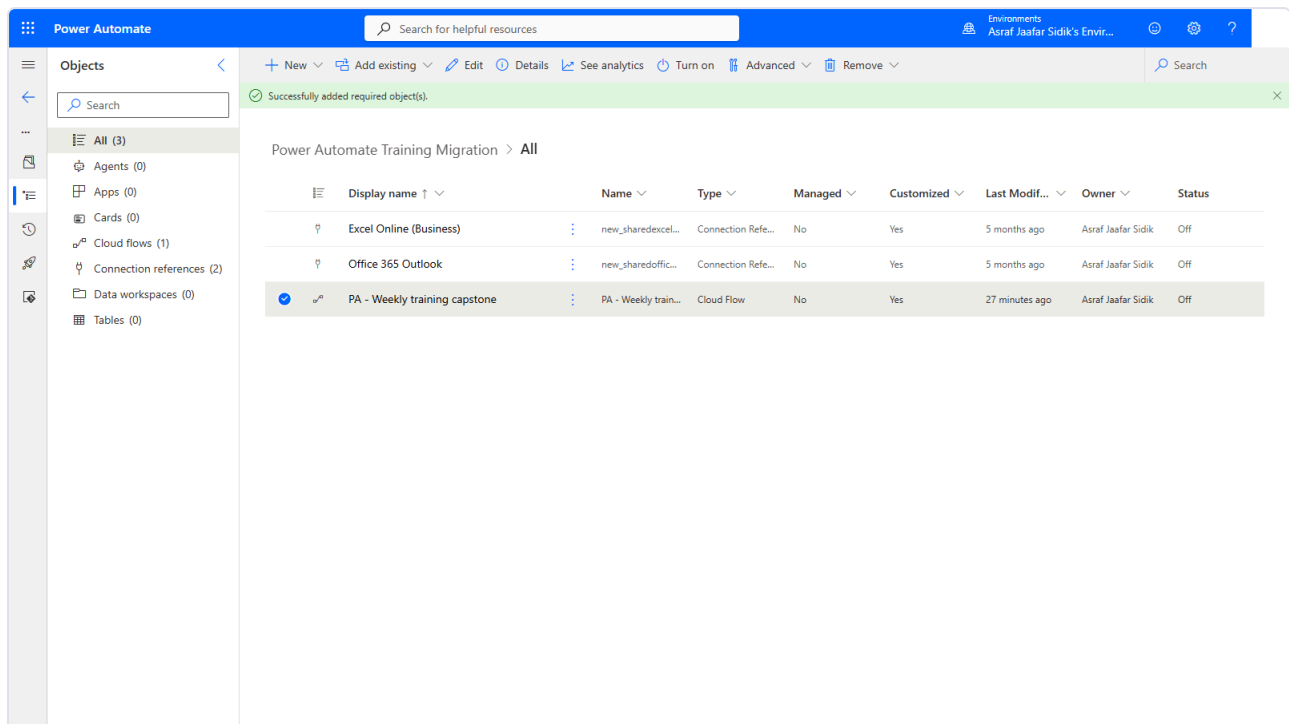


Pick the capstone from the list. Here it's on the From Dataverse tab.

Power Automate may also add **connection references**. A connection reference is a solution component that points to a connection. The target environment still needs a valid connection and an authorised account.

10.8 Verify the Solution Components

Confirm the solution has three objects: the capstone cloud flow and the Excel Online (Business) and Office 365 Outlook connection references.



Three objects: the flow and its two connection references.

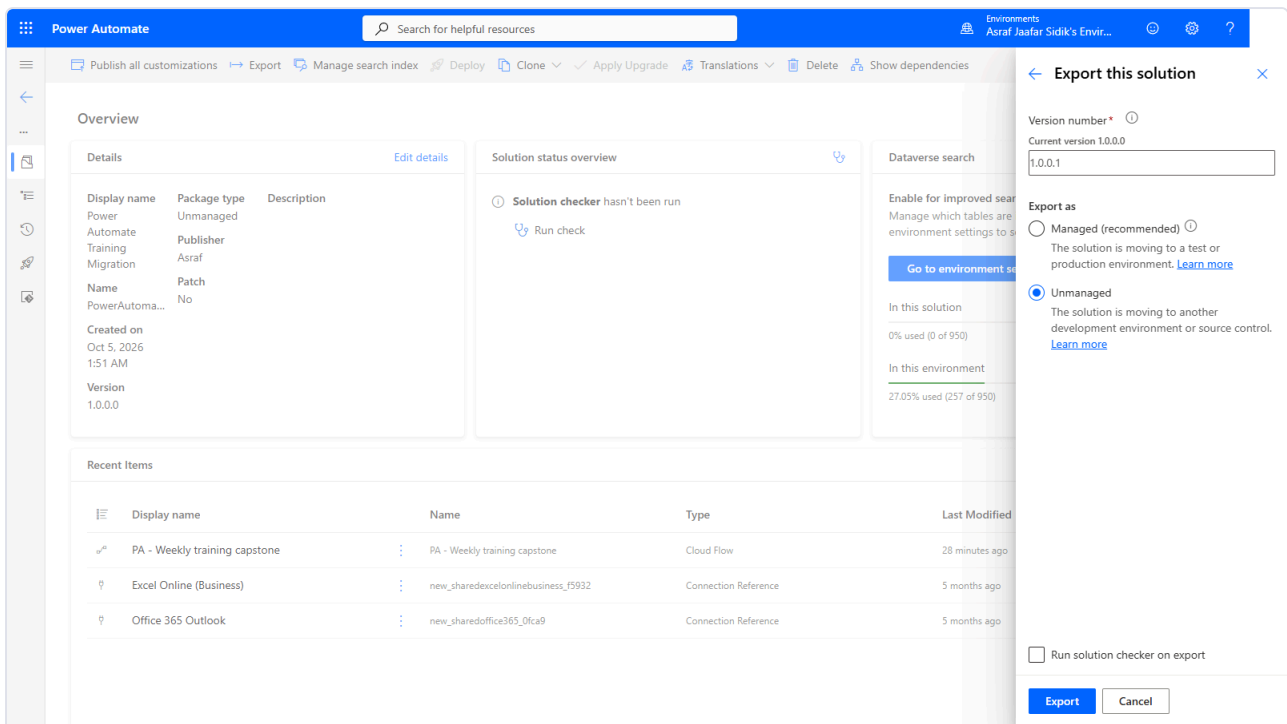
Key point: Showing up in the object list doesn't mean a dependency is ready. File locations, table names, recipients, connection accounts, environment variables and permissions can all differ in the target environment.

10.9 Review the Solution Before Export

Open **Overview** and check the name, version, package type, publisher and included items.

10.10 to 10.12 Publish and Export

1. Select **Export**. If a **Before you export** panel offers **Publish**, select it so the latest changes are included, and wait for **Published**.
2. Select **Next**.



Unmanaged suits a learning exercise. The version number goes up with each export.

3. Confirm the version, select **Unmanaged**, and select **Export**. Power Automate suggests the next version number (for example 1.0.0.1), so every exported package has its own version.

4. When the success message appears, select **Download** and store the ZIP in the trainer-approved location. The worked example produced `PowerAutomateTrainingMigration_1_0_0_1.zip`.

An unmanaged package suits this exercise because its components can be edited after import. Managed solutions are normally used for controlled distribution where recipients shouldn't edit the components. That's an organisational decision, so don't switch package types casually in an established process.

Tip: Don't unzip or rename the package before import. Treat it as a release artifact and record who exported it, from which environment, and why.

10.13 and 10.14 Switch Environment and Start the Import

1. Use the environment selector to choose the trainer-approved target environment, and confirm its name before opening **Solutions**.
2. Select **Import solution**, then **Browse** to the exported ZIP. Select **Next** only after confirming the package name and the target environment.

The demonstration stops here. No file is uploaded and nothing is imported. Your trainer may not switch environments at all if there's no second training environment. **Never use production as a stand-in for a training target.**

10.15 Repair Connections and Settings

After the package is selected, Power Platform may ask for connection mappings or environment-specific values. Before import or first use:

1. Map each connection reference to an approved connection in the target environment.
2. Confirm the Excel workbook and `tblTraining` table exist in the intended target location.
3. Review recipients, team and channel selections, form references, schedules, time zones and environment variables.
4. Confirm the importing account and future flow owner have the required permissions.
5. Keep the imported flow turned off until verification is complete.

10.16 Verify and Test Safely

After an authorised import, open the solution and confirm the expected components are there. Run Flow checker, review every connection and setting, and use fictional data and approved destinations for the first test.

Testing is a separate release decision. An imported flow can be structurally valid and still point at the wrong workbook, mailbox, form, team, channel or recipient. Get trainer authorisation right before any test that can send messages or change shared data.

Independent Practice

Create a migration checklist for one of the earlier flows. Name its trigger, connectors, data sources, recipients, environment-specific settings, owner, safe test data, and the evidence you'd need before turning it on in production. Don't export, import or run anything.

Troubleshooting

Symptom	What to check
Solutions is missing or unavailable	Environment type, Dataverse, licence, security role and maker permissions
The flow isn't in the list	Current environment, both the From Dataverse and Outside Dataverse tabs, flow ownership, and whether it's already in another solution
Connection references are missing	Select the flow in the solution, then Advanced > Add required objects
Extra components appear	Connection references and other dependencies may be added automatically. Review each one
Export stays pending	Refresh Solutions, open export history, and confirm publishing finished
Import says the solution already exists	Check you're in the intended target, and whether this is an upgrade or an accidental same-environment import

<i>A connection shows an error after import</i>	<i>Create or pick an approved target connection and remap the connection reference</i>
<i>The flow imports but can't find the workbook</i>	<i>Target OneDrive or SharePoint location, file name, table name, permissions and connector account</i>
<i>The imported flow is off</i>	<i>Leave it off while reviewing. Turn it on only through the approved release process</i>

Lesson Summary

Environments separate workspaces, permissions, data and release stages. Solutions package related Power Platform components so a process can move in a controlled way. A safe migration covers dependency review, publishing, a versioned export, a confirmed target, connection mapping, configuration checks, Flow checker, controlled testing and a deliberate decision to switch the flow on.

HANDS-ON

Hands-on exercises

Hover over a grey box and click the copy icon in its top-right corner. Everything on this page is **text**, typed or pasted straight into a field.

Solution display name (text, section 10.2)

Power Automate Training Migration

Solution name (text, section 10.2)

PowerAutomateTrainingMigration

Solution version (text, section 10.2)

1.0.0.0

11

CHAPTER 11

Extra Practice: Personal Automations

Four small flows for when you finish early, or for practice back at your desk. Each one only reads your own data or writes to your own OneDrive training folder, and only notifies you. None of them touches shared sites, lists, teams or other people's mailboxes.

Copy-paste values: flow names and text for every exercise are on the copy-paste page.

Estimated time: 15 to 20 minutes each, self-paced

Your result: Up to four working personal flows, each built with the skills from Chapters 3 to 8.

Which One Should I Try?

Exercise	Flow type	Practises	Connectors
A. Flagged email to To Do	Automated	Triggers and dynamic content	Office 365 Outlook, Microsoft To Do (Business)
B. Send me a note	Instant	Trigger inputs	Microsoft Teams (your own Flow bot chat)
C. Save an email to OneDrive	Automated	Trigger filters, file actions	Office 365 Outlook, OneDrive for Business
D. News digest	Automated	A non-Microsoft 365 trigger	RSS, Office 365 Outlook

Tip: Turn each flow off when you've finished testing, unless you want to keep using it. Go to **My flows**, select the ... next to the flow, and choose **Turn off**.

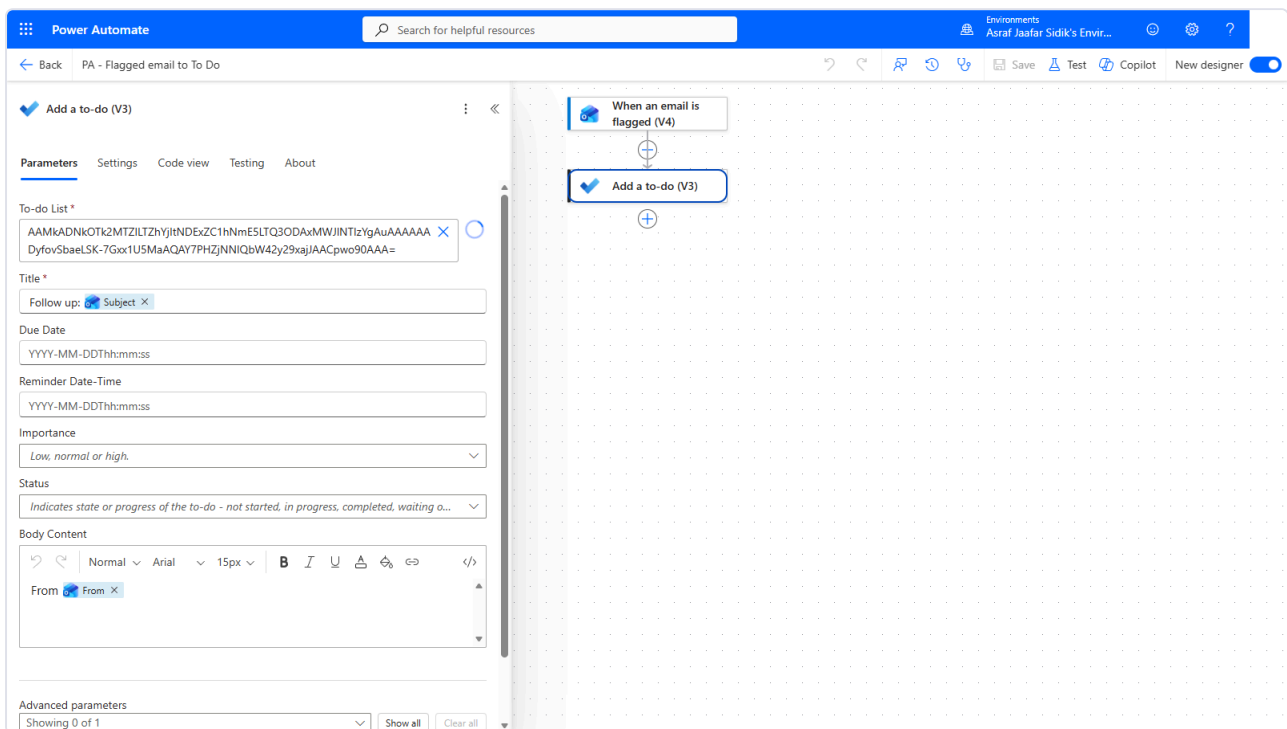
A. Flagged Email to To Do

The problem: You flag emails to come back to, then forget about them. This flow adds every flagged email to your personal To Do list.

1. Select **Create > Automated cloud flow**. Name it **PA - Flagged email to To Do**.
2. Choose the trigger **When an email is flagged (V4)** (Office 365 Outlook) and select **Create**.
3. In the trigger, set **Folder** to **Inbox**.

4. Add **Add a to-do (V3)** (Microsoft To Do (Business)):

Field	Value
To-do List	Tasks
Title	Type <i>Follow up:</i> then insert Subject
Body Content	Type <i>From</i> then insert From



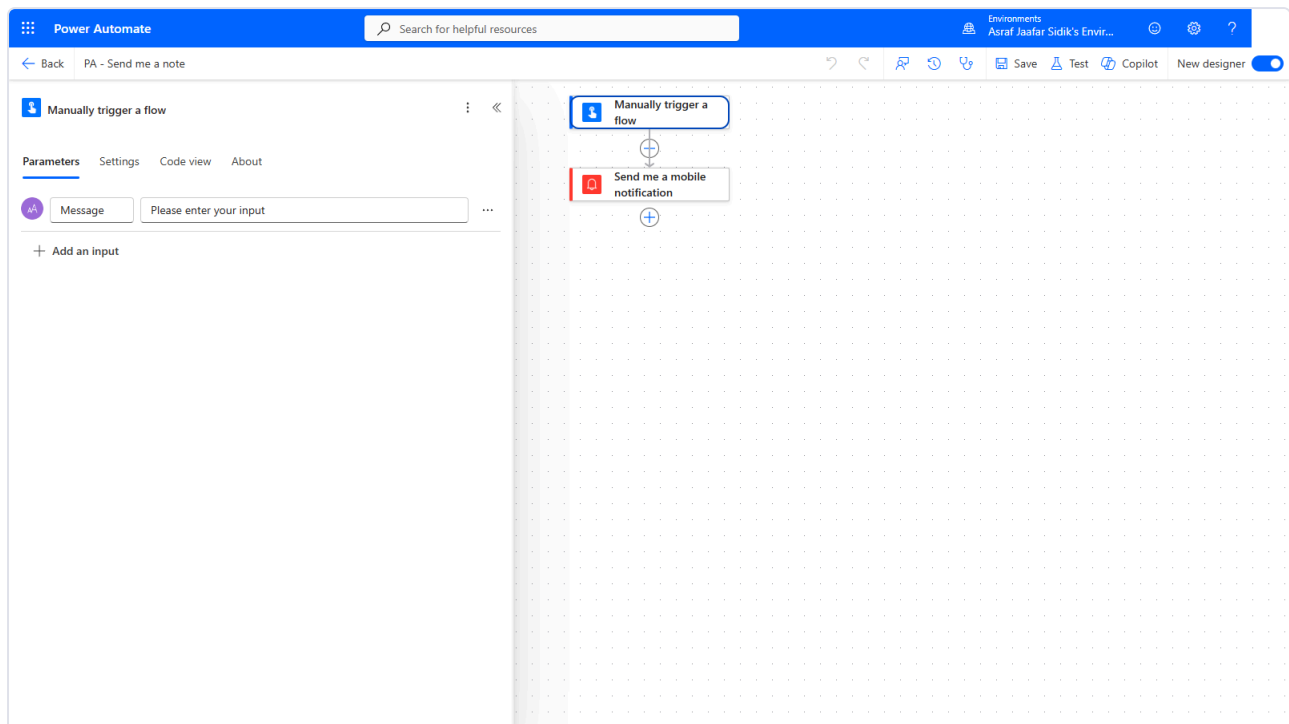
The flagged email's subject becomes the task title.

5. Save, then **Test > Manually > Test**. Flag any email in your Outlook inbox. Within a minute, the task appears in Microsoft To Do.

B. Send Me a Note

The problem: You think of something and want a quick reminder where you'll see it. This instant flow asks you for a message and sends it to you as a Teams chat from Flow bot. It only posts in your own chat with Flow bot.

1. Select **Create > Instant cloud flow**. Name it *PA - Send me a note*.
2. Choose **Manually trigger a flow** and select **Create**.
3. Select the trigger, then **+ Add an input > Text**. Rename the input from Input to *Message*.



A trigger input asks the person running the flow to type something first.

4. Add **Post message in a chat or channel** (Microsoft Teams):

Field	Value
Post as	Flow bot
Post in	Chat with Flow bot
Recipient	Your own email address
Message	Type <i>Reminder:</i> then insert Message from the trigger

5. Save, then **Test > Manually > Test**. Type a short message and select **Run flow**. The message appears in Teams, in your chat with Flow bot.

Note: Earlier versions of this exercise used **Send me a mobile notification**. During testing that action reported that the Power Automate mobile app had been retired and notifications had nowhere to go, so this version uses Teams instead.

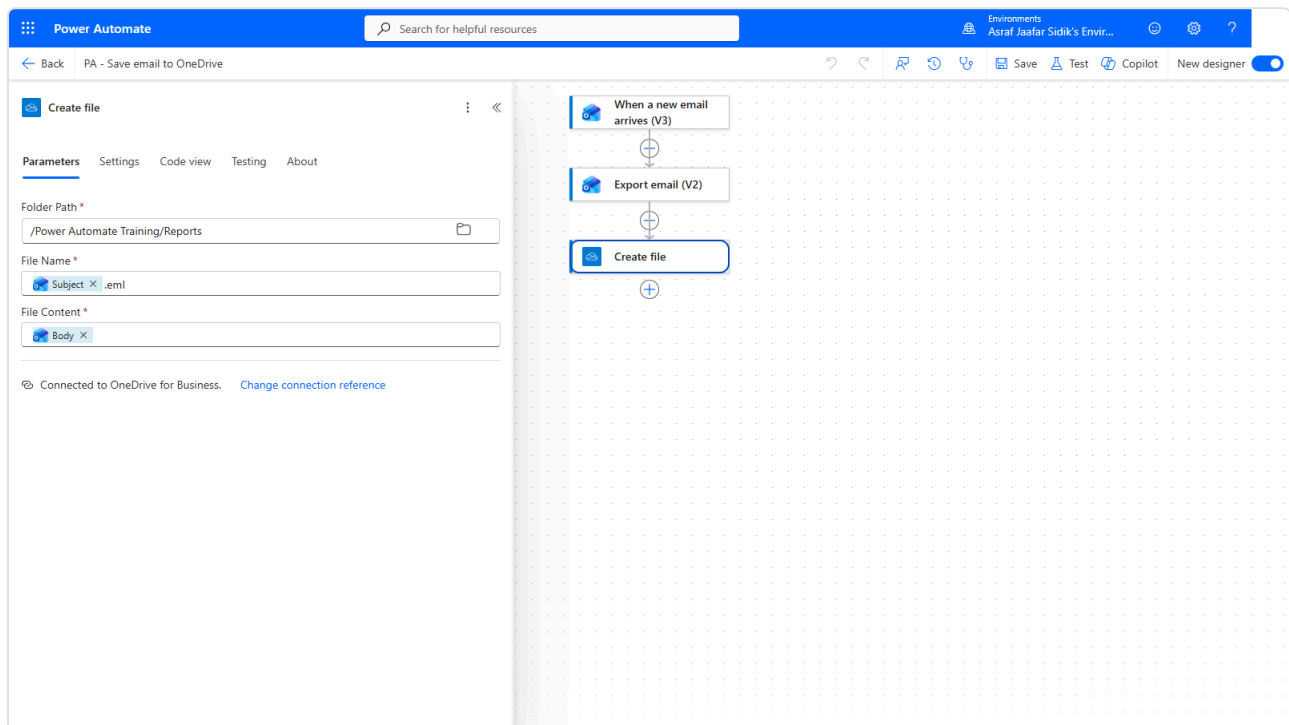
C. Save an Email to OneDrive

The problem: Some emails need keeping as files: a confirmation, a booking, an agreement. This flow saves any email you send yourself with `[PA SAVE]` in the subject as a file in your training folder.

1. Select **Create > Automated cloud flow**. Name it `PA - Save email to OneDrive`.
2. Choose **When a new email arrives (V3)** (Office 365 Outlook) and select **Create**.
3. In the trigger, set **Folder** to **Inbox**. Under **Show all**, set **Subject Filter** to `[PA SAVE]`.

4. Add **Export email (V2)** (Office 365 Outlook). In **Message Id**, insert **Message Id** from the trigger.
5. Add **Create file** (OneDrive for Business):

Field	Value
Folder Path	/Power Automate Training/Reports
File Name	Insert Subject , then type <code>.eml</code>
File Content	Insert Body from Export email (V2)



Export email turns the message into a file. Create file saves it.

6. Save and **Test**. Send yourself an email with the subject `[PA SAVE] Booking confirmation`. A `.eml` file appears in Reports. Double-click it to open it in Outlook.

D. News Digest

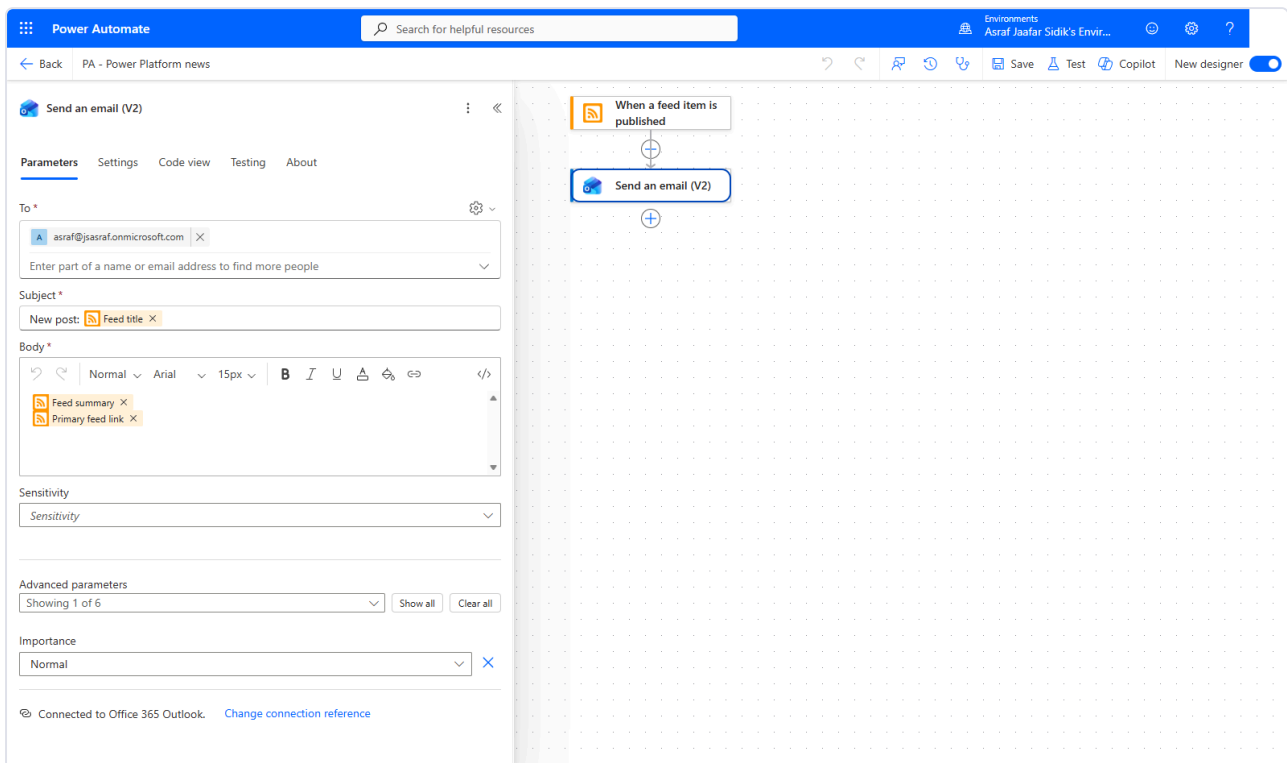
The problem: You want to keep up with Power Automate news without checking the blog. This flow emails you whenever a new post is published.

1. Select **Create > Automated cloud flow**. Name it `PA - Power Platform news`.
2. Search for `RSS`, choose **When a feed item is published**, and select **Create**.
3. In **The RSS feed URL**, paste the Microsoft Power Platform blog feed from the copy-paste page.
4. Add **Send an email (V2)** (Office 365 Outlook):

Field	Value
To	Your own email address

Subject Type *New post:* then insert **Feed title**

Body Insert **Feed summary**, press Enter, then insert **Primary feed link**



The RSS connector watches a public web feed. It reads, and never writes, anything.

5. Save and turn the flow on. The next new blog post arrives in your inbox. The RSS trigger checks for new posts on a schedule, so a test may not fire straight away.

Note: If the feed URL stops working, open the blog in your browser and look for its RSS link, or try any other news site that offers an RSS feed.

Lesson Summary

Small personal flows are the best way to keep practising after the course. Each one here uses a different starting point (a flag, a button, a subject filter and a web feed) with the same building blocks: a trigger, dynamic content and an action.

HANDS-ON

Hands-on exercises

Hover over a grey box and click the copy icon in its top-right corner. Everything on this page is **text**, typed or pasted straight into a field.

A. Flagged email to To Do

Flow name:

PA - Flagged email to To Do

Title start (insert **Subject** after it):

Follow up:

B. Send me a note

Flow name:

PA - Send me a note

Input name:

Message

Teams message start (insert **Message** after it):

Reminder:

C. Save an email to OneDrive

Flow name:

PA - Save email to OneDrive

Subject filter:

[PA SAVE]

Folder path:

/Power Automate Training/Reports

Test email subject:

[PA SAVE] Booking confirmation

D. News digest

Flow name:

PA - Power Platform news

Microsoft Power Platform blog feed:

<https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/power-platform/blog/feed/>

*Subject start (insert **Feed title** after it):*

New post:

Microsoft Power Automate for End Users

This book accompanies the two-day Microsoft Power Automate for End Users course. It follows one training coordinator's routine, from saving email attachments and sending an Excel summary, through weekly reminders and a Forms approval, to a filtered capstone flow and a personal morning briefing built with variables and parallel branches. Every chapter gives point-and-click steps and copy-ready values you can use during the session and back at your desk.